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Happening today

● **FINANCE MINISTER NIRMALA** Sitharaman will embark on a visit to Canada and the US to hold talks on economic cooperation and investment opportunities.

Business as Usual

By EP UNNY



THE CITY **PAGE 3**
PROTEST AT IIT DELHI
OVER STUDENT'S
DEATH ON CAMPUS

PM MODI DEVOTING PERSONAL ATTENTION TO DEVELOPING RUSSIAN-INDIAN RELATIONS, SAYS PUTIN

Jaishankar meets Putin, focus on trade, energy, fertilisers, high-tech

Modi and Putin to meet twice in next few weeks for SCO, BRICS

Shubhajt Roy
New Delhi, August 24

AHEAD of two scheduled meetings between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Russian President Vladimir Putin in the next three weeks, External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar called on the latter in Moscow on Monday. Putin told Jaishankar that among the areas of bilateral cooperation with India, Russia is giving priority to energy, fertilisers, nuclear energy and high technology sectors.



External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar with Russian President Vladimir Putin in Moscow on Monday. AP

Modi and Putin are expected to meet at the SCO (Shanghai Cooperation Organisation) summit in Kyrgyzstan on August 31-September 1, and

again at the BRICS summit in New Delhi on September 12-13. Underlining the increase in bilateral trade between the two

● **CONTINUED ON PAGE 2**

Govt on Gor's remarks: Trump unpredictable, so took cautious approach

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 24

CITING US President Donald Trump's "unpredictable behaviour" when meeting foreign leaders, government sources on Monday said India, therefore, adopted a "cautious approach" when Prime Minister Narendra Modi met him in France in June this year.

The clarification came in response to US Ambassador Sergio Gor's public remarks that the Indian side had asked the

THE WORLD **PAGE 12**
TRUMP MOVES TO
HIKE H-1B VISA FEE
TO OVER \$100,000

NEW U.S. SANCTIONS
'AIM TO BLOCK IRAN
REVENUE SOURCES'

US administration to "not do a full press conference, no questions" after the meeting

● **CONTINUED ON PAGE 2**

United Peela Interface in bread



Amul
Decades of taste

OBC creamy layer candidates in '25 civil services exam: Govt seeks SC directions

Shyamal Yadav
New Delhi, August 24

THE CENTRE on Monday sought "clarifications and appropriate directions" from the Supreme Court on the applicability of its March 11 judgment ordering the consideration of claims by nearly 100 OBC candidates who were selected in Civil Services Examinations (CSE) since 2016 but rejected by the Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT) on the basis of creamy layer criteria.

The Centre's clarification plea comes just ahead of the start of the Foundation Course for the CSE-2025 batch, tentatively scheduled to begin at the Lal Bahadur Shastri National Academy of Administration in Mussoorie this week.

The appeal, the Centre emphasised, was concerned solely with CSE-2025, whose selection process "stood substantially concluded prior to the pronouncement of the judgment and is presently at the terminal stage of service allocation".

In its appeal, the DoPT, however, does not mention the applicability of the Supreme Court judgment from next batches.

E. EXPLAINED

Govt says will have cascading effect

The Centre has argued that SC's March 11 judgment came five days after the final result of CSE-2025 was declared. Delay in finalisation of the category-wise merit and allocation list would have a cascading effect — from training to seniority and pay fixation of the incoming batch.

The Centre said that the March 11 judgment "altering settled position (on creamy layer)" was rendered five days after the final result of CSE-2025 already stood declared. Any delay in finalisation of the category-wise merit and allocation list would have a cascading effect on the training schedule, batch strength, logistics arrangements, the training calendar fixed by the respective academies, cadre allocation for IAS and IPS officers, and the seniority and pay fixation of the

● **CONTINUED ON PAGE 2**

FORM WITH WORSHIPPERS' AADHAAR OR PAN

Tough conversion law kicks in this week, Mumbai pastors ask churchgoers to sign form they are praying of their 'free will'

'Self-declaration' more as assurance, say pastors in Vasai-Virar, Mira-Bhayandar, Thane, Mumbai, Palghar after incidents of disrupted Sunday prayers and FIRs

Purnima Sah
Mumbai, Mira-Bhayandar, Vasai-Virar, Palghar, Thane, August 24

THE MAHARASHTRA anti-conversion law that toughens legal provisions against forced conversion comes into effect August 28. Its shadow has already fallen on Christian congregations across the Mumbai Metropolitan Region. At prayer halls in Vasai-Virar, Mira-Bhayandar and beyond, local pastors are asking worshippers to do something they never had to before — fill a form.

This "self-declaration" states that they are attending the prayer meeting of their own "choice" and face "no pressure, inducement, temptation, lure, or threat of any kind". It further says their decision to attend church "is completely personal, voluntary, and independent." The form asks for a passport-size photograph and an Aadhaar or PAN number.

Until this year, anyone could walk in.

Over the past month, *The Indian Express* found these forms being circulated — in English, Marathi and Hindi — to congregations in Mumbai, Mira-Bhayandar, Vasai-Virar, Palghar and Thane. This follows a run of Sunday disruptions at prayer meetings over the past five months: there



Worshippers sign the form at New Hope Church in Virar. PURNIMA SAH



● 'THE DECLARATION'

- They attend church voluntarily.
- They participate in prayers of their own free will.
- Their participation is part of their religious freedom and a right guaranteed under Constitution of India.
- In case anyone makes a false allegation against them or the church, the voluntary application/self-declaration may be produced as legal evidence.

have been nine FIRs linked to five such disruptions between April and July.

Pattern of prayer, protest

Typically, a prayer meeting is held on a Sunday, often in a

rented hall, school, banquet hall or home. People identifying themselves as Bajrang Dal or VHP workers object, often alleging that Hindus are being converted. Police are called, both sides are taken to the station,

● **CONTINUED ON PAGE 2**



Gurgaon, Monday

School buses stranded on a waterlogged road at Subhash Chowk in Gurgaon after heavy rainfall lashed the NCR on Monday, causing massive traffic jams and leading to cancellation of several flights. PTI

GURGAON received 52 mm rainfall from 8.30 am to 8.30 pm, affecting movement on the Delhi-Gurgaon Expressway and other roads

THE DISTRICT administration advised corporate offices to work from home on Tuesday and told schools to hold classes online

IN DELHI, several areas, including Connaught Place, were inundated. Janakpuri recorded the highest rainfall at 72.5 mm

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J&K reopens probe into 1998 massacre of 23 Kashmiri Pandits

Bashaart Masood
Srinagar, August 24

JAMMU AND Kashmir's State Investigation Agency (SIA) has reopened the Wandhama massacre case, 28 years after militants gunned down 23 Kashmiri Pandits in Ganderbal district in the Valley.

Sources in the SIA said the case was reopened as part of the agency's efforts to reinvestigate the killings of Kashmiri Pandits and gather fresh evidence to identify those responsible.

Lessons from Jantar Mantar: Delhi Police chief orders intel revamp

Sakshi Chand
New Delhi, August 24

DELHI POLICE Commissioner Anurag Kumar has asked the intelligence wing of the force to expand its information-gathering efforts, and to collect at least 10 specific pieces of intelligence ahead of every planned protest.

Sources said the directive was issued earlier this month after the protests at Jantar Mantar and Connaught Place in July saw a much bigger turnout than anticipated, "exposing gaps" in intelligence-collection.

Police were caught flatfooted

● **CONTINUED ON PAGE 2**

● 10 SPECIFIC PIECES OF INTELLIGENCE

The intelligence wing has been directed to collect and analyse:

- Profile of participants
- State-wise participation
- Modes of mobilisation
- Names of leaders and key functionaries
- Agenda or demands of the protesters
- Places of stay and movement
- Local contacts and linkages



At least 50,000 protesters hit the streets in Delhi on July 20

- Organisational affiliations
- Sources of funding
- Logistical arrangements

● **HEALTH COMMISSIONER TO LEAD PROBE; PRELIMINARY INFORMATION POINTS TO EXPLOSION IN VENTILATOR, SAYS OFFICIAL**

'Hadn't even seen son's face': Three newborns killed in fire at Amravati hospital

Ankita Deshkar
Amravati, August 24

AS HE sat outside the mortuary on Monday, Swapnil Borge was shell-shocked. His son was born only a day before, and though he'd not even seen his face yet, Borge had gone around distributing sweets to anyone he came across — staff of the government hospital, fellow patients and passers-by.

"I hadn't even seen his face yet," he said. "I don't know how to tell my wife about this."

Borge's son was one of three newborns who died in a fire at the Neonatal Intensive Care Unit (NICU) of the govern-

ment-run Amravati District Women's Hospital. Officials said the fire, which broke out in the early hours of Monday, could have been caused by a fault in a ventilator in the NICU.

"The incident took place around 4 am at the NICU of the hospital," Amravati Collector Ashish Yerekar told *The Indian Express*. "There were 39 babies, of whom we were able to rescue 36, while three died."

When the fire broke out, there were nine babies — one on a ventilator and eight on warmers. The baby on the ventilator and two babies who were next to him died in the incident."

Thirty-two of the rescued

babies have been referred to other hospitals, while four babies have been kept with their mothers. Dr Vinod Pawar, District Surgeon, Amravati, said: "According to the preliminary information, it appears that there was an explosion in the ventilator."

Police have registered three cases of accidental deaths.

Minister for Public Health and Family Welfare Prakash Abitkar, who visited the hospital and met the affected families, told the media that a committee headed by Health Commissioner Sanjay Katkar would look into the incident and submit a report in seven days.

Chief Minister Devendra



Grieving family members of the victims, in Amravati, Monday. PTI

Padnavis expressed his condolences and promised action. He announced an ex gratia of Rs 5

lakh to the families of the deceased. "Orders have been issued to the health administra-

tion to conduct a high-level inquiry into this incident. The strictest possible action will be taken against those responsible for this incident. Both the Health Minister and the Secretary have been instructed to visit Amravati today itself," he said on X.

At the hospital, staff and witnesses recounted the chaos. "We had no idea what was happening. There was a lot of smoke, so we immediately started rescuing the babies and used fire extinguishers. We could barely see anything. The entire ward was engulfed in flames immediately after the explosion," one staffer said.

Mura Bhai, whose grandson was in the NICU, was among

those who helped rescue the babies. "We were sleeping on the veranda in the hospital when we received the call. It was completely dark inside the ward, and we rushed there with the torches in our mobile phones to help the nurses. Some babies were already trapped and could not be saved."

Officials said the Maharashtra government had provided the ventilators. "A similar minor blast occurred in one of the ventilators at the same hospital in 2022, although there were no casualties then. The ventilators were subsequently replaced. One of those replaced ventilators caught fire," one official said.

Sources at the hospital said

the building's fire audit had lapsed on August 21 and that the hospital had alerted the PWD. They also mentioned that the fire alarm at the ward, too, did not function.

Families, meanwhile, are still struggling to come to terms. Gayatri Chopade's family has moved her to her hometown of Anjanagar and ensured there is no television to relay news of the fire that killed her baby.

"Her baby had swallowed stool in the womb and was shifted from Warud to Amravati. The baby had almost recovered, and Gayatri was discharged from the Warud hospital this week. We learnt about the baby's

● **CONTINUED ON PAGE 2**

Students 'lured with biscuits' to take part in protest: FIRs filed in Kannauj, Deoria

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, August 24

AS STUDENT protests roil schools and colleges across Uttar Pradesh, authorities in two districts have cracked down with FIRs — in Kannauj, police alleged students were lured with biscuits to join a protest, while in Deoria, an activist was booked after filming and posting a video of a lapsed school campus.

The action comes amid Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath's directive on Saturday to file FIRs and take strict action against those spreading false information and "misleading" videos about schools and colleges. At an event in Lucknow on Sunday, he said that some people were posting videos of dilapidated school buildings on social media to "arush" the government's image.

Basic education officers in several districts had also directed schools to restrict the entry of outsiders, including YouTube users and social media users, without prior permission from the authorities concerned.

According to police, on August 20, students and their parents staged a protest against the headmaster of a composite school in Gunaapur, stopping and surrounding his vehicle and raising slogans. Parents alleged the headmaster discriminated against the students, misbehaved and assaulted them. Students also boycotted classes.

However, officials said that during an inquiry, headmaster Rakeshendra Saxena alleged that the students were made to participate in the protest as part of a conspiracy against him. He claimed some people had dis-

tributed biscuits and offered other incentives to lure them.

After a video of the incident was viral, an inquiry was conducted by an officer. Students allegedly told the officer that unidentified persons had lured them with biscuits and persuaded them to join the protest.

Kannauj Block Education Officer Vishwanath Pathak — the complainant in the case — alleged in his complaint that some political persons were using the incident to tarnish the image of the education department and the state government.

The case was filed against unidentified persons on August 20 at Gurusahajanpur police station for abetment, presence of an abettor when an offence is committed, abetment of an offence by the public or more than 10 persons, and unlawful assembly.

Station House Officer, Gurusahajanpur police station, Ajay Awasthi said the case was lodged for misguiding students. No arrest has been made so far.

In Deoria, activist and local resident Rajat Singh was booked on August 22 for allegedly entering a primary school without permission and posting a video of its "dilapidated" condition.

The education department, said the campus had an unused building that was auctioned and demolished as per rules. Some debris remained in a corner. The department said it was removed after Singh's video.

Singh was booked under charges of statements conducting a public mischief and criminal trespass and house-trespass at Gauri Bazar police station. It was lodged by Block Education Officer Vinay Sheel Mishra.

Amravati hospital fire

death around 730 am," said her husband, who was in the fire department. "By then, the staff at the hospital had rescued six babies. Fire extinguishers were used, and the fire brigade also sprayed water, but the smoke did not subside," he said. However relatives alleged that the fire brigade arrived after the fire was put out.

Outside the mortuary, some passers-by consoled Swapnil Borge, but he just nodded. When he looked up, he said: "I saw the NICU catching fire in front of me. I heard a woman scream as I was searching for my baby. I learnt at 7 am that my child is no more. I had thought so much about him. I would buy him a gold ornament, give him a good name. But they ate my son alive."

Intelligence revamp

on July 20, when at least 50,000 young people hit the streets in the heart of Delhi and tried to march on Parliament to press their demand for education reform. Violent clashes followed, and the massive use of teargas and lathis against the protesters was widely criticised.

A senior officer said the Special Branch of the Delhi Police, which deals with intelligence, usually gathers basic details such as the venue of the protest and the expected turnout. The Commissioner has asked the Special Branch for a more "comprehensive and actionable assessment" of the groups organising the protests going forward, sources said.

Specifically, the intelligence wing has been directed to collect and analyse the following 10 details: the profile of participants; state-wise participation; modes of mobilisation; names of leaders and key functionaries; agenda or demands of the protesters; plans of stay and movement; local contacts and linkages; organisational affiliations; sources of funding; logistical arrangements.

Police sources said the directions aimed at improving the preparedness of the police to handle protests and public gatherings, particularly those involving participants from outside Delhi or multiple organisations.

"The emphasis is on collecting information that can help the force assess the law-and-order implications of such gatherings in advance," a source said. A senior officer said field units must provide verified, specific, and usable inputs rather than broad estimates. "The pur-

the incident in the morning and immediately informed the fire department. "By then, the staff at the hospital had rescued six babies. Fire extinguishers were used, and the fire brigade also sprayed water, but the smoke did not subside," he said. However relatives alleged that the fire brigade arrived after the fire was put out.

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pose is to understand not just where a protest is happening, but who is behind it, how people are being mobilised, where they are coming from, and whether there are local support structures," the officer said.

The sources said the Commissioner specifically stressed that the need to keep the radio-communication system fully functional, so it can be used more effectively both during daily policing and major operations. A review of the handling of the protests has identified gaps in communication and coordination, leading to delays in some cases in information from the ground reaching senior officers, they said.

"The Commissioner directed that the wireless communication network be checked comprehensively and any deficiencies be rectified immediately," a source said.

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Jaishankar meets Putin in Russia

sides, Putin credited Modi for giving "personal attention" to the relationship. "Your visit today underscores the level of relations that has long been established between Russia and India, over decades. We continue to work together in virtually all areas. This includes governmental ties, inter-parliamentary ties, and economic cooperation," Putin told Jaishankar.

"I am pleased to note that our trade turnover has increased this year. While it declined slightly last year, it's growing this year, and this is partly, and perhaps primarily, thanks to Prime Minister (Narendra Modi), who is devoting his personal attention to developing Russian-Indian relations," he said.

Identifying trade and economic relations has been intensified as a priority area by both the leaders, who had set a bilateral trade target of US\$100 billion by 2030. Bilateral trade between the two sides touched a record high of US\$68.7 billion in FY 2024-25; it was US\$59.63 billion in FY 2025-26.

At the beginning of our

Real.Courier IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Vam2tRb6RGJOKH6Bd0F>

Govt on Gor remarks

between the two leaders. Trump, however, disregarded this request and took questions from the media.

Facing criticism from the Opposition, government sources said: "Discussions regarding arrangements for public appearances of leaders are normal practice ahead of any VVIP visit. In this regard, the Indian side communicated its stance and practice for such visits. Delegations when meeting the US President are wary about his unpredictable behaviour, as may be seen from his interactions with the President of South Africa, Ukraine etc. Thus, the cautious approach by India."

At a televised meeting in February last year, Trump and US Ambassador to India, Vincent O'Brien, had engaged in a heated argument with Ukraine President Volodymyr Zelenskyy. In May last year, Trump also sought to corner South African President Cyril Ramaphosa on the alleged discrimination against White farmers.

Modi has rarely addressed press conferences with foreign leaders — Trump and former British Prime Minister David Cameron are among the few exceptions. The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) has re-branded the joint media interactions as "media appearances" and "media statements".

This has not gone down well in the western media; in May this year, a Norwegian journalist questioned MEA officials on this during Modi's visit to Oslo for the India-Nordic summit.

Speaking at the Economic Times World Leaders Forum on Saturday, US Ambassador O'Brien said, "The fact that our President and Prime Minister Modi have such a deep and personal friendship makes it a lot easier for me frankly. It is one of those things that you may have seen."

Tough conversion law kicks in this week, Mumbai pastors ask churchgoers to sign form

break the law," he said.

Caution and 'precaution'

For those signing, it is unconstitutional territory. Anita Patel, 55, a resident of Virar, said she has followed Christianity for 16 years and this was the first time she had been asked to declare in writing that she was attending voluntarily.

"Earlier, there was a freedom to choose and believe what we wanted to follow, and nobody questioned us about why we were following a particular faith. It is strange that I have to fill out such a form. It feels as though I no longer have the freedom to follow what I want to," she said. "But it is important considering the current situation and the attacks on prayer meetings, this is perhaps the only way to live."

Robin Alexander, 41, who sings during the service at Holy Sings Church in Virar, called it a precautionary measure. "It is good that we have this form. It is for our protection and to prove that we are coming here of our own free will and are not being forced," he said.

Devdan Tribhuvan, state president of the Maharashtra Christian Development Association, said the forms were introduced as a security measure after people attending prayer meetings began being questioned, threatened, and, in some cases, saw services disrupted. "The allegations of conversion were already being made, so we started taking a simple declaration to make it clear that people were attending the prayer meeting of their own free will. It is purely for security purposes. The forms are not government documents; they are signed by the person and kept with the pastor," he said.

I travelled with President Trump to G7 two months ago in Evian and they brought in the cameras."

He was referring to the meeting between Modi and Trump on June 17, on the sidelines of the G7 leaders summit — their first since Op Sindoor last year. The meeting was highly anticipated as there was frostiness in the ties after Trump's claims that he had brokered the ceasefire between India and Pakistan.

"I will share it as an anecdote. We were behind the scenes, behind the stage, and at one point it was just the President and I. And he asked me what the Indians going to raise. We went over some topics. And he said, 'they have any asks. And MEA had one ask. And let's bring in the media. Let's not do a full press conference, questions. And I told the President, Indians prefer no questions. So he said no problem. The meeting starts, the press comes in. There are 50 cameras. President sitting here,

and taking photographs. Tribhuvan added, because those involved in disruptions are often unidentified when FIRs are registered.

The Bajrang Dal claims it acts within the law. Gautam Ravariya, the outfit's Konkan region co-convenor, said it monitors prayer meetings on social media and informs police rather than acting alone. He acknowledged FIRs had also been registered against its members.

"Four workers are attacked, they will defend themselves. We are not going there either to get beaten or to beat anyone, but self-defence is everyone's right," he said. Ravariya alleged some prayer groups first provide assistance to vulnerable families and then encourage them to convert.

When contacted, Niket Kaushik, Commissioner of the Mira Bhayandar Vasal-Virar Police, whose jurisdiction covers Vasal East, where five of the nine FIRs were registered, said: "There was one local incident in the past few months related to the issue and necessary action was taken. We have not seen any recurring instances to call it a trend."

When asked about the form that churches are asking attendees to fill, he said, "We are unaware of any such consent form."

On July 2, representatives of Mumbai for Peace and 24 civil society organisations met Mumbai Police Joint Commissioner (Law and Order) Manoj Kumar Sharma, seeking preventive action over repeated disruptions. "There is a pattern. People attend prayer meetings, then call in groups of 40 to 60 people. This has been happening repeatedly over the past three to four months," said Dophy D'Souza, spokesperson for the Bombay Catholic Sabha.

On the forms, D'Souza: "We do not know how much they will help, but what options do we have this point? Churches and prayer places are open to everyone — people come to

are among those expected to attend.

Jaishankar is on a two-day visit to Russia (August 23-24). Earlier in the day, he co-chaired the 27th session of the India-Russia Inter-Governmental Commission on Trade, Economic, Scientific, Technological and Cultural Cooperation (IRIGC-TEC) with Manturov.

While the Indian side included India's Ambassador to Russia Vinay Kumar and Joint Secretary, Eurasia Division, Mayank Singh, the Russian side was represented by Manturov, Minister of Foreign Affairs Sergey Lavrov, Deputy Chief of Staff of the Presidential Executive Office Maksim Oreshkin, and Aide to the President of Russia Yury Ushakov.

The India-Russia Inter-Governmental Commission (IGC) has two divisions, one for Trade, Economic, Scientific, Technological and Cultural Cooperation (IRIGC-TEC), co-chaired by Jaishankar and Manturov; and the Military and Technical Cooperation (IRIGC-M&MTC), headed by the defence ministers of the two countries.

Prime Minister sitting there. They both speak for a few minutes. As soon as they get done, the first thing the President does is, looks at the cameras and says any questions? And that opened everything up. And he did a 45-minute press conference, and everything was on the table," Gor said at the event.

Raising Gor's remarks, Congress leader Pawan Khera said in a post on X: "This @MEAIndia comment is revealing because: I suggest that it may be Modi's normal practice to plead with foreign governments not to make him face the media; he pleads, but they don't listen; then they publicly mock him by revealing that they ignored him; and yet, he won't fight back — because he is compromised."

"This is not just about Narendra Modi. It is the office of India's Prime Minister that is being diminished and disrespected. And Modi deserves every bit of condemnation for bringing us to this point," Khera said.

prayer for peace of mind, with friends, or because they have a particular prayer or wish. So, these forms are essentially intended to protect the church's interests."

Making the law clear

Mumbai Police Joint Commissioner (Law and Order) Manoj Kumar Sharma, said, "There have been a few incidents in Mumbai which are under review. Complaints were filed from both sides, we had given warning to those who were disrupting prayers, other-wise Mumbai has been peaceful and no such incidents have occurred recently. Yes, we have received the memorandum from Mumbai for Peace and if any such incidents occur we will take action accordingly, our team is also investigating those complaints."

Church leaders are worried the disruptions may grow once the law takes effect. The legislation criminalises religious conversion brought about through undue influence, threats, misrepresentation, or document or undue influence, and covers conversions allegedly linked to marriage or a promise of marriage. It places the onus on the person facilitating the conversion to establish it was voluntary and prescribes stricter punishment when the alleged conversion involves a minor, woman, member of a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe, or a person of unsound mind. The state notified the law on July 31.

Speaking to *The Indian Express* on the consent form, Fr. Nigel Barrett, spokesperson for the Archdiocese of Bombay, said, "Taking a consent form is a wise precaution... It establishes that people are attending voluntarily and that no one is forcing them to come. Given the current law and the manner in which certain groups, such as the Bajrang Dal, are using these spaces, people are taking precautions to safeguard themselves."

The reopening of the Wandhama massacre is the latest case reopened by the investigating agency. Sources said that it has also reopened the case related to the murder of Tika Lal Taploo.

Taploo was killed on September 13, 1989, and is considered the first targeted killing in the Valley. The 59-year-old Taploo, an advocate by profession, was the BJP's Vice President for Jammu and Kashmir and also a member of the Rash-

OBC creamy layer candidates

incoming batch vis-à-vis subsequent recruitment cycles, it warned.

The government stated that "anecdotal or unqualified application of the ratio of the said judgement, with retrospective effect, to the already-concluded selection process of CSE-2025, would result in a peculiar and acute anomaly amounting to discrimination inter se candidates of the very examination cycle sought to be benefited."

The government move comes ahead of crucial Assembly elections, with anti-reservation protests underway at some places.

The matter traces its origins to a DoPT letter of October 14, 2004, clarifying an Official Memorandum (OM) of September 1993 on the creamy layer criterion for OBCs. The 1993 OM had excluded income from salary and agricultural sources from the income/wealth test status. However, the 2004 clarification said the salary income of employees in public sector undertakings (PSUs) and the private sector would be a criterion.

As per the petitioners, this was "hostile discrimination" between the wards of government servants and those of PSUs or private sector employees.

The 2004 clarification was not implemented effectively until 2014, while the UP government was in power and was making efforts to consolidate OBC support. It began to be applied rigorously from the CSE-2015 (corresponding to the 2016 batch).

Since then, around 100 candidates who possessed caste certificates issued by competent authorities and cleared the CSE have found their OBC claims rejected by the DoPT on the creamy layer ground. Most of them are parties in different petitions before the Supreme Court and various High Courts.

Interestingly, some of these candidates had also been affected in earlier cycles. The implementation could hence lead to revised ranks for some.

In its application, the Centre has urged the Supreme Court to also "clarify / direct that the judgement shall not be applied retrospectively so as to unsettle completed admissions in higher educational institutions, completed academic sessions, degrees already conferred, or settled rights of students".

the CSE process.

On March 11 this year, hearing an appeal by one of the candidates, Rohini Nathani, a Division Bench of Justices P S Narasimha and R Mahadevan ruled that income cannot be the sole criterion for determining the creamy layer among OBCs. The Court said: "The object of excluding the creamy layer is... not to create artificial distinctions between equally placed members of the same social class... unequal treatment of similarly placed OBC candidates would not only be legally erroneous but constitutionally impermissible."

It further held that treating the children of those employed in PSUs or private employment as a creamy layer would not benefit solely on the basis of salary income, without reference to the nature of their posts (Group A, B, C or D), "would certainly lead to hostile discrimination between parties who are similarly placed and would amount to equals being treated unequally, thereby attracting the rigour of the equality doctrine under Articles 14, 15 and 16".

The Supreme Court gave six months time for the implementation of its judgment, which is set to get over on September 11. DoPT sources told *The Indian Express* that the government had been all set to implement the Supreme Court verdict and that verification of documents of all affected candidates had already been completed.

If the March 11 judgment is implemented in full, its benefits would extend not only to candidates appearing in future examinations but also to those affected in earlier cycles. The implementation could hence lead to revised ranks for some.

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J&K reopens probe into 1998 massacre of 23 Kashmiri Pandits

that truth prevails and those responsible are brought to justice."

The massacre dates back to 1998. On the night of January 25-26 in 1998, a militant group wearing army fatigues appeared in Wandhama village in central Kashmir's Ganderbal district.

They engaged in conversation with Kashmiri Pandits and asked them to assemble at one place, before opening fire and killing 23 people, including four children and nine women.

The victims belonged to four families who had stayed back and not migrated from Kashmir when militancy erupted in the Valley in early 1990. They also included five guests who had come from Jammu to visit their relatives in Wandhama.

The police blamed Pakistan-based Lashkar-e-Toiba (LeT) for the massacre. The killings triggered protests by Kashmiri Pandits across Jammu and Kashmir on January 25, 1998, protesters in Delhi marched towards the National Human Rights Commission and clashed with police, leading to injury to nine protestors.

The then Prime Minister, Inder Kumar Gujral, flew to Kashmir and then to Wandhama to join the mourners, accompanied by then Principal Secretary NN Vohra. J&K Chief Minister Farooq Abdullah and Governor K V Krishna Rao.

The police investigation in the case didn't make any significant progress and it was closed.

The reopening of the Wandhama massacre is the latest case reopened by the investigating agency. Sources said that it has also reopened the case related to the murder of Tika Lal Taploo.

Taploo was killed on September 13, 1989, and is considered the first targeted killing in the Valley. The 59-year-old Taploo, an advocate by profession, was the BJP's Vice President for Jammu and Kashmir and also a member of the Rash-

triyas Swamyasevak Sangh (RSS).

Over the last three years, the investigating agency has reopened several cases related to the killings of the Kashmiri Pandits. In 2023, the agency reopened the case of Neelkanth Ganjoo. A retired judge, Ganjoo was killed on November 4, 1989, in Srinagar. He is believed to have been targeted as he had sentenced Jammu and Kashmir Liberation Front founder Maqbool Bhat to death in 1968. Bhat was finally hanged in 1984 and buried inside Tihar Jail.

In August, 2025, the SIA reopened the case of Sarla Bhat, a Kashmiri Pandit nurse working at the Sher-e-Kashmir Institute of Medical Sciences (SKIMS) in Srinagar. She was abducted by terrorists from her hostel on April 18, 1990, and her body was found the next day with multiple bullet wounds.

While there has not been much progress in Ganjoo's case, the SIA has filed a chargesheet in the killing of Bhat and sentenced Jammu and Kashmir Liberation Front founder Maqbool Bhat to death in 1968. Bhat was finally hanged in 1984 and buried inside Tihar Jail.

In 2017, the Supreme Court had dismissed a petition by Roots in Kashmir, a Kashmiri Hindu organisation, to re-open and investigate the killing of Kashmiri Pandits in the Valley. A bench comprising the then Chief Justice, J S Khehar and Justice D V Chandrachud had said that with nearly three decades having passed since the Pandit exodus from the Valley, evidence "is unlikely to be available".

The petition had sought "transfer of all the FIRs/cases pertaining to the killing of Kashmiri Pandits" by militants since the inception of insurgency out of J&K, and their handling by "some other independent investigating agency like the CBI or NIA".

A curative petition filed by Roots of Kashmir was also dismissed by the apex court in 2022.

Seven months after the petition was dismissed, the SIA opened the first case, of Ganjoo.

STUDENTS SAY 8 DEATHS BY SUICIDE SINCE 2023, RAGE AT DEANS, DEMAND COMPENSATION

'We are here after eight deaths': Rare protest at IIT Delhi as student's suicide sparks anger

Pragynesh
New Delhi, August 24

AT 9 a.m. on Monday, students began gathering near the Lecture Hall Complex at the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Delhi. By evening, nearly 300 of them had moved to the first-floor lobby of the institute's main building, outside the director's office, demanding accountability.

For a campus where student protests are an unusual sight, the mobilisation was striking.

The protest came two days after a 31-year-old MSc Physics student, Rishikesh, died allegedly by suicide after jumping from the sixth floor of a building on the campus. Students said his death was the eighth suicide at the institute since 2023, and demanded the resignation of a Dean and Associate Deans, along with an independent inquiry and compensation for his family.

"We aren't here after one sui-

cide. Not after two. We are here after eight. How is it not enough for them?" a student said.

The morning began around the Lecture Hall Complex, where students gathered and discussed their demands. Among them were the resignation of Professor Sreedevi Upadhyaya, Associate Dean of Student Welfare, an inquiry into the deaths, and Rs 1 crore in compensation for Rishikesh's family.

After a brief silence in memory of Rishikesh, students began talking about what they described as a pattern of "administrative indifference." "Rishikesh had taken a semester-long withdrawal after his father's death earlier this year because of mental health difficulties. He underwent treatment for more than a month," a student said.

"When he returned to the hostel in late July, however, his name had been removed from the hostel rolls because of



The students' protest on Monday. EXPRESS

his withdrawal," another student said.

Students alleged that despite fitness clearances from the hospitals where he had been treated, Rishikesh was asked to obtain another clearance from the IIT Delhi hostel before he could be allotted a room. "He was eventually forced to stay in rented accommodation outside the campus with his mother," a

student said.

"Whenever we try to talk about problems, they tell us, 'You should leave if you can't cope.' They have a lack of empathy," another student said, while protesting.

The administration had cancelled all classes on Monday as the protest gathered momentum. By late afternoon, the centre of the demonstration had

shifted from the Lecture Hall Complex to the main building.

By 5 p.m., the first-floor lobby outside IIT Delhi Director Rangan Banerjee's office had become the heart of the protest. Around 300 students had gathered there. Banerjee had already received the students' list of demands and was meeting representatives, along with Professor Sreedevi.

At about 5:30 p.m., Banerjee emerged from his office. The students cheered.

He announced that an inquiry committee would be constituted. But he also said that Professor Sreedevi would not resign at that point.

The cheers quickly turned into hoots. Professor Sreedevi was escorted out through a back entrance of the building. "If she can't face us, how will she solve our problems?" one student asked.

Another student said: "If we lose a credit, we are punished. Why is she not being punished?"

Restoration, upkeep in focus: Govt to divide 1.3-km stretch at Chandni Chowk into five parts

Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, August 24

THE DELHI government has decided to divide a 1.3-km road stretch from Lal Jain Mandir to Fatehpuri Mosque in Chandni Chowk into five parts, officials said, adding that the aim is to protect the heritage market by ensuring cleanliness and maintenance of the area. The stretch was developed and opened to the public in 2021, but the redevelopment and beautification started wearing off following the

multiplicity of departments.

"A contract to maintain the stretch was given to a private company for three years during the tenure of the previous (AAP) government. However, due to the internal tussle between the Municipal Corporation of Delhi and Public Works Department, the contract was not renewed — after which the revamped stretch ran into problems with poor sanitation,

paan stains and garbage everywhere," said a senior official. Officials said that the BJP-

led government has now decided to divide the road into five stretches, and restore and maintain the cross roads as well.

The estimated cost of the project is Rs 34 crore. The first stretch runs from Lal Jain Mandir to Esplanade Road T-Point. The second runs from Esplanade Road T-Point to Sis Ganj Sahib Gurdwara. The third stretch runs from Fountain Chowk and ends at Town Hall Crossing. The fourth runs from Town Hall to Ballimaran, while the fifth begins at Ballimaran

and ends at Fatehpuri Mosque.

Under the proposed plan, the PWD has invited tenders to appoint a private firm for the complete upkeep and maintenance of the stretches for a period of three years.

The plan proposes to clean approximately 55,000 sqm of roads, footpaths, vendor zones and paved areas. Deployment of security guards, sweeping of roads and footpaths, garbage removal, washing of kerbs and railings, and upkeep of public assets are part of the plan.

71-yr-old pedestrian killed in GK area car hits multiple vehicles



The mangled car. EXPRESS

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 24

A 71-YEAR-OLD woman was killed after a car allegedly hit multiple vehicles before striking her and her husband in South Delhi's Greater Kailash on Sunday. The driver has been arrested.

According to police, a PCR call regarding the road accident was received on August 23. A police team reached the spot and found that the driver of a Mahindra XEV 9e had allegedly collided with several vehicles before hitting the pedestrian couple near Kailash Metro Station.

The couple, Shashi and her husband Kulbushan, 65, were rushed to Moolchand Hospital. Shashi was declared dead on arrival by doctors. Kulbushan, who had initially sustained injuries, was subsequently declared fit to make a statement.

The accused was identified as Tapan Ahir, 59. According to police, he has been working as a driver for the same vehicle owner since 1997. At the time of the accident, he was allegedly

on his way to Kailash Colony Market to pick up his brother. Police have booked Ahir for rash driving, act endangering life or personal safety of others and causing death by rash and negligent driving of vehicle.

Shashi was a retired Central Public Works Department official, while her husband Kulbushan is former Punjab National Bank official.

Shashi's niece, Charu, said that couple had gone to the dentist in the morning. "When I came to the hospital, my uncle's face was disfigured. My aunt is no more. And this happened not because they were speeding, or even driving. They were just walking," she said.

Police said the offending vehicle also damaged a Mahindra Thar, an autorickshaw and a cycle-rickshaw.

Police have seized the offending vehicle. A blood sample of the accused driver has also been sent to the Forensic Science Laboratory to determine whether he was driving under the influence of alcohol.

Police said further investigation is underway.

CJP's Saurav address 'shared online': HC seeks replies from portals

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, August 24

THE DELHI High Court Monday issued summons to digital media portals, social media intermediaries and political commentator Abhijit Iyer-Mitra over allegations that he had lent the privacy of Cuckooch Janta Party (CJP) spokesperson Saurav Das by circulating his residential address.

Das, in his civil suit, has sought damages.

Senior advocate Akhil Sibal, appearing for Das, told Justice Sachin Datta that some of the posts cited in the suit, which disclosed Das' residential address, had already been taken down by X Corp. He urged the court to ensure that they were not restored.

Justice Datta, without passing any orders, directed the defendant parties to file their replies in 10 days.

The Pamphlet, a digital media channel on YouTube and one of the defendant parties, represented by advocate Abhinav Chandrachud, told the court that their Twitter (X Corp) posts, which Das has objected to, are no longer available.

Sibal, on the other hand, pointed out that "personnel" of The Pamphlet had entered the property in New Delhi where Das lives "without consent and had then put up a video" of the residence. Sibal added that Iyer-Mitra had relied on this video "to add to it".

Das has sought an injunction against the circulation of his private details, such as his residential address, along with taking down personal information that continues to remain in the public domain.

His suit states that owing to his journalistic work and political engagement, he has been "subjected to violent threats and targeted hostility" in the past. Das said repeated disclosure and amplification of his precise residential address "creates a real and foreseeable risk of his being subjected to violence at and around his home."

He added that such disclosure also places the other occupants of the premises at risk, and has caused him "grave and continuing apprehension for his safety and security."

Earlier this month, he had filed a police complaint in this matter.

Lawyers object to biometric attendance

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, August 24

AFTER THE Delhi government's move making biometric attendance compulsory did not go down well with several officials, prosecutors in the Capital last week approached the High Court challenging circulars of the Directorate of Prosecution (DoP) making Aadhaar Enabled Biometric Attendance System (AEBAS) mandatory without allegedly taking the "peculiar nature" of their duties into account.

Prosecutors are qualified advocates appointed by the Central or state governments to conduct criminal cases on behalf of the State. Around 300 prosecutors are part of the Delhi Prosecutors Welfare Association (DPWA).

On August 17, Justice Swarana Kanta Sharma disposed of a plea by the DPWA with a direction to the Centre and the Delhi government to consider their plea before the court as a representation and decide the same within four weeks, while giving an opportunity of hearing to the association.

The DPWA, through its secretary Rajesh Kumar, had moved the HC challenging circulars dated July 16 and July 21 by the DoP. The July 16 circular

notified that AEBAS was made applicable for public prosecutors, while the July 21 circular made AEBAS mandatory for all public prosecutors, additional public prosecutors and assistant public prosecutors serving under the DoP. This mandate, the association says, ignores the peculiar nature of prosecutorial duties and the functioning of Criminal Courts.

Following the circulars, the Home department had directed implementation of AEBAS in district offices and court complexes on July 24 and 31, and also on August 3.

Contending that the system is "impractical having regard to the nature of their duties and that their presence is otherwise reflected in the court records and proceedings", the DPWA sought before the court that the two circulars be quashed, or the implementation of the circulars be kept in abeyance while a "practical and court-centric attendance mechanism" be devised for public prosecutors.

Stating that the circulars were unreasonable, DPWA flagged that mandatory biometric attendance has put "unnecessary administrative burden upon an already overburdened prosecutorial service".

SAVITRIBAI PHULE PUNE UNIVERSITY
(Formerly University of Pune)

APPOINTMENT OF ASSISTANT LAW OFFICER POST
Savitribai Phule Pune University is inviting online applications from eligible candidates to fill the post of Assistant Law Officer (Group B) in the Legal Cell from the university fund for a fixed period on contract basis. All details regarding qualifications and other related information is available on the University website.

http://admin.unipune.ac.in/recruitment.
Applications are open from 27/08/2026 to 16/09/2026.
Advt. No.: 18 [Prof.(Dr.) Prafulla Pawar]
Date: 25/08/2026. Offg. Registrar

COEP Technological University Pune
(Formerly College of Engineering Pune)
Shivajinagar, Pune-411005.
Ph: (020) 25507009, FAX: (020) 25507299 Web: www.coep.ac.in

Admission Notification for COEP Technological University level ACAP (SPOT) Round
It is notified to all aspiring candidates that COEP Technological University level ACAP (SPOT) Round for Admission to First Year B.Tech. Programmes, Direct Second Year B.Tech., Direct Second Year B.Tech. Programmes for Working Professionals, First Year of B.A. Planning, First Year of M.B.A. Programmes will be conducted for seats remaining vacant after the last date of reporting of last CAP round and till the cut-off date as notified by the State CET-CELL, Mumbai for the current Academic Year 2026-27.

Applications are invited for ACAP (SPOT) Round at COEP Technological University, Pune, for AY 2026-27. Detailed notification and link for application form is available on COEP Tech. website: <https://www.coep.ac.in/admissions/>

Date: 25/08/2026

sd/-
RegistrarSBI
State Bank of India
Central Recruitment & Promotion Department
Corporate Centre, Mumbai
Phone: 022-22820427RECRUITMENT OF JUNIOR ASSOCIATES
(CUSTOMER SUPPORT & SALES)
IN CLERICAL CADRE IN STATE BANK OF INDIA (SBI)

Applications are invited from eligible Indian citizens for appointment as Junior Associates (Customer Support & Sales) in State Bank of India on regular basis.

NUMBER OF VACANCIES:
REGULAR: 7680 • BACKLOG: 287

Eligibility criteria (age, qualification, etc.), requisite fees and other details, along with the link for online submission of applications and online payment of fee, are available on Bank's website <https://sbi.bank.in/web/careers/current-openings> under Advertisement No. CRPD/CR/2026-27/17. Candidates are advised to go through the detailed advertisement and ensure their eligibility and other details before applying and remitting fees.

DATE FOR FILING ONLINE APPLICATION & PAYMENT OF FEES:
11.08.2026 TO 31.08.2026.

For any query, please write to us through link "CONTACT US" — "Post Your Query" which is available on Bank's website <https://sbi.bank.in/web/careers/current-openings>

Place: Mumbai
Date: 11.08.2026
General Manager (RP&PM)

भारतीय कंटेनर निगम लिमिटेड
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.
भारत सरकार का नगरपालिका : A Navratna Undertaking of Govt. of India
C-3, Mathura Road, Opp. Apollo Hospital, New Delhi-110076INDICATIVE RECRUITMENT NOTICE
(Employment Notification No. 05/2026)

Container Corporation of India Limited (CONCOR), a "Navratna" CPSE under the administrative control of Ministry of Railways, Govt. of India, invites applications through ONLINE Mode for recruitment to the following posts in Executive and Supervisory cadre, as per details given below:

Sl. No.	Name of Post / Pay-scale
1.	Management Trainee (C&O) / ₹ 50,000-3%- 1,60,000
2.	Management Trainee (Accounts) / ₹ 50,000-3%- 1,60,000
3.	Management Trainee (Accounts)/Compliance / ₹50,000-3%- 1,60,000
4.	Management Trainee (Technical) / ₹ 50,000-3%- 1,60,000
5.	Management Trainee (MS) / ₹ 50,000-3%- 1,60,000
6.	Management Trainee (Civil) / ₹ 50,000-3%- 1,60,000
7.	Management Trainee (P&A) / ₹ 50,000-3%- 1,60,000
8.	Assistant Officer (C&O) / ₹ 40,000-3%- 1,36,000
9.	Assistant Officer (Accounts) / ₹ 40,000-3%- 1,36,000
10.	Assistant Officer (Technical) / ₹ 40,000-3%- 1,36,000
11.	Assistant Officer (MS) / ₹ 40,000-3%- 1,36,000
12.	Assistant Officer (Civil) / ₹ 40,000-3%- 1,36,000
**Backlog Vacancies	

ONLINE Registration/submitting of application will be from 31.08.2026, 10:00 AM and closing (last) date will be 30.09.2026 upto 11:55 PM. Interested candidates may visit CONCOR's website <http://www.concor.co.in> and HR & Career Section for details and Result, for further details viz. qualification, experience, age relaxation, pay-scale, general instructions, etc. Further, corrigendum, if any, or any other notice shall be published on CONCOR website only.

Nearly 33L electors in Capital to get notices to prove eligibility as SIR enters next phase

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, August 24

STARTING AUGUST 31, 33 lakh electors in Delhi are set to get notices to prove their eligibility as the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) enters the next phase, sources involved in the exercise told *The Indian Express*.

Those getting the notice will be asked to furnish one of the 13 documents listed by the Election Commission (EC), which includes birth certificate, passport, caste certificate and a permanent residence certificate.

These are 34% of the roughly 97 lakh electors who had submitted their forms in the enumeration phase of the SIR while the booth level officers (BLOs) conducted door-to-door visits. After the visits, the BLOs upload these enumeration forms on the Election Commission's portal.

The office of the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) also announced the completion of the rationalisation of polling stations in the Capital on Monday. Polling stations have been increased from 13,033 to 14,947 to ensure that each polling station has roughly 1,200 electors each.

When the exercise started in June, Delhi had 1.45 crore names on its electoral rolls. Forms of around 47 lakh electors were marked uncollectible — a category that includes people who are absent, have shifted, have died, have duplicate entries, or fall under 'Other' reasons and will not find a place in the electoral roll set to be published on August 31.

Out of the 33 lakh electors, who will be on the draft electoral rolls but are set to get notices, around 14 lakh are expected to get notices because their details

could not be linked to the 2002 SIR roll, said sources.

Nineteen lakh notices are set to be sent out due to anomalies found in the enumeration forms. These anomalies include the name of the electors in the current electoral roll not matching with the name in the last intensive revision roll; less than 15 year age gap between elector and parent; more than 50 year age gap between elector and parent; less than 9 month gap between birth date of siblings, among other reasons.

The notice phase for disposal of claims and objection phase will last from August 31 to October 29. The final electoral rolls will be published on November 1.

The Electoral Registration Officer (ERO) — usually a subdivisional magistrate who is senior to the BLO — may ask for additional documents if not satisfied about the electors' age (must be above 18) or citizenship (only Indian citizens are eligible to vote).

An Aadhaar Card alone is not enough. It is the only document in the list that, by itself, will not suffice to prove eligibility. The EC has said. It must be accompanied by another document from the list that establishes the electors' age and citizenship.

For those born in India before July 1, 1987, the EC requires a document proving date and/or place of birth. For those born between July 1, 1987, and December 2, 2004, the EC requires a document for the elector and one parent. For those born after December 2, 2004, the EC requires documents for the elector and both parents. These categories follow the requirements under the Citizenship Act, 1955.

Gautam Buddha University
(Established by the Uttar Pradesh Gautam Buddha University Act, 2002
UP Act No. 9 of 2002, passed by the Uttar Pradesh Legislature)
Greater Noida Gautam Buddha Nagar- 201312 (U.P.)

Advertisement No.: GBU/Admn./2026/08 Dated 25 Aug 2026
The Gautam Buddha University invites applications for the following posts:

- Director AI Centre of Excellence (AI-COE)
- System Administrator (AI Centre)

for a fix tenure from Indian Citizens. Interested candidates are advised to visit University website (www.gbu.ac.in) for details, information regarding eligibility criteria, pay, prescribed form, any update/corrigendum/modification etc. The applicant may send their application in the prescribed format through Speed Post Registered Post/Courier only to "The Registrar, Gautam Buddha University, Greater Noida Gautam Buddha Nagar-201312 U.P. (India). The duly filled application form must reach on or before 16th September, 2026 upto 5.30 p.m.

Registrar

ITM Vocational University TM
A UGC Recognized Listed Private University u/s 2(f) of UGC Act 1956, established vide Gujarat Private Universities Act 2009, Amendment Act No. 1 of 2014, accredited by NAAC & Member - Association of Indian Universities

Appointment for the position of the Provost
ITM Vocational University, Vadodra has constituted a committee under section 15(1) of the Gujarat Private Universities Act, to recommend a panel of suitable persons for appointment as the Provost of the University. The tenure for the post of the Provost is 3 (three) years. The applications as per the UGC format, along with resume of the applicant (in triplicates), name of referees, details of relevant academic research, administrative experience, a brief note not exceeding 500 words on "why the applicant considers himself/suitable for the position" and three copies of recent passport size photograph of the applicant, should reach the address indicated below by speed post/courier superscribing the name of the post on the envelope or e-mail the same on - careers@itm.edu. Selection by the committee may not be limited to the applications received in response to this advertisement and the committee reserves the right to consider any other eligible persons or to invite such other names as it considers appropriate from higher educational institutions of repute. Please send your application and detail resume to careers@itm.edu within 15 days from the date of advertisement.

Prof. RSS Mani
(Convener-Search Committee)
ITM Corporate Office: 1001, 10th Floor, Platinum Techno Park,
Plot No-17-A, Bhagwan Mahaveer Rd, Sector 18, Vashi, Navi Mumbai,
Maharashtra 400703.

भारतीय कंटेनर निगम लिमिटेड
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C-3, Mathura Road, Opp. Apollo Hospital, New Delhi-110076

INDICATIVE RECRUITMENT NOTICE
(Employment Notification No. 05/2026)

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Sl. No.	Name of Post / Pay-scale	SC	ST	OBC-NCL	EWS	UR	Total	Age Limit
1.	Management Trainee (C&O) / ₹ 50,000-3%-1,60,000	04	03	04	02	12	25	18-28 years
2.	Management Trainee (Accounts) / ₹ 50,000-3%-1,60,000	01	01**	03	-	04	09*	18-28 years
3.	Management Trainee (Accounts)/Compliance / ₹ 50,000-3%-1,60,000	-	-	-	-	-	-	18-28 years
4.	Management Trainee (Technical) / ₹ 50,000-3%-1,60,000	01	-	01	-	02	04	18-28 years
5.	Management Trainee (MS) / ₹ 50,000-3%-1,60,000	01	-	01**	-	01	03	18-28 years
6.	Management Trainee (Civil) / ₹ 50,000-3%-1,60,000	-	-	01	-	01	02	18-28 years
7.	Management Trainee (P&A) / ₹ 50,000-3%-1,60,000	-	-	-	-	02	02	18-28 years
8.	Assistant Officer (C&O) / ₹ 40,000-3%-1,36,000	03	02	05	01	09	20	18-32 years
9.	Assistant Officer (Accounts) / ₹ 40,000-3%-1,36,000	-	-	01	-	01	02	18-32 years
10.	Assistant Officer (Technical) / ₹ 40,000-3%-1,36,000	01	-	01	-	02	04	18-32 years
11.	Assistant Officer (MS) / ₹ 40,000-3%-1,36,000	-	-	01	-	01	02	18-32 years
12.	Assistant Officer (Civil) / ₹ 40,000-3%-1,36,000	01	-	01	-	02	04	18-32 years
*Backlog Vacancies								
Total 77								

ONLINE Registration/submitting of application will be from 31.08.2026, 10:00 AM and closing (last) date will be 30.09.2026 upto 11:55 PM. Interested candidates may visit CONCOR's website <http://www.concor.co.in> and HR & Career Section for details and Result, for further details viz. qualification, experience, age relaxation, pay-scale

Another rainy day, same old story



Schools, shops hit, Capital sees massive waterlogging & snarls

Sophiya Mathew & Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, August 24

SCHOOLGIRLS WADING through waist-deep murky water, holding onto each other for balance, and pushing a stalled white school van at an inundated neighborhood road — this is how the morning started in Southeast Delhi's Sangam Vihar on Monday for some students.

Just down the road, at the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) primary school in Deoli, which caters to nearly 800 children across two shifts, chaotic scenes unfolded as the morning bell rang. While teachers and staff reported for duty, classes had to be abruptly called off after heavy downpour submerged the school ground under deep, muddy water that did not recede even by late evening.

Across Delhi-NCR, heavy rain triggered widespread disruption, waterlogging and traffic jams, causing inconvenience to residents and commuters. At Safdarjung base station in the Capital, 34.6 mm of rain was reported between 8:30 am and 8:30 pm. According to IMD officials, Jankapuri and Anagar recorded the highest rainfall at 70 mm and 66 mm, respectively.

Road caves in, parts of city flooded

Speaking to *The Indian Express* on the flooding of the ground, a senior official at the Deoli school on condition of anonymity said, "During the monsoon, this happens at least twice or thrice a month." He attributed this to a maintenance-related issue of the school's rain water harvesting system.

The surrounding belt of Durga Vihar, Deoli, and Sangam Vihar also saw pervasive flooding, engulfing narrow alleyways. At Main Market Durga Vihar and A-block basement commercial shops remained shut with water accumulating at doorsteps, while on Ashoka Avenue and Raju Park in C Block, residents struggled to drive through the narrow streets.

"I have lived here for 50 years, and the neglect remains the same," said Shanti (70), a resident of Raju Park.

Earlier this month, residents had to pool their own money to lay a drainage pipe because repeated appeals to departments yielded no progress. Just recently, a small child fell into an open drain and was about to drown before a passerby pulled him out.

In C Block, Deoli, Pahadi Road, a section of the road caved in amid the downpour, prompting Delhi Jal Board (DJB) to

rush for emergency repairs. In Deoli village, resident Jagdish Anand alleged that house walls have developed cracks due to delayed sewer excavations.

The recurrent flooding in Sangam Vihar and adjoining settlements stems from several reasons. DJB in multiple submissions previously informed the National Green Tribunal (NGT) that sewer laying across parts of Sangam Vihar face severe delays.

Key bottlenecks include forest-land restrictions requiring clearances from the Ridge Management Board, pending road-cutting permissions, and local encroachments. While peripheral trunk sewers exist along main arterial routes, internal feeder connectivity lags, with deadlines in several pockets pushed to 2027. The resulting mix of sewage and stormwater regularly chokes natural outflow. As per officials, ongoing Phase-IV Delhi Metro construction work near Salnik Farms has also temporarily disrupted local drainage, with construction barricades trapping runoff and triggering severe waterlogging and vehicular logjams at the Deoli MCD intersection.

Dejavu at Sadar Bazar

In Central Delhi's wholesale hub of Sadar Bazar, scenes were

eerily reminiscent of last month's inundation. Along the Qutub Road-Telivara Akhara stretch, porters submerged waist-deep hauled heavy commercial goods on their heads and backs to dry ground, while shopkeepers frantically bailed water out of flooded basements.

MCD officials noted that Sadar Bazar relies on an aging combined drainage system with limited capacity.

Responding to the citywide waterlogging, Public Works Department (PWD) officials said intensive pre-monsoon preparedness and field monitoring have helped reduce critical waterlogging spots across Delhi from 194 to 65, and recurrent locations from 53 down to 20.

To clear the accumulated water, Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) deployed one de-watering pump, PWD positioned two to three pumps near Azadpur Market Chowk, and the MCD pressed a tractor-mounted pump alongside a diesel unit provided to the RWA. Iron safety cones were placed over three open manholes at Telivara to prevent accidents, with joint field inspections scheduled with PWD consultants to integrate the stretch into Phase I of the comprehensive drainage master plan.



School children waded through a flooded street in Sangam Vihar in New Delhi; (above) fleet of school buses stuck at a waterlogged stretch near Gurgaon's Subhash Chowk on Monday.

• Skywatch

Forecast: August 25, 2026
Generally cloudy sky. Very light to light rain.

MAX: 34-36

1.9°C above normal

MIN: 25-27

1.4°C above normal

• Sunrise: 5:56 AM (August 26)

• Sunset: 6:51 PM (August 26)

• Moonrise: 5:16 PM (August 25)

• Moonset: 3:56 AM (August 26)

• AQI Tracker

Anand Vihar
Poor
AQI: 254

Rohini
Moderate
AQI: 118

Pusa
Moderate
AQI: 123

Najafgarh
Satisfactory
AQI: 77

● Good (0-50)

● Satisfactory (51-100)

● Moderate (101-200)

● Poor (201-300)

● Very Poor (301-400)

● Severe (401-500)

At least 12 school buses go under in Gurgaon, children stranded for hours

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurgaon, August 24

AT LEAST 12 school buses stuck on a stretch near Subhash Chowk for more than two hours, forcing parents and children to wade through knee-deep water; traffic jams and waterlogging across key parts of the city and safety hazards due to what residents attributed to loose electric wires on poles and in meters — these were the scenes that Gurgaon witnessed as 52 mm of rain between 8 am and 5 pm halted business as usual.

The gridlocks caused by the downpour prompted the district administration to issue a work-from-home advisory for private offices on Tuesday. Schools have been advised to hold online classes.

Meetu Gupta, a resident of Uniwold Gardens Society in Sector 47, said she waded through a water-logged area for around 20 minutes to reach Rail Vihar where her daughter, a Class 12 student, was stranded in a school bus for nearly one-and-a-half hours. Her daughter, a student of Heritage Experiential Learning School in Sector 62, was among a large number of schoolchildren stranded as a dozen school buses were unable to navigate the inundated corridor.

The other buses stuck included those of Suncity School; Delhi Public School Sushant Lok; Shikshantar School; and GD Goenka Public School. Gupta stepped out of the society with another parent and brought back eight students with them when they realised that the buses were stuck.

"One of the buses had broken down, which is why others were not able to move. Students were stranded without food. My daughter was exhausted and had body pain," Gupta said, adding, "I and another parent took 7-8 children, who are my daughter's friends, and were willing to come to our society. Many other students were stuck till nearly 6 pm. It was so concerning, given

the ongoing Metro construction work. What was sad was there seemed to be no police deployment, despite the Sadar station close by."

Upscale areas flooded

Several upscale areas were inundated, including Golf Course Road, Artemis Road, and the internal roads of Sector 52, 45 and 55, the roads around Galleria and Super Mart, apart from the usual hotspot of Sheela Mata Road.

Municipal Corporation of Gurgaon Commissioner Pradeep Dahiya said a 300-to-400-metre cross-section drain near Medanta is yet to be constructed by the Gurgaon Metropolitan Development Authority (GMDA), leaving the stretch vulnerable. "However, given the heavy 75 mm rain received in a couple of hours, the water did subside speedily. A place remains a pain point if water doesn't drain," he said, pointing to Narsinghpur as being a previous waterlogging hotspot that was clear this time.

Dahiya, along with MCG and GMDA officials visited Subhash Chowk at 10 pm, and gave instructions to the officers to work towards solutions for waterlogging in the area.

When contacted, GMDA officials said their on-ground teams cleared accumulated water from all main road stretches and undertook drain-irrigation inlet cleaning to prevent further water accumulation. "Traffic movement soon returned to normal," a GMDA spokesperson claimed.

However, snarls were observed throughout the day across the Delhi-Gurgaon Expressway and Sohna Road.

Meanwhile, in DLF Phases 1 and 2, tree feelings were reported. "Many electricity meters on poles Outside House at Arjun Marg (Phase I) are open. During the rainy season, if due to small sparks or loose connections, they catch fire. It can cause a big mishap," Deepak Bajaj, a resident of Arjun Marg said.

EXPRESS special

'Your account funded Naresh Goyal': Couple loses life savings in digital arrest scam

Pragnesh
New Delhi, August 24

ON THE afternoon of April 17, a retired Armyman was settling in for a siesta at his home in South-West Delhi's Munirka when the headline in the hall rang. "You have not paid your electricity bill. Call this number or the connection will be cut," the caller said. He gave the 78-year-old man a number before hanging up. The man thought it was odd since he had already paid his bill. He and his wife lived alone.

Their two daughters were married and settled in Dubai. Unsure whom to check with, he thought of his children but decided it would be pointless to make an international call over something so trivial.

So, he called the number. It was the beginning of a 48-hour digital arrest in which the couple would be harassed, cornered, isolated and finally coerced into handing over their entire savings: Rs 15.5 lakh to men posing as CBI officers using an old trick — the Jet Airways founder Naresh Goyal case.

The call from Mumbai

Police said from the retired Armyman called the number, a voice told him that his name had surfaced in a money laundering case involving Goyal.

"We have found that you gave your account details to Goyal, and all his money was sent to foreign accounts through your account," he was told, according to police officers. The retired Armyman said he

• HIGH-VALUE SCAMS OF 2026

JAN: The biggest cybercrime of 2026 in Delhi, till May 2026, involved a Rs 14-crore digital arrest of an octogenarian — Om Tanuja, 81, and Indira, 77 — living in Greater Kailash.

JAN: A 70-year-old woman was duped of over Rs 7 crore in Delhi's Greater Kailash after a week-long "digital arrest" by

scammers posing as ED officials. **APRIL:** 76-year-old woman from Alaknanda in South Delhi was contacted by scammers claiming to be from Mumbai Police and the ED. They told her that her accounts had been used to fund the terrorist who carried out the Pahalgam attacks last year. She lost over Rs 43 lakh.

had no idea anything like this had happened. He then received a video call from a CBI official in Mumbai.

"A man appeared on screen, claiming to be DCP Anil Kumar from the CBI. He had a fake CBI office set up behind him, complete with a large emblem on the wall, and was wearing a uniform. He and another man, who he called SI Vijay, told the victim that he had been charged under the Foreign Exchange Management Act and Money Laundering Act," said a police officer.

Police said that when the victim pleaded innocence, the men sent him photographs of places around his house — including the entrance to his society and a glass office building metres from his home.

"They told him that a team was in Delhi to arrest him unless he cooperated, and that was why they were sending these pictures. But the two men had downloaded the photographs from Google, said an investigating officer. The couple were now

under digital arrest. Police said they were sent a fake notice from the Enforcement Directorate and asked to share their KYC details and medical records to 'DCP Anil' while remaining on video call.

On April 18, police said, the scammers claimed to have good news. "We have moved court for your anticipatory bail. But now your money needs to be verified. We will give you an RBI account number. You transfer whatever you have in it. The RBI will return it post verification," the men told the victim, as per police. The victim transferred Rs 15.5 lakh, and was sent a 'bail order' from the Bombay High Court. The call was then cut. "When his money didn't come back after two days of him constantly calling the scammers, he came to the police," said the officer. A case was registered.

Targeting the elderly

Officers said the spike in crimes against the elderly began in the new decade as families

became more nuclear.

As per an officer, almost every month in 2026, they have been seeing at least two to three major cyber frauds targeting elderly people. "The problem is even more severe in upscale localities. Scammers and robbers know that many of the people here are affluent, and their children are either in high-stakes jobs that keep them busy or they are in foreign countries," said the officer.

The latest National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) data backs the trend of crimes against senior citizens, with Delhi reporting more such cases than any other metro city in India. As per the data, crimes against senior citizens in Delhi dipped marginally, from 1,361 cases in 2023 to 1,267 in 2024. The city, however, continued to top the list among metropolitan cities. The 1,267 cases accounted for just over 30% of the 4,107 crimes against senior citizens reported in metropolitan cities. And the retired Armyman's case is among the high-profile digital arrest cases registered in Delhi this year. (see box)

Following the money

During their probe, police traced the Rs 15.50 lakh transferred by the victim to a current account in Ludhiana belonging to a man named Sarbjit, 38. Police picked up Sarbjit for questioning. He allegedly told investigators that he had handed over the account to cyber fraudsters through an intermediary. That intermediary,

police said, was Suraj (30).

Suraj allegedly told investigators that he had been introduced to another man, Naresh alias Lucky, through Telegram and had ultimately passed the account and its banking kit to him. The trail then led investigators to Jaipur. Police said Sarbjit, Suraj and a third man, a bank official named Sandeep, travelled to Jaipur to hand over the account kit to Naresh.

Sandeep (32) allegedly used his banking-sector contacts and knowledge to facilitate the procurement of current accounts. Police suspect these accounts were then passed through several intermediaries before reaching cyber-fraud operators based abroad.

All three were arrested, and a police team subsequently nabbed Naresh from Rajasthan. During questioning, police said he allegedly admitted that he procured current accounts from Suraj through Telegram and supplied them to cyber-fraud operators based in Cambodia and the UAE.

This, police said, revealed the wider structure of the network — people willing to provide bank accounts for commissions, intermediaries who collect and transfer the accounts, and overseas operators who used them to receive proceeds of cyber fraud. Police, however, are yet to recover the money. Police said the current account was allegedly linked to 17 complaints involving fraudulent transactions running into crores.

Two days on, boy who fell into drain remains untraced; MCD engineer suspended

Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, August 24

A JUNIOR engineer with the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) was suspended Monday for "dereliction of duty" two days after a 15-year-old fell into an open drain in South East Delhi's Jasola on Saturday, as the boy could not be traced even on the second day of the search operation.

The boy, Mithun Kumar, had fallen into the drain on Saturday morning while chasing a kite. Search operations were conducted through Sunday and Monday.

Mithun is a Class 8 student. His father, Awadhesh, is a migrant from Badaun in Uttar Pradesh and works as a labourer in Delhi. On Sunday, a heart-breaking video clip surfaced as Awadhesh, in a desperate bid to save his son, entered the drain.

He said on Monday that the family had lost hope of their son being found alive. "We know we won't find our child safe and sound. We are just hoping to get his body so our hearts can find some peace," the father said. His wife, Anitha, was inconsolable.

"It has been two days, and I haven't seen his face. He is a very good boy. He used to even correct his teachers if they got their questions wrong," the grieving mother said.

The MCD issued the order suspending one of its junior engineers on Monday evening. The Chief Minister's Office stated that this action was taken based on CM Rekha Gupta's in-



Search operations underway in Jasola; Missing 15-year-old boy Mithun Kumar. EXPRESS

structions.

"Chief Minister Rekha Gupta expresses strong displeasure and sorrow over this incident. She directed the Chief Secretary to provide information about the drain in question within an hour and suspend the guilty officer," read a statement by the CMO.

The rescue operation, which entered its second day Monday, was carried out by the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF), Delhi Fire Services (DFS) and the Delhi Disaster Management Authority (DDMA).

Two earthmovers and a mini-lorry were stationed along the drain, while Awadhesh

paced up and down, frantically making calls to relatives. Mud, plastic waste and debris choked the gaping drain.

The search operation was paused in the afternoon when heavy rainfall lashed the city. The wait further agitated the distraught family.

"They say they have stopped midway due to the rain. They gave the same excuse yesterday and the day before. Had they put more effort, we would have found our child's body by now," said Awadhesh.

DCP (South East) Vinit Kumar said that rescue operation is "ongoing without any delay" and will continue until the tide is found.

A police officer present at the site, meanwhile, said: "We are now laying soil to create a path for the excavators to remove the waste from the drains. We have searched all other possible areas."



Success Mantra

IN HIS first meeting with the newly appointed national office-bearers of the BJP, Prime Minister Narendra Modi is learnt to have gently cautioned them not to be content with the electoral victories of the party. According to sources, PM Modi repeatedly urged the new team of BJP president Nitin Gadgil to be in touch with the people on the ground and understand their pulse. During the interaction, the PM spoke to each of the 65 new office-bearers about their journey in politics and the party. Nabin, too, during his interaction with his new team members, advised them to strengthen their bond with the people on the ground, including the party cadre in the states where the party is in power, sources said.

Conspicuous by Absence

THE MINISTRY of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare organised a national conference on Digital Agriculture Mission and the Pulse Mission on Saturday. The conference, addressed by Union Agriculture Minister Shri Singh Chauhan, was attended by ministers from only four states — Haryana, Assam, Arunachal Pradesh and Nagaland. While the absence of ministers from other states was noticeable, what was more striking was the fact that no minister from Uttar Pradesh attended the event. On past occasions, all three ministers responsible for agriculture in UP have participated in conferences organised by Chauhan's ministry. In fact, last year, UP Agriculture Minister Suraj Prasad Singh, Deputy Minister Baldev Singh Olakh and Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Horticulture Dinesh Pratap Singh attended the National Agriculture Conference — Rabi Abhiyan 2025 on September 15-16.

Abhishek moves apex court for early decision by Speaker on rebels' disqualification

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, August 24

TRINAMOOL CONGRESS general secretary and Lok Sabha leader Abhishek Banerjee has approached the Supreme Court seeking an expeditious decision by Speaker Om Birla on petitions seeking disqualification of 20 rebel party MPs who have aligned themselves with the Nationalist Citizens Party of India. According to the SC website, a bench comprising Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justices Joydeep Bagchi and V Mohana has listed Banerjee's plea for hearing on August 25. The top court is also seized of a similar plea filed by the Shiv Sena (UBT) challenging the Speaker's approval to the merger of its six MPs with the Shiv Sena led by Maharashtra Deputy CM Eknath Shinde. A bench of Justices P Narasimha and Alok Aradhya is hearing that petition. Banerjee, in his plea, challenged the alleged delay in deciding the disqualification proceedings initiated against the MPs. The TMC leader has sought directions from the Speaker to decide the disqualification petitions in accordance with the anti-defection provisions of the Constitution. He had earlier submitted separate petitions against the 20 MPs and subsequently urged the Speaker to expedite their disposal.

Vijay scraps airport plan; free LPG, bus travel scheme widened

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, August 24

TAMIL NADU Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay Monday announced that his government would abandon the proposed Rs 27,000 crore greenfield airport at Parandur, fulfilling one of his earliest and most politically consequential promises. This comes even as Chennai confronts an increasingly urgent need for a second airport. On Monday, the Chief Minister announced three free cooking-gas cylinders every year to eligible women-headed households and a sweeping expansion of free bus travel for women.

The decision, announced by Vijay in the Assembly, brings to an end—at least at Parandur—a project planned over \$746 crore in Kanchipuram district and resisted for years by residents of Ekanapuram and surrounding villages. For Vijay, Parandur was never simply another infrastructure dispute. It was the first major protest arena he entered after launching the Tamilaga Vetri Kazhagam, which he had sought to establish his own party on an issue beyond his own celebrity. Visiting Ekanapuram on January 20, 2025, Vijay publicly sided with villagers fighting the acquisition of their homes and farmland and promised that the airport would not be built there.

On Monday, as Chief Minister, he returned to that promise. "As I had already assured, the measures undertaken to establish a new airport at Parandur will be abandoned by this government," Vijay told the House.

The decision is significant because the case for another Chennai airport has hardly disappeared. Meenambakkam airport, Vijay said, has capacity for 30 million passengers annually, while Chennai's expansion as an industrial and commercial



Tamil Nadu CM C Joseph Vijay speaks in Assembly on Monday. PTI

Key announcements for women

Rs 4,000 CRORE annual cost: The Vetri Panayam scheme will provide three LPG cylinders a year for women-headed households with annual income below ₹2.5 lakh

Rs 6,000 CRORE annual cost: The Vetri Panayam scheme will allow women to travel free not only on ordinary state-run buses, but express as well as deluxe government buses

centre is increasing demands for passenger and cargo capacity. "I'm well aware of industrial development and the role airports play in it. I extend it my complete support. But this project should not come up at Parandur," Vijay recalled telling the protesters in 2025. That distinction, between accepting the need for an airport and rejecting its location, has now become government policy.

Vijay said that after "detailed consultations with senior officials and experts," the government had identified "a few suitable alternative locations" where a new airport could be developed without affecting agricultural land and residential settlements on the same scale. Technical feasibility studies would follow, and the new site would be finalised soon, he said.

To bridge the years before an alternative airport can be built, Vijay announced a substantial expansion of the existing Chen-

nai airport. His government will work with the Airports Authority of India to develop a new Terminal 5 in the north-western sector of Meenambakkam, capable of handling an additional 20 million passengers annually, along with an access road and flyover.

Once the ongoing Terminal 3 work is completed, Vijay said, Meenambakkam's annual capacity would rise to 35 million passengers. Terminal 5 would eventually take it to 55 million passengers a year. "Through this, the services at Chennai airport will be improved, and passenger transportation requirements will be met until the new airport is established," he said.

Vijay also announced three free cooking-gas cylinders every year for eligible women-headed households and an expansion of free bus travel for women. The two measures add to a series of women-focused schemes unveiled by the four-month-old TVK government.

In the Assembly, Vijay said the Annappoorai Super Six Scheme would benefit about 1.30 crore families and cost the state exchequer approximately Rs 4,000 crore annually. The scheme is scheduled to take effect during Pongal in January.

The cooking-gas scheme was a major welfare promise made by the TVK ahead of the Assembly election. Vijay linked the measure to the shortage and rising cost of cooking gas, which he said had followed the continuing conflict in the Gulf region.

According to Vijay, eligibility will cover "economically disadvantaged families with an annual income not exceeding Rs 2.5 lakh, small and marginal farming families, and other vulnerable families in society." Through this scheme, approximately 1 crore 30 lakh 16 thousand 104 families will benefit, he said.

Meanwhile, the free bus travel scheme — renamed "Vetri Panayam" — will take effect on October 2, the birth anniversary of Mahatma Gandhi, and is expected to cost the state approximately Rs 6,000 crore annually. Vijay told the Assembly. The measure extends the benefit to several categories of government buses that had so far remained outside the programme and removes restrictions on both income and the number of journeys.

In its first phase, women will be permitted to travel free not only on ordinary buses in metropolitan cities and towns but also on Express, LSS and Deluxe government buses operating in metropolitan and urban areas. More significantly for women outside the major cities, free travel will be extended to ordinary far-mo-fossil and hill-rout buses, allowing journeys between districts.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Stalin moves HC over Kolathur defeat, seeks full VVPAT count

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, August 24

FORMER TAMIL Nadu chief minister M K Stalin moved the Madras High Court challenging the post-election verification of EVMs in Kolathur.

Stalin's defeat in the constituency was one of the defining moments of the last Assembly election, ultimately leading to the collapse of the DMK government. He lost to Tamilaga Vetri Kazhagam (TVK) candidate V S Babu by 8,795 votes.

Now, after nearly four months since Joseph Vijay formed the TVK government, the DMK president has urged the court to order a 100% count of VVPAT slips besides checking and verification of all 286 EVMs deployed in Kolathur.

He also sought to have Babu's election declared void. In his petition, Stalin argues that the post-result checking and verification process revealed a series of malfunctions and irregularities but was not certified by election authorities as being "satisfactory".

He had pressed for verification — albeit for 14 EVMs — on May 7 as well. This exercise began only on July 29, nearly three months later — a delay that the petition says caused "serious and irreversible prejudice" to his legal rights.

Stalin's case is not simply that machines malfunctioned. He argues that authorities failed to provide specific technical reports explaining why they malfunctioned. His representative had also sought 18 technical clarifications about the verification procedure.

On August 20, the SAD's Bathinda MP Harinagar Kaur, wife of party chief Sukhbir Badal, indicated the possibility of a tie-up with the BJP while addressing party workers in

Amid buzz of alliance with SAD, Santhosh says BJP will go solo

Raakhi Jagga
Patiala, August 24

AMIDST GROWING speculation about a possible alliance between the BJP and the Shiromani Akali Dal (SAD) for the Punjab Assembly elections due in February 2027, BJP national general secretary (organisation) B L Santhosh on Monday said the party would contest all 117 Assembly seats to form its own government in the state.

"Punjab is fully ready for change, and the BJP is fully prepared to make this change a reality. In the upcoming Assembly elections, the BJP will contest all 117 Assembly seats in Punjab and, by securing a victory, will form its government in the state," Santhosh said while addressing the state BJP's zonal meeting in Patiala.

Earlier in the day, Santhosh was welcomed at the Mohali airport by Punjab BJP president Kewal Singh Dhillon and BJP co-incharge of the state Narendra Singh Raina as he arrived on a two-day visit. He is reviewing the Punjab BJP's organisational activities and preparations for the election.

"These meetings covering all 23 districts of Punjab will be focused on strengthening the state BJP organisation down to the booth level, taking the policies and achievements of Modi government to the people," said a party leader.

Santhosh's remark about the BJP's plan to go alone in the polls assumes significance in the backdrop of recent statements by SAD leaders, all hinting at the renewal of an alliance with the BJP.

On August 20, the SAD's Bathinda MP Harinagar Kaur, wife of party chief Sukhbir Badal, indicated the possibility of a tie-up with the BJP while addressing party workers in



B L Santhosh addresses party leaders in Patiala. EXPRESS

Longowal. Her brother and SAD leader Bikram Singh Majithia endorsed her statement, saying Harinagar was speaking about the sentiments of people.

He added that decision on an alliance would be taken by the leadership of both the parties. One of the oldest allies of the BJP, the SAD had walked out of the NDA as well as the Modi government in September 2020 during the farmers' agitation against the now-repealed central agricultural laws.

The Akali Dal and the Punjab BJP's organisational activities and preparations in Punjab, with both parties facing a debacle.

The speculation about a renewed alliance came after Sukhbir Badal called on Modi in Delhi on August 7. However, the state BJP leaders have maintained that the party would contest the Punjab elections on its own. "On the BJP front, there is no talk about an alliance. Our focus is on building our organisational structure," said Pritpal Singh Bala, state party spokesperson.

If the BJP and the SAD do not have full alignment, the Punjab elections will witness a multi-cornered battle with the ruling Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) already facing a challenge from the principal Opposition Congress.

Security strategies meet: Focus on tackling terror & infiltration

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 24

UNION HOME Minister Amit Shah Monday inaugurated the ninth National Security Strategies Conference here to discuss key national security issues, including the defence and deportation of illegal migrants and proxy warfare by Pakistan.

According to a statement by the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA), discussions on the first day included counter-terrorism challenges, analysis and operationalisation of intelligence through the Multi-Agency Centre, a vision document on narcotics control, the detection and deportation of illegal migrants, a policy framework to combat cyber crime, and proxy warfare by Pakistan.

"For effective tackling of terrorism and radicalisation, Shah emphasised training for implementation of MHA's PRAHAAR scheme, expedient



Union Home Minister Amit Shah during the inauguration of the ninth National Security Strategies Conference 2026. PTI

Real Creator IAS Edition https://mcf+2RvD_RG9mJmJgI trial by bringing back fugitives and using trial-in-absentia provisions, and adopting a comprehensive and integrated approach while investigating UAPA cases," the spokesperson said.

During discussion, Shah has also directed that AI-based analysis of information available on MAC platform be carried out to create standard operating procedures, the spokesperson said.

Real Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Vam2YRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>

Mahua moves SC over late-night Bengal Circuit House eviction

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 24

TRINAMOOL CONGRESS MP Mahua Moitra Monday approached the Supreme Court challenging the Nadia district administration's order directing her to vacate the Krishnanagar Circuit House on the August 14.

A lawyer appearing for Moitra told a bench of Justices CJ Surya Kant and Justices Joydeep Bagchi and V Mohana that she was directed to move out. "May I mention an Article 32 petition by a sitting lady Member of Parliament who was evicted from her constituency accommodation by local officials, the additional district magistrate and the district magistrate, in deed of night," the lawyer said. Moitra represents Krishnanagar in Lok Sabha. Article 32 of the Constitution of India allows citizens to directly ap-

Dharmendra, Sule, Sawant chime in

New Delhi: Samajwadi Party (SP) MP Dharmendra Yadav has written to Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla, seeking a probe by the Committee of Privileges into TMC MP Mahua Moitra allegedly being asked to vacate a Circuit House in West Bengal late at night.

Before Yadav, NCP (SP) MP Supriya Sule, Shiv Sena (UBT) MP Arvind Sawant and CPI MP

K Radhakrishnan had also written to Birla over the August 14 incident.

In his letter, Yadav has asked to "take immediate cognizance of this entire episode, seek a report from the officials, and refer the matter to the Privileges Committee for an impartial inquiry." He has also sought instructions to ensure Moitra's safety. PTI

Seeking an early hearing, Moitra's lawyer said it "involves an important constitutional issue". Though the bench initially did not appear keen to entertain the plea, the CJ later said, "We will see".

Moitra has also wrote to Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla to inform him of the August 14 development.

यूनियन बैंक ऑफ इंडिया
अच्छे लोग, अच्छा बैंक

Good people to bank with

UPI@10: From Banking the Unbanked to Digitally Empowering India

By Shri Nitesh Ranjan, Executive Director, Union Bank of India

Ten years ago, India embarked on an experiment that fundamentally changed the way its citizens transact. The Unified Payments Interface (UPI), launched in April 2016, began with just 21 banks and 373 transactions in its first month. UPI today processes over 2,300 crore transactions worth more than ₹25 lakh crore every month, an extraordinary transformation in the scale and scope of India's digital payments ecosystem.

Yet, UPI's significance goes much beyond payments. UPI has democratised digital transactions in much the same way that Jan Dhan democratised access to banking, taking India from banking the unbanked towards digitally empowering its citizens.

From JAM to UPI: Building India's Digital Public Infrastructure

UPI's success was built on the JAM trinity - Jan Dhan accounts, Aadhaar and mobile connectivity. Jan Dhan brought millions into formal banking. Aadhaar provided digital identity and mobile connectivity provided access. Two years after Jan Dhan began expanding access to formal banking, UPI was launched in 2016. UPI added the transaction layer, enabling instant, interoperable and round-the-clock payments.

Together, these reforms have accelerated the financialisation, formalisation and digitalisation of the Indian economy. Digital payments improve transparency, create financial trails and reduce dependence on cash, strengthening efforts against forged currency and unaccounted transactions. Faster settlement also reduces transaction costs and improves the speed and efficiency of economic activity. UPI is therefore not merely a payment system — it has become a critical economic infrastructure.

From Banking the Unbanked to Financial Empowerment

Financial inclusion cannot end with opening a bank account. People must be able to receive, save, transact and borrow through the formal financial system.

UPI has helped bridge this gap. A street vendor or small merchant no longer requires expensive payment infrastructure — a QR code can become a digital point of sale. Rural households and small businesses can access the same interoperable payment infrastructure as customers in India's largest cities.

Continuous innovation has widened this reach. UPI Lite facilitates seamless small-value payments. UPI 123PAY extends digital payments to feature-phone users, and UPI AutoPay enables recurring payments. UPI has thus transformed financial inclusion from access to a bank account into active participation in the digital economy.

Union Bank of India: A Decade of UPI Innovation

Union Bank of India is proud to have been part of this journey from the very beginning as one of the 21 pilot banks that launched UPI in 2016. Today, the Bank ranks fourth among 741 UPI-enabled banks, reflecting our commitment to driving digital payments and financial inclusion at scale.

The Bank has embraced innovations including UPI Lite, RuPay Credit Card on UPI, interoperable cardless

cash withdrawal and cash deposit, UPI Circle, biometric-based UPI transactions and UPI Global. Importantly, Credit Line on UPI enables select Retail and Agriculture customers to transact from pre-sanctioned credit facilities. During COVID-19, Union Bank of India, in coordination with NPCI, also leveraged UPI for digital prepaid vouchers, enabling secure and contactless delivery of assistance.

From UPI to ULI: Democratising Credit

If UPI's first decade was about democratising payments, the next revolution can be about democratising credit through the Unified Lending Interface (ULI).

Small farmers and MSMEs often face credit constraints because information such as land records, business registrations, KYC, credit history and financial turnover resides across different systems. ULI can reduce these frictions by digitally connecting lenders with relevant data, subject to consent and safeguards, making credit appraisal faster and more efficient, particularly for agriculture, MSMEs and smaller borrowers. This continues the progression towards frictionless credit envisaged in the Jan Dhan@10 journey.

The progression is powerful: Jan Dhan banked the unbanked; UPI enabled them to transact; and ULI can help finance the underserved. The 'new trinity' of JAM-ULI-UPI will be a revolutionary step forward in India's digital infrastructure journey.

UPI@20: From Digital to Intelligent Banking

Beyond the internationalisation of UPI, Artificial Intelligence can be the next major milestone in India's digital financial journey. If Jan Dhan provided access, UPI transformed payments and ULI paving powers to democratised credit, AI can provide the intelligence layer — enabling faster decisions, better credit assessment, personalised products and stronger fraud detection.

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Three arrested for gangrape of 17-year-old girl in MP's Pachmarhi

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, August 24

A 17-YEAR-OLD GIRL was allegedly gangraped by three men after she was taken, along with a male acquaintance, to a secluded forest area in Pachmarhi — a famous tourist spot in Madhya Pradesh — last week. Police have arrested all three accused within six hours of the survivor reporting the incident, officials said on Monday.

According to police, the girl was returning home with an acquaintance when a friend of the latter arrived with two other men. The three allegedly took the girl and her acquaintance to a secluded spot where they allegedly intimidated them and sexually assaulted the teenager. The accused allegedly later dropped them and threatened them against revealing the incident before anyone.

The incident came to light after the girl approached Pachmarhi police and reported the alleged assault. Following her complaint, multiple police teams were deployed and all three accused were arrested within six hours, police said.

"The three accused have confessed to the crime and are now being produced before the court," said Narmadapuram Additional Superintendent of Police Abhishek Rajan.

Naga-Kuki
crossfire: CRPF
SI shot at in
Manipur

Express News Service
Imphal, August 24

ASUB-INSPECTOR of the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) sustained a bullet injury to his left foot as fresh violence broke out along the border between a Naga-dominated district, and adjoining areas of Kuki-Zo-dominated Kangpokpi district on Monday.

Pradeep Singh of the 36th Battalion was deployed at an outpost in Matnang Naga village, Senapati, near the border with Taphou Kuki. The CRPF leader, according to preliminary reports, he was hit in crossfire between the Naga and Kuki village sides. He is undergoing treatment at District Hospital, Senapati.

The violence began at around 2.40 am at Taphou Kuki, where a house was allegedly set on fire by unidentified persons. Fire and emergency services personnel reached around 3.30 am. Further incidents were reported around 4 am in Mareime area on the Senapati side. A house belonging to Nagas was reportedly set ablaze and another demolished by unidentified persons.

The situation escalated at around 9 am when firing broke out. Security forces have since been deployed in Taphou and adjoining areas. The violence has disrupted traffic along NH-2, the Imphal-Dimapur highway connecting Manipur and Nagaland. Transport services on NH-2 had resumed only last Friday after three years following the ethnic violence that erupted in May 2023.

Tejpal should have surrendered before filing appeal, Goa tells SC

Tejpal, convicted of raping journalist in 2013, said there was no need for him to surrender as HC had given him 4 weeks

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 24

THE GOA government on Monday told the Supreme Court (SC) that former editor-in-chief of Tehelka magazine, Tarun Tejpal — found guilty of raping a female journalist in 2013 and sentenced to 10 years rigorous imprisonment — should have surrendered before filing an appeal challenging the conviction.

Solicitor General (SG) Tusshar Mehta, appearing for the state, took the stand before a single-judge bench of Justice Alok Aradhya, who took up Tejpal's application seeking exemption.

Appearing for the convict, senior advocate Kapil Sibal urged that the appeal be listed for hearing on August 31. The Bombay High Court (HC) while sentencing him on Au-

gust 6 had given Tejpal four weeks to surrender.

Opposing this, Mehta pointed out the appeal will not stand unless he surrenders. He contended that Order XC Rule 3 of the Supreme Court Rules, 2013, is mandatory in nature, in view of which, until and unless the appellant surrenders, the appeal cannot be listed before the court.

Citing a two-judge bench judgment of the SC, which held the provision to be mandatory, the SC said that until and unless suitable orders are passed on the application seeking exemption from surrender, the appeal cannot be listed before the court.

Consequently, the request to list the matter before the Court without considering the application seeking exemption from surrender, cannot be accepted, Mehta argued.



Following Tejpal's acquittal in 2021, the Goa govt appealed to the HC, which reversed the trial court's conclusions

Countering this, Sibal said there was no need to surrender as the HC had given Tejpal a window of four weeks.

"The rule does not apply because this is a case where stay has been granted by the High Court, so there is no question of applying this rule. Suppose the Court says no stay, I will have to go to jail.

What's the pleasure in saying I must surrender and then appeal, when the High Court itself granted a stay and the order stands?" the senior counsel contended.

The court, after hearing both sides, said Sibal "has not addressed" it "on the merits of the application seeking exemption from surrender."

With a view to afford him an opportunity to address the court on the aforesaid interlocutory application, list the same for consideration on 25.08.2026."

The case dates back to November 2013, when Tejpal allegedly assaulted the survivor on two separate occasions inside the lift of a hotel in Goa while the two were alone during a literary festival.

He was acquitted of all charges by an Additional Sessions court in Mapusa in May 2021. Then, the court had said the woman's messages to the accused established that she was "neither traumatised nor terrified" and that this "completely belies" the prosecution's case.

The Goa government appealed to the High Court, which reversed the trial court's conclusions and convicted him. The latter said "the trial court proceeded on a notion that a victim of sexual assault must behave in a stereotypical manner".

The HC further noted that the appreciation of evidence by the trial court was "not only unreasonable, but perverse", and criticised it for permitting an "invasive, humiliating cross-examination into the victim's past sexual history, moral views, and personal WhatsApp messages, directly violating statutory embargoes... that prohibit questioning a victim's character or past relationships".

Challenging this, Tejpal, said in his appeal before the SC that the HC judgement is "erroneous, misconceived, contrary to facts and the record, and is directly contrary to settled law".

Recently, the Goa government moved the SC for an enhancement of Tejpal's punishment by seeking life term.

• BRIEFLY



Wreckage of a tractor-trolley that fell off a bridge in Dhar district of Madhya Pradesh on Monday. PTI

MADHYA PRADESH

Kanwariya dies, 21 injured as tractor-trolley falls off bridge

A 42-YEAR-OLD Kanwariya died and 21 others were injured, two of them in critical state, after a tractor-trolley carrying them fell off a bridge in Madhya Pradesh's Dhar district on Monday, police said. Kushi Sub-Divisional Officer of Police Sunil Gupta said the deceased Rajendra Patidar succumbed to injuries at a hospital in Barwani. Initial investigations suggest the tractor steering failed, causing the vehicle to fall off the bridge, he added. More than 30 devotees were travelling in the tractor-trolley when the accident occurred. PTI

Tree branch falls on 3 in Kolkata hospital, 1 dead

A WOMAN died and two persons were injured after a tree branch fell on them inside the state-run SSKM Hospital premises on Monday, a police officer said. The deceased, Rahida Bibi, had come from Nahati in Birbhum to look after a relative admitted to the hospital. It happened outside the urology department amid intermittent rain and strong winds in Kolkata and several parts of south Bengal under the influence of a low-pressure area. Two persons were injured in the incident and are undergoing treatment, he said. The Kolkata Police officer said no complaint has so far been filed. PTI

Saveetha top Indian varsity in Shanghai list

SAVEETHA UNIVERSITY has emerged as the number one institute in India and secured a prestigious position in the 501-600 global ranking band in the Shanghai Academic Ranking of World Universities (ARWU) 2026. The Shanghai ARWU ranks universities based on academic and research performance indicators, including alumni and staff winning Nobel prizes, field medals, researchers, papers published in Nature and Science journals, papers indexed in major citation indices, and the per capita academic performance of the institution. Over 2,500 universities were assessed worldwide. ENS

Maoist acquitted to 'missing' report: Why a 2008 killing is back in focus in Odisha

Sujit Bisoi
Bhubaneswar, August 24

ADDRESSING A function marking the birth centenary of slain Vishwa Hindu Parishad (VHP) leader Swami Laxmananda Saraswati at his native place Gurujanga in Angul district on Friday, Odisha Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi said his government would uncover the truth behind the seer's killing and ensure that justice is delivered in the case.

"Every drop of Swami ji's blood will receive justice," Majhi told the gathering.

His assurances came three days after a special court in Odisha acquitted Maoist leader Dharmendra Pradhan and others during the birth centenary celebrations of Laxmananda Saraswati in Angul district. EXPRESS

CM Majhi pledges justice for slain VHP leader Laxmananda Saraswati



Odisha Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi, former Union minister Dharmendra Pradhan and others during the birth centenary celebrations of Laxmananda Saraswati in Angul district. EXPRESS

spending around 10 years in jail.

Kandhamal killings

On August 23, 2008, 20-25 masked people gunned down the Saraswati, 84, and his four aides at his ashram at Kandhamal's Jalespeta. The ashram inmates were celebrating Janmashtami. The VHP leader, who had led a campaign against govt slaughter and conversion of tribals into Christianity, had received threats and even faced an attack before his murder. Saraswati, who had come to the tribal-dominated Kandhamal in the late 1960s, had set up ashrams and kanyashrams (residential girls' schools) in Jalespeta to educate tribal girls.

His killing triggered large-scale communal violence that claimed at least 39 lives and displaced over 25,000 people.

Many churches, prayer halls and houses were torched or damaged. The riots strained the ties between the then ruling parties BJD, led by CM Naveen

Patnaik, and BJP, who had been in an alliance since 2000, leading to Patnaik snapping ties with BJP a month before the 2009 Assembly and Lok Sabha polls.

In September 2008, the Patnaik government constituted a judicial inquiry commission, led by former Orissa High Court judge Justice S C Mohapatra, to probe into Saraswati's killing and subsequent riots. After Mohapatra's demise, this inquiry was handed over to another retired judge Justice A S Naidu. Even though the Naidu commission submitted its report in December 2015, it was not made public by the Patnaik government that remained in power till June 2024.

The BJP that demanded a CBI probe into Saraswati's killing while in Opposition stormed to power in Odisha in 2024. After two years at the helm, the BJP government on June 10, 2026, filed an FIR alleging that the two judicial commission reports — including one on the

2008 Saraswati killing and riots and another one on the 2016 fire incident at SMI medical college and hospital — were not available in the CMO and remained untraceable despite searches.

The Majhi government alleged that while several reports and files forwarded by the Home Department to the CMO were returned on June 4, 2024, when the Assembly poll indicating a BJP win became clear, these reports remained missing. The FIR claimed that the "disappearance" of the reports created a reasonable suspicion that they may have been "intentionally removed, retained, concealed, destroyed or otherwise unlawfully dealt with." The BJP accused the previous BJD government of "intentionally" causing the reports' disappearance while the police also issued summons to at least four retired bureaucrats including V K Padma, a close Patnaik aide.

Hindutva push

At the Saraswati event on Friday, CM Majhi accused the Patnaik government of "deliberate conspiracy" to shield perpetrators behind disappearance of files. Majhi also raked up the "failure, negligence and appeasement policies" of the BJD dispensation in this regard. "I want to give a firm assurance to the 4.5 crore people of Odisha that the truth behind the incident would certainly be brought to light," he said.

The function was also attended by former Union education minister Dharmendra Pradhan and a slew of BJP and VHP leaders.

As part of Hindutva push, the BJP government has named a medical college at Phulbani after Saraswati. A grant of Rs 13 crore has been sanctioned from the CM's special assistance

(CMSA) for redevelopment of ashram, kanyashram and other development works in Kandhamal. The government has also announced its proposal to transform the slain VHP leader's village as a "heritage village".

The BJD hit back at Majhi, accusing him of making "baseless allegations" on the Saraswati murder case. BJD spokesperson Lelini Mohanty said, "The nation knows which party does appeasement politics. State BJP chief Manmohan Samal and ex-governor Biswahan Harichandan were a part of the then Patnaik ministry (in 2008). Is the CM pointing towards them as well." The BJD also took a swipe at the Majhi government for "searching for an important Commission report after two years of assuming office". "Has it been deliberately misplaced by the CMO to protect someone from their own organisation," Mohanty asked.

Hailing from Mandasamand of Andhra Pradesh's Srikakulam, Azad was involved in Maoist activities since 1990 and worked in Uddan area of Srikakulam in different roles. He was also an accused in the 2008 Nayagarh police armoury attack — in which at least 14 people, including 13 policemen, were killed; and in 2006 R Udayagiri jail attack. However, he has been acquitted in all these cases.

Azad had surrendered before the Andhra Pradesh police in May 2011. After being handed over to the Odisha police in June 2011, he had been lodged at Jharpada jail in Bhubaneswar for 15 years until his acquittal in the Saraswati murder case. Earlier, the Supreme Court had asked Odisha and Andhra Pradesh governments to set up special courts for speedy disposal of cases against Azad.

Two days after ship sank off Odisha coast, no trace of 22 crew members yet

Sujit Bisoi
Bhubaneswar, August 24

IT'S A RACE against time in the Bay of Bengal, where over 150 personnel of the Indian Coast Guard and a surveillance aircraft of the Indian Navy are mulling over a massive search and rescue operation for 22 crew members of a merchant vessel, which sank off the Odisha coast late on Saturday.

Coast Guard sources said that with no breakthrough so far in the search for the crew members of MV Ocean Winner, they have expanded their area of operation.

"As the operation progresses, it's a standard practice to expand the search area based on the inputs from the previous area of search. So far, there has been no update on the whereabouts of the 22 missing crew members," Coast Guard spokesperson Commander Amit Uniyal told The Indian Express.

Two crew members, identified as Chinese nationals, were rescued on Saturday itself. In

the joint search operation, the Indian Coast Guard has deployed three ships with around 150 personnel while the Eastern Naval Command has deployed an aircraft — P8I — on surveillance sortie.

Coast Guard sources said rough sea conditions in the middle of the Bay of Bengal are hampering the search and rescue by limiting visibility. Also, the mishap occurred where the sea is known to be deep, making the search and rescue operation more challenging.

MV OCEAN WINNER sank around 230 nautical miles (425 km) from the Paradip coast of Odisha. It was carrying more than 72,000 tonnes of iron ore from Odisha to China with a stop at Singapore. It left Paradip Port early on Friday morning.

On the two rescued sea farers, an official source said, "The crew members — both Chinese nationals — are most likely to be brought to Paradip Port in a day or two. The next move will be decided after consultation at the top level."

• KUNNUMMAL'S APPOINTMENT, WHICH HAS BEEN CHALLENGED BY BOTH CONGRESS AND CPI(M), HAS BEEN VIEWED AS THE GOVERNOR'S STEP TOWARDS 'SAFFRONISING' HIGHER EDUCATION IN THE STATE

Who is Mohanan Kunnummal, Kerala V-C at centre of repeated controversies

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram,
August 24

"ARE YOU cockroaches or termites?" Kerala University of Health Sciences (KUHS) Vice-Chancellor Dr Mohanan Kunnummal repeatedly asked students during a recent award ceremony in Thiruvananthapuram.

When a video of students sitting unresponsive went viral, it added a new episode to the growing controversies around Kunnummal, who has found himself at the centre of recurring tensions between the Governor's office and Kerala government, of the Left and now the Congress, over the last few years. A medical professional

specialising in radio-diagnosis for the last three decades, Kunnummal, who is also the V-C of the University of Kerala, on August 22 alleged that "foreign forces" were trying to convert young people to cockroaches.

This cockroach controversy came close on the heels of Kunnummal's remark on Vande Mataram at an RSS Sankalp youth summit on Independence Day. Reacting to the Congress-led government's decision to skip the recital of Vande Mataram at Kerala's official Independence Day events, Kunnummal said, "When we pray, we say Vande Mataram. It is our mother and those who oppose Vande Mataram do not know who their mother is."

Over the years, both the

CPI(M) and Congress have challenged Kunnummal's appointments — first as the V-C of KUHS in 2019 and then the additional charge as the V-C of the University of Kerala in 2023 — as part of the Governor's "saffronisation of higher education" in Kerala.

In October 2019, then Governor Arif Mohammed Khan picked Kunnummal as the V-C of KUHS, allegedly overlooking the recommendations of a search committee formed by the then Left government. After then Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan assumed office of the Left government's second consecutive term in 2021, the higher education sector had been marked by repeated tussles between the Governor



Kunnummal is the V-C of Kerala University of Health Sciences and Kerala University

and the state government.

The first battle ground was the University of Kerala in 2022, when Khan formed a search committee for a new V-C to the

incumbent Dr Mahadevan Pillai's tenure was coming to an end. The University Senate, dominated by CPI(M) members, did not name its nominee to the search committee in protest against the Governor's earlier action. Then gave Kunnummal the additional charge as the V-C of the University of Kerala.

In 2024, when his five-year tenure as V-C of KUHS was to end, Kunnummal was reappointed for another term by Khan — until then, it had been unusual in Kerala to reappoint a V-C. The only precedent came in 2021, when Kannur University V-C Dr Gopinath Ravindran was given another term by Khan, who claimed he had acted at the behest of the

CPI(M) government. In 2023, the Supreme Court quashed Ravindran's reappointment.

As the power struggle between the government and Khan continued over the University of Kerala, Kunnummal as the acting V-C got involved in nominations for the University Senate with Khan's backing. In 2024, Khan extended Kunnummal's tenure as V-C "till a permanent V-C was appointed" at the University of Kerala. When the CPI(M) members in the Senate legally challenged the decision, the Kerala High Court upheld the Governor's move, which led to Kunnummal's continuation as the V-C.

After Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar replaced Khan as the

Kerala Governor in January 2025, Kunnummal had drawn the ire of the Left government over a portrait of Bharat Mata with a saffron flag at a function attended by Arlekar.

On June 25, 2025, socio-cultural outfit Rev Padmanabha Seva Samithi marked 50 years since the Emergency with an event at the University of Kerala attended by Arlekar. University registrar Anil Kumar, who had ordered the cancellation of the programme over a Bharat Mata portrait displayed at a university hall, was suspended by Kunnummal. The incident had sparked protests with the Left alleging that Kunnummal was "proving his loyalty to the RSS".

Things have not changed

much since the Congress-led UDF came to power in May this year. In June, RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat addressed a lecture series in Thiruvananthapuram titled "100 Years of Sangh-Jury New Horizons". The event was attended not only by Kunnummal, but also by two other vice-chancellors — MG University V-C in-charge Dr D Maavoothu and Malayalam University V-C in-charge Dr C R Prasad. Chief Minister V D Sathesan said the attendance of the three V-Cs at Bhagwat's event was a "serious lapse" and was not in tune with the state's educational tradition and the dignity of the V-C's post. However, months later, Kunnummal was in attendance at another RSS event on Independence Day.

NIA searches five locations in cyber terror case

New Delhi: The NIA on Monday conducted searches at five locations across five states in connection with the ongoing investigation into a cyber terrorism case registered in Gujarat.

The raids were carried out in Jammu in Pune, Maharashtra; Nashik in Kherda, Gujarat; Begunbad in Karnataka; Telangana; Gopalganj in Bihar; and Delhi. They were in connection with a case registered on June 25, 2025, a NIA spokesperson said.

The accused had attempted a Distributed Denial of Service attack against 54 websites of Government of India entities during the time of Operation Sindoor last year. A DDoS attack is a malicious attempt to disrupt normal traffic to a server, service or network by flooding it with massive illegitimate internet traffic from compromised sources. ENS

Joint elections plan flawed, against basic structure of Constitution: Chidambaram

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 24

FORMER UNION Minister and senior Congress leader P Chidambaram on Monday told a parliamentary panel that the proposal to hold simultaneous elections in their current form was flawed and undermined the basic structure of the Constitution, particularly the core principles of parliamentary democracy, it is learnt.

He is learnt to have made the submission during a meeting of the Joint Committee of Parliament on the Constitution (129th Amendment) Bill, 2024, and the Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2024, which aim to ensure simultaneous elections to the Lok Sabha and

state Assemblies. The agenda for Monday's meeting included interactions with Chidambaram. Padma Awarded from Delhi, representatives of National First Policy Research Centre and representatives of Vikrit Centre for Legal Policy.

Chidambaram, who is also a member of the Rajya Sabha, is learnt to have argued that since a legislature is elected for a five-year term, curtailing its tenure directly violates the basic structure of the Constitution. He also told the panel that his conscience does not allow him to support the Bills and stressed that the government does not have the numbers (two-thirds majority) to pass the legislation, it is learnt. Some members of the committee



P Chidambaram, former Union minister and Congress leader

from the Opposition parties are learnt to have opposed the proposal, claiming it would give too much power to the Election Commission of India.

The joint committee has

BJP MP P P Chaudhary as its chairman, while its members include BJP's Anil Baluni, Sanjay Jaiswal, Congress's Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, Manish Tewari, SP's Dharmendra Yadav and TMC's Sagarika Ghose.

On Monday, the committee also had a dialogue with a group of Padma awardees, some of whom supported the proposal while some opposed it.

Speaking in support, one of the awardees is learnt to have said that frequent enforcement of the Model Code of Conduct (MCC) halts developmental projects and emphasised that synchronised elections would ensure uninterrupted regional development.

Speaking to reporters, committee chairperson Chaudhary

said Monday's meeting spanned over seven hours.

"First, we had a discussion of about one and a half to two hours with former Union minister and Rajya Sabha member P Chidambaram. All the members sought clarifications from him, and it was a very healthy and academic discussion. The entire committee, across party lines and rising above ideological differences, is working in the national interest to ensure that the best possible framework for One Nation, One Election is created," said the BJP MP.

The Bills on simultaneous polls were introduced in the Lok Sabha in December 2024, after which they were referred to the joint committee of Parliament for examination.

'Fish feast' in Ayodhya sets off political fireworks

Maulshree Seth
Lucknow, August 24

A 'FISH bhoj' (feast) organised in Ayodhya by the Nishad community on Sunday has sparked a political row, with Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath accusing state Congress chief Ajay Rai of partaking of the feast and the opposition leader challenging him to show evidence.

The controversy erupted after a purported video of the feast after an event held by Ram Nishad, who joined the Congress last month after leaving the BJP, went viral on social media. The BJP hit out at Rai, saying it was the Hindu holy month of Shravan when many Hindus avoid meat. Rai challenged Adityanath to provide evidence. Ram Nishad, meanwhile, said they have committed "no crime" by eating fish.

Addressing a public meeting in Rae Bareilly on Monday, Adityanath alleged, "We are all devotees of Bajrang Bali. But you must have seen the conduct of the devotees of Babri yesterday. They went to Hanuman Garhi temple and later were seen enjoying a fish feast at one of their offices. This is what they call 'Ram on the lips and a dagger tucked under the arm.' He went on to say that "even a chameleon would be embarrassed by this kind of behaviour". "It would wonder what kind of human species this is—chanting 'Ram-Ram' inside the temple and feasting on fish the moment they step out."

UP Deputy CM Brajesh Pathak told the media, "Ayodhya Dham is our sacred abode, the abode of Lord Ram, and hosting such a feast there, especially during Shravan, reflects the culture of the Congress party."

Congress leaders denied the claim. They said the event was held in Gosaigani, around 30-

Feast's video triggers BJP-Cong row, with UP CM accusing Opp of insulting Ayodhya and Cong denying that its leaders attended the event

40 km from Ayodhya, and that its leaders did not participate in the subsequent fish feast.

Rai accused the BJP of trying to divert attention from allegations surrounding the alleged theft of donations in Ayodhya. "Does the CM have any photos? If he can produce any pictures, I will be ready to resign immediately... Nishad Samaj invited me to a programme in Ayodhya yesterday. If they were getting fish prepared there, it would be their concern. I attended the programme and returned."

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, Nishad said Congress leaders, including Rai and AICC in-charge of UP, Rajendra Pal Gautam, had been invited to the programme to mark the joining of the party. The leaders arrived around 1-2 pm and were served vegetarian food. They left around 3 pm. He said the viral video showed a separate feast organised by members of the Nishad community after the political programme. "We are fishermen. We have committed no crime by eating fish," he said.

Explaining the importance of fish to the Nishad community, he said, "Fish is important to us from birth until death. How can we manage if we do not touch fish for a month? If you want to talk about something, talk about uplifting the community."

"Nishadon ne machhli banake kha liya to kausa apuradhi kar liya? (What crime have we committed by preparing and eating fish?)" he asked.

Suvendu: 10% of CAA applicants got citizenship so far

Express News Service
Kolkata, August 24

CHIEF MINISTER Suvendu Adhikari on Monday said that out of the 2.3 lakh people who applied for citizenship under the amended citizenship law (CAA) in the state, 23,000 (or 10 percent) have been issued citizenship certificates so far, and asserted that hearing of applications will be completed soon.

"This was our promise. We are implementing it. As a result, Hindu refugees who have applied for citizenship will be issued certificates quickly," the CM told mediapersons at Nabanna, the state secretariat.

Notably, only a few days ago, the Centre had issued guidelines assigning the responsibility of issuing citizenship certificates to the district magistrates. Adhikari said, "Through the district magistrates, we will act quickly. Of the 2.30 lakh people, 23,000 have received certificates. And those who have not yet applied will still be able to do so. We will also be able to complete the hearings swiftly and issue certificates to Hindu refugees who came from Bangladesh due to religious persecution."

"Our Hindu refugees, the Matta community, who have long been waiting in hope and brought us to power, will receive the certificates from me. The Government of India has entrusted this responsibility to me," he said, while also denying allegations of discrimination in transferring money to women beneficiaries of the Annapurna

cash-transfer scheme. "Those who are eligible will receive the money (under the Annapurna scheme). Out of nearly 1.45 crore beneficiaries, 19.2 lakh are Muslim families. We do not discriminate. The government has records of what appeasement was practised during the previous (TMC) administration. One lakh eligible women beneficiaries in the Hills of Darjeeling have received financial assistance," Adhikari said amid reports of protests by women in several parts of the state over non-payment of the scheme money.

Reacting to the last weekend's clashes at Jadavpur University campus that took place between ABVP, the RSS students' wing, and CPI(M)'s SFI, the CM said, "Normal classes have been held at Jadavpur University. There is no problem there. This will not be tolerated here. One must engage in nationalistic activities. Things like 'Red Salute' to (Maoist leader) Kishenji will not be allowed." He said that he will personally visit the JU campus next Friday and sing 'Vande Mataram' there.

Adhikari once again targeted the Mamata Banerjee-led Trinamool Congress. "A lot remains to be done. The corrupt anti-newspaper duo was at the peak of corruption. The harshest punishment will be given to thieves. The work of confiscating the property acquired through theft, auctioning it, and returning it to the government treasury is still pending," Adhikari said. "Can everything be done in 110 days? It has only been three months."

JU still tense, CM says probe 'anti-national' graffiti on campus

Tanushree Bose & Atri Mitra
Kolkata, August 24

AMID THE simmering tension at Kolkata's Jadavpur University (JU) following last week's clash between ABVP and SFI supporters, West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Monday expressed "concerns over 'anti-national' graffiti and drawings" on the campus and directed the state university authorities to probe and carry out on-ground physical verification of students.

The CM's directive came soon after a meeting called by the university's vice-chancellor, Bishnujit Ghosh, in which the anti-national graffiti and drawings on the campus and directed the state university authorities to probe and carry out on-ground physical verification of students.

In a post on X, Adhikari

wrote, "The CMO has received concerning videos and photographic representations through the CM's Grievance Cell from conscientious Students of Jadavpur University, reporting instances of objectionable, sociopathic, violent and Anti-National wall graffiti & drawings inside the Arts Division Boys Hostel premises."

"...Under no circumstances will campus premises be permitted to be used as platforms for spreading dangerous propaganda and Anti-India sentiment," CM Adhikari wrote and asked the university and Principal Secretary of the Higher Education Department to initiate an "immediate inquiry".



Special Bond

Chief Justice of India Justice Surya Kant interacts with a school student ahead of Raksha Bandhan at the Judge's Lounge, Supreme Court, in New Delhi on Monday. PTI

Lalmani Verma
Lucknow, August 24

IN THE wake of the ruling BJP's setback in Uttar Pradesh in the 2024 Lok Sabha polls, several party leaders had flagged "disappointment among BJP workers because of neglect" by the state administration among the factors for its poor performance, while some others had blamed the central leadership's "dominance" in candidate selection for it.

In the 2024 Lok Sabha polls, the BJP's UP tally fell from 62 of 80 seats to 33, while its vote share declined from 49.98% to 41.37%.

BJP national president Nitin Nabin recently constituted a new team of central party office-bearers, giving increased representation to UP leaders in it, including those who have lost previous polls. This is being seen in UP BJP circles as part of the party high command's efforts to improve coordination and synergy between the central and state units in order to smoothen the party's roadmap for the state Assembly polls slated for early 2027. Nabin's new team has eight BJP faces from UP—one more than the previous team—with two representatives each in the groups of vice-presidents, general secretaries and secretaries besides presidents of two morchas—OBC and minorities.

"Four of these eight leaders faced defeat in the 2024 Lok Sabha and 2022 UP Assembly polls. Their elevation cannot be called a challenge for the popularity of CM Yogi Adityanath who has been running the UP government with special focus on law and order for two consecutive terms since 2017. Instead, those leaders will be able to give more time for organisational works in the state. The ultimate goal of both Yogi ji and BJP leadership is winning 2027 Assembly polls and creating a favourable atmosphere for the 2029 Lok Sabha polls," said a BJP leader close to Adityanath.

He said that Rekha Verma, who retained the national vice-president's position, had lost the Lok Sabha poll from Dhauraha, while new general secretary Smriti Irami had lost her Amethi parliamentary seat in 2024. He also pointed out that another general secretary Harish Dwivedi lost in Basti in the 2024 Lok Sabha election, while new OBC morcha president Amarpal Maurya faced defeat in Unchaur in the 2022 Assembly polls.

Another senior UP BJP leader said barring the second-term national vice-president Tariq Mansoor, other seven office-bearers from the state are aged under 55 years, adding this was as per the party's plan of promoting younger leaders to en-



BJP chief Nitin Nabin's new team of Central party office-bearers hold eight BJP faces from CM Yogi Adityanath-led UP government. EXPRESS

able to connect with the youth and Gen Z more effectively.

On BJP's decision to bring Smriti Irami back into its national leadership, a party leader said, "She is popular among women and youths, she is a good speaker and she has experience of defeating Rahul Gandhi in his bastion Amethi in the past. She can be a good leader to challenge Rahul and another top Congress leader Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, who are likely to lead the UP campaign for the party."

On Harish Dwivedi's appointment as a new national general secretary, a BJP leader said, "Dwivedi is a Brahmin and an active leader with ABVP background. His appointment holds importance amid reports that there was simmering anger among sections of upper castes

over the new UGC regulations stayed by the Supreme Court. It is known within the party that Dwivedi's relations with CM Adityanath had never been very friendly, but as a young Brahmin face and with his experience of being Assam BJP in-charge and as the in-charge of the upcoming Rajasthan local body elections—he will be helpful for the party in UP polls." Dwivedi was a two-term MP from Basti adjoining Adityanath's home turf Gorakhpur, before losing from his seat in the 2024 election.

Both Rekha Verma, an OBC leader, and Tariq Mansoor, a Pasmanda Muslim, who have retained their vice-president posts, are known for their "non-interference" in the affairs of the UP BJP or the state government, party insiders said.

"Mansoor is an influential voice within the Muslim community, he has given his stature as a former AMU vice-chancellor. By retaining him in the organisation and appointing UP's Kunwar Basit Ali as Minority Morcha chief, the party has tried to strike a balance with Muslims who are largely upset because of bulldozer actions in the BJP-led states despite getting benefits of all the welfare schemes," said a party leader. Ali has frequently shared his photos with Adityanath on social media.

Bhola Singh, a three-term Dalit MP from Bulandshahr, and Sangeeta Yadav, a Rajya Sabha MP and former MLA from Chauri-Chauri in Gorakhpur, appointed as secretaries, are essentially known as leaders confined to their respective seats.

BJP sources said while Sangeeta Yadav has her parental home in Gorakhpur, she is not a regular visitor to the region. "But by elevating her in the national team, the party has intensified efforts to reach out to Yadavs, that is SP's traditional vote base," said a leader.

"Maurya has a bigger responsibility of working among OBCs, especially among Kushwaha, Shukla, Saini and Maurya groups who have decisive presence in UP, Haryana, Bihar, etc. But his appointment is more important for UP as the SP is trying to woo these non-Yadav caste groups now," the leader added.

Why Bihar wants the Farakka treaty scrapped — and why it puts Govt in a bind

Santosh Singh
Patna, August 24

A FRESH diplomatic and political confrontation is brewing in Bihar over the 1996 India-Bangladesh Ganges Water Sharing Treaty, or known colloquially as the Farakka treaty. As the treaty's lapse approaches, Bihar's ruling National Democratic Alliance is pushing against its renewal—a development that could put the BJP-led Centre in a bind.

In the latest push against the pact, Bihar Deputy Chief Minister Vijay Kumar Choudhary, who has been the state's top resource portfolio and who had accompanied CM Samrat Choudhary during a recent meeting with External Affairs

Minister S. Jaishankar in Delhi, told reporters that the state had "expressed our concerns regarding the Farakka treaty and that it has proved detrimental to Bihar's interest." The Union minister assured us of the taking care of our concerns," he said.

This comes after JD(U) national working president and Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Kumar Jha also urged the Centre not to renew the pact. "The Farakka treaty has done enormous harm to Bihar. It is also surprising that the treaty was never reviewed in the last 30 years," Jha told *The Indian Express*. "Bihar suffers flood, heavy siltation and also paucity of water because of it. Now that we are in the phase of industrialisation, we need rational use of water.

During summers, when we need water for ourselves, we have to concede water to Bangladesh as per the treaty."

The Farakka Water Treaty (officially called the Ganges Water Sharing Treaty) is a bilateral deal signed on December 12, 1996, between India and Bangladesh that regulates the sharing of the Ganga waters at the Farakka Barrage in West Bengal, India, primarily during the dry season from January 1 to May 31. The treaty expires in December.

The barrage was built in 1975 to divert water from the Ganga into the Hooghly River to flush out the silt and to keep Kolkata Port navigable. However, this reduced downstream river flow into Bangladesh, causing severe water shortages, increased soil



The treaty has done enormous harm to Bihar: JD(U) working president and RS MP Sanjay Kumar Jha, who has urged the Centre not to renew the pact

salinity, and ecological stress in southern Bangladesh. The 1996 treaty established a 30-year binding

framework (1996–2026) to replace earlier short-term stopgap arrangements and ensure predictable water distribution.

Unlike the earlier 1977 temporary deal, the 1996 treaty lacks a "minimum flow guarantee clause". If total flow falls drastically below 50,000 cusecs, the treaty only calls for immediate emergency consultations between both governments. Siltation, reduced groundwater discharge, upstream water withdrawal, and erratic rainfall patterns have altered the river's actual availability in Bihar compared to 1996 baseline levels.

For two decades, the Bihar government has been flagging concerns over the barrage with the Centre—first under Nitish Kumar and now under

Samrat Choudhary. The government argues that the structure has created a severe "flood-and-parch" dynamic upstream, and that the heavy silt trapped behind the barrage has drastically elevated the Ganges riverbed, destroying its natural water storage capacity and driving severe seasonal floods into surrounding districts like Bhagalpur and Munger during monsoons.

Pushing against renewal, Jha argued that Bihar's projected water needs up to 2050 be prioritised and that any future diplomatic arrangement must include a comprehensive National Silt Management Policy and direct representation for the state.

The mounting domestic pressure from NDA coalition partner JD(U) comes at a deli-

cate moment for Delhi's foreign policy. For his part, Jaishankar has stressed that neighbourhood relations must be navigated through "mutual interest" and "common ground".

At a recent media conclave, Jaishankar, while responding to questions on complex bilateral issues, said that Bangladesh demands for stronger downstream guarantee clauses to wider diplomatic discussions—noted that for any international relationship to function smoothly, both sides must establish a shared landing point.

But even as the state's NDA alliance mounts pressure on the Centre, Bihar's Principal Opposition, the Rashtriya Janata Dal, has been highlighting a 2011 parliamentary speech by

party chief Lalu Prasad in which he demanded the dismantling of the barrage.

"We are only reproducing what is already in the public domain. Now all eyes are on the NDA government at the Centre, which faces a tight balancing act between regional flood mitigation, demands from Bangladesh for stronger downstream guarantee clauses to wider diplomatic discussions—noted that for any international relationship to function smoothly, both sides must establish a shared landing point.

But even as the state's NDA alliance mounts pressure on the Centre, Bihar's Principal Opposition, the Rashtriya Janata Dal, has been highlighting a 2011 parliamentary speech by



The Indian EXPRESS
— FOUNDED BY —
RAMNATH GOENKA
— IN 1932 —
BECAUSE THE TRUTH
INVOLVES US ALL

It is wrong to cancel Telangana CM's US visit

INSTEAD OF heading to Boston as planned on Sunday, Telangana Chief Minister Revanth Reddy abruptly flew back to India from London — he was denied permission by the Ministry of External Affairs for the US tour, which led to the cancellation of the second leg of his foreign trip. Undoubtedly, denying permission lay in the MEA's merit. Before it accords political clearance, the visits of chief ministers and other dignitaries are assessed by the ministry for criteria such as the "purpose" and "level" of scheduled meetings. And yet, it is unseemly that the MEA should weaponise the rulebook's small print to cut short CM Reddy's trip. Apparently, the CM's itinerary included possible meetings with New York City mayor Zohran Mamdani and US Vice President JD Vance — while the NYC mayor is seen at some levels below the Telangana CM, a meeting with the US Vice President did not fit the trip's stated purpose, which was to attract investment into Telangana, including educational partnerships. This is a narrow-minded approach that does not behave the external affairs ministry of a country like India, which prides itself on its growing confidence on the world stage, and on building global knowledge hubs like Hyderabad. Moreover, by curtailing an opposition chief minister's foreign trip, the government looks small and narrow, sending a dispiriting signal to the world — and within the country.

The denial of permission to CM Reddy can be seen as part of a dismal pattern of antagonism, and the near breakdown of dialogue, between government and Opposition at home. This is so even as Reddy, the second CM of a newly carved out state, who began his career in the ABVP, has been seen to tweak the script — in the past, he has struck a note of pragmatism and cordiality vis-à-vis the government of Narendra Modi. In the aftermath, the political trend has been the recycling of tired and opaque spectres and prejudices — the BJP in Telangana has insinuated that the MEA decision was meant to cut short engagement with "anti-India" and/or "anti-BJP" elements, that are out to destabilise "national security".

After Operation Sindoor in May 2025, the Modi government dispatched seven multi-party delegations, which included prominent leaders of the Opposition, to foreign capitals. They were tasked with making India's case to the world while projecting national unity. The subject, then, was terror, but the message was generally heartening. That whatever be the political differences within, India's ruling establishment trusted and included the Opposition in its dealings with the world. CM Reddy's abbreviated trip now points to an unfortunate and unflattering backsliding.

In saying no to Trump, Carney does right thing

BY INSTRUCTING his negotiators to walk away from trade talks with the US — reportedly over Washington's last-minute demands — Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney has drawn a red line against President Donald Trump's weaponisation of tariffs. Canada's economy is deeply integrated with that of its superpower neighbour, and Carney's "dollar-for-dollar" retaliation against Trump's 50-cent tariff on around \$20 billion worth of Canadian goods will inevitably hurt businesses and workers on both sides of the border. Among other "unacceptable" demands, said PM Carney, Washington seeks to restrict Canada's ability to pursue trade deals with other countries, which would amount to an erosion of Canadian sovereignty. Elected to power not too long ago on a promise to stand up to Trump's threats, Carney has done the right thing by rejecting an unequal trade relationship. In doing so, he is also acting on his assessment at 200 seven months ago. The "rules-based order", he had said, "is fading".

The Trump tariffs touch products from Canadian wine and dairy to furniture, clothing, cement and hockey equipment. Should Carney proceed with Canada's retaliation from September 8 onwards, there will be risks, both political and economic, for his country. But the popularity of the "Buy Canadian" campaign — an expression of economic nationalism triggered by Trump's threats, including making Canada the 51st state of the US — has already shown that many Canadians support their government's challenge to the US president. Carney will now have to convince them that the costs of confrontation are worth paying.

For the Canadian PM, the showdown with Trump is the clearest test yet of his thesis that middle powers must stand up to great powers and unite. Indeed, he has been busy securing deals in Asia and Europe, a paradigm shift away from Canada's economic dependence on the US so far. It is too early to say whether these new partnerships have the substance to mitigate the pain that a breakdown in US-Canada relations will cause. But Carney is doing something rather rare in the Trump era: A middle power is saying no to a superpower.

The humanoid's winning the race. Or is it?

WHO WOULD win in a fight, Mike Tyson or a silverback gorilla? It's a question many have asked, including Tyson himself. Back in the 1980s, the boxing legend was strolling through a zoo with his wife when he came across the ape enclosure, where one big silverback was bullying all the others. Tyson tried to bribe the attendant with \$10,000, the story goes, to open the cage so he could fight the animal, but the employee declined. That was undoubtedly for the best — even the greatest human fighter wouldn't last long against a larger, stronger and more vicious animal.

If human athletes shouldn't be judged on their ability to out-fight a gorilla, they shouldn't be expected to outrun a machine, either. Given that, what's the need for a brouhaha over two Chinese humanoid robots beating Usain Bolt's 100m world record at the World Humanoid Robot Games in Beijing this past weekend? Smartphone maker Honor's robot, Lightning, came second with a time of 9.47s, whereas the winner, Tiangong Ultra, developed by the Beijing Humanoid Robot Innovation Center, clocked 9.39s, compared to Bolt's 9.58s. Someone on a motorbike, another machine, could have done the same.

That aside, the robot games offered their share of finish-line drama — Tiangong careening into the sidelines, Lightning having to be carried away on the stretcher — and there's no reason these events can't be considered entertaining "sports" in their own right. Will they eclipse human athletic competition one day? Neither horses nor cars have stopped people running. The only thing to remember is this: Like should be compared with like.

Gor in Srinagar: A one-man mission to strengthen a sputtering relationship

SERGIO GOR's comment about Jammu and Kashmir being an important part of India has generated banner headlines, and understandably so. Taken literally, his words go against decades of US policy on Kashmir. They are even more noteworthy than President Donald Trump's offer, made soon after Operation Sindoor last year, to work with India and Pakistan to help find a "solution" for Kashmir. That's because Trump's comments actually reflected a past US policy — one espoused in the initial years after 1947, when several administrations sought to help solve the Kashmir issue. The US posture has since evolved from working on it actively to taking a more hands-off role and welcoming any Indian and Pakistani efforts to resolve it themselves.

Additionally, this isn't just any US ambassador to India who made this comment. Gor is an ambassador who also serves as special envoy to South Asia, which gives him ample policy authority over both India and Pakistan. Even more important is that Gor is widely believed to be a close confidant of Trump's.

But as significant as Gor's statement was, it's important not to overstate the implications. This is likely more about Gor's desire to bolster US-India relations than it is about anything having to do with Kashmir.

Unsurprisingly, there's been

Recall that since Gor arrived in New Delhi in January, he has been on a one-man mission to strengthen a sputtering relationship. He has pursued high-level engagements in New Delhi and across Indian states. He has announced conciliatory measures, like inviting India to join the Pax Silica silicon supply-chain initiative after India initially didn't receive an invitation. His messaging about India and US-Indias ties has been unrelentingly positive, in contrast to the sharp criticism directed at India by the White House in the months before Gor took up his ambassadorial post.

Against this backdrop, we can see what was likely at play in Srinagar.

Gor was keen to keep up his positive messaging and broader charm offensive with New Delhi. By saying Kashmir is an "important part of India", he was giving it a handsome compliment and perhaps providing a US rationale for pursuing commercial cooperation with Kashmir — a goal identified by Gor in an X post shortly after his Kashmir visit. Additionally, more broadly, given his proximity to Trump, Gor may have been looking to say something that would go down well with the Indian business community, to help advance an evergreen objective of his boss — attract more foreign investment to the US.

It's also essential not to overstate the implications of Gor's comments for the US-India-Pakistan triangle



MICHAEL KUGELMAN

no formal US statement announcing a new policy on Kashmir. To be sure, Washington also hasn't walked back Gor's comments or clarified that US policy on Kashmir remains the same. But this can perhaps be attributed to a view within US government circles that there's no reason whatsoever to interpret Gor's comments as a policy shift. After all, as several Indian analysts have noted, Gor used the word "important", as opposed to "integral". The latter term is the one often invoked by New Delhi when articulating its position on Kashmir. Additionally, the term "important" is not as closely associated with contexts linked to territoriality.

It's also essential not to overstate the implications of Gor's comments for the US-India-Pakistan triangle. True, Pakistan's foreign ministry summoned the US charge d'affaires, Nathalie Baker, soon after Gor's comments. But that move shouldn't be read as a threat to a resurgent US-Pakistan partnership. It's very unusual for a US official to say anything about Kashmir that goes against Pakistan's position. And this is Kashmir — what multiple Pakistani leaders have described as the country's "jugar vein".

In this sense, Islamabad had no choice but to rapidly summon Baker, But Pakistani officials have been quiet ever since. And that's no surprise; they have no

interest in rocking the boat with a US administration on which they badly want to remain on good terms, given its stated interest in capitalising on commercial opportunities in Pakistan — and in partnering in a range of spaces, from counterterrorism to peace mediation in the Middle East.

Meanwhile, Gor's comments may deliver a boost to US-India ties, but not much more than that.

The Indian government has said little about them publicly, and much of the messaging from Indian voices — from officials in Kashmir to prominent independent analysts — has essentially revolved around the view that what the US thinks about Kashmir ultimately doesn't matter, given that it's India's issue. This ho-hum reaction may also be a reflection of the trust gap in India when it comes to Washington these days — a problem that Gor, despite his best efforts, has so far been unable to fix.

Ultimately, given the significance of what Gor said and who he is, it would be wrong to dismiss all this as much ado about nothing. But at the end of the day, there's no change in policy or diplomatic alignments to speak of. It's just another case of an unconventional administration doing unconventional things.

The writer is resident senior fellow for South Asia at Atlantic Council, Washington, DC

The Mecca pact is for joint defence. Against whom?



DP SRIVASTAVA

THOUGH THERE is a pause in the shooting war, the situation in West Asia continues to be volatile. The Strait of Hormuz remains closed. Houthi attacks on the Bab el-Mandeb at the mouth of the Red Sea have closed the second waterway for the transport of Saudi oil to Asian markets. This also affects shipments of Russian crude oil to India. Amid these developments, Saudi Arabia, Turkey and Pakistan have signed the Mecca Joint Defence Agreement. This raises the question: Joint defence against whom? There could be three possible threats: The Houthis, Iran, and Israel.

The joint statement issued after the Makkah Al-Mukarramah Summit stipulates that "any armed attack against any of the three states shall be regarded as an attack against them all". However, the extent and nature of commitments by the three countries for joint defence are not known. Nor has the geographical scope of such an arrangement been spelt out. Will this include conflicts outside West Asia? Can Pakistan invoke it in case of an Indian riposte to a future terror attack?

Has the Mecca Agreement created an Islamic NATO? Article 5 of the North Atlantic Treaty provides for collective self-defence but limits its scope to Europe. The only time Article 5 was invoked was in Afghanistan, post 9/11. NATO's travails in Ukraine and absence in the Iran war point to the fact that what matters is common threat perception, not a formal pact. Within the Mecca Agreement, the threat perceptions differ. Houthi attacks on Red Sea shipping do not pose a direct threat to Turkey or Pakistan. Turkey is more concerned with the Israeli presence in Syria. Pakistan regards India and Afghanistan as threats. In 2015, Pakistan did not take part in the action against the Houthis despite requests from Saudi Arabia and the UAE.

Is the Mecca Agreement an alliance of Sunnis powers against Shia Iran? Iran has emerged as the most important regional power, having withstood more than 23,000 Israeli and US bombing raids in the war. Can Turkey and Pakistan provide Saudi Arabia with the protection from Iranian retaliation that the US could not? However, they do not mind sharing Saudi riches. The accord gives Pakistan a diplomatic profile at a time when its economy is sinking and it is beset by internal problems in Balochistan and PoK. Saudi Arabia and Pakistan had signed a Strategic

Mutual Defence Agreement (SMDA) last year. A Pakistan Air Force contingent and 13,000 ground troops were deployed in the eastern part of Saudi Arabia in April this year. Did the Pakistanis fire a single shot in discharge of their obligations under the SMDA?

The third possible threat is Israel. PM Netanyahu's pronouncement of a Greater Israel may have made Arab governments uncomfortable. However, the US umbrella could provide better protection to Saudi interests than Turkey could.

The trilateral pact has not gone unnoticed in Tehran. The influential daily Kayhan, close to the IRGC, has carried a strong editorial against Pakistan, questioning its credentials as a neutral mediator in Iran's talks with the US. In Pakistan, Shia cleric Jawad Naqvi has already criticised the government for joining the alliance.

India has friendly relations with Saudi Arabia. It is a good customer for Saudi oil. Saudi Arabia has a mature diplomatic establishment. It will nevertheless be useful to sensitise them to our concerns. If attacked, India is bound to exercise its right of self-defence.

The lasting solution to the West Asia crisis is mainstreaming Iran, so that it has a stake in a peaceful region. The June 17 MoU holds the promise of lifting both secondary and primary sanctions against Iran. This goes beyond the Obama-era nuclear deal. Iran's capacity to dominate Hormuz is tacitly recognised by all countries. This should be used as a deterrent against future aggression, rather than as a toll, which would bring a small fraction of the revenue Iran could earn from the export of its oil and petrochemicals once sanctions are lifted. The US should lift the blockade. The nuclear issue need not be insurmountable. Iran has already committed in the MoU to not "procure or develop nuclear weapons". The US has to moderate its demands. Insistence on "zero enrichment" will only be a deal-breaker. Iran has a legitimate sense of grievance. It was twice attacked by Israel and the US amid negotiations. But the future of its people is more important. The alternative to an agreement is continued disruption of global oil supplies, loss of revenue for the Gulf states and Iran, and chaos in West Asia.

The writer is former ambassador to Iran. He negotiated the Chabahar Agreement

Counting out the disabled citizens



SHASHANK PANDEY



AARTI BATRA

SELF-ENUMERATION for Census 2027 began on August 17 in Jammu and Kashmir, Haryana, Punjab, Rajasthan and Uttar Pradesh, ahead of door-to-door enumeration from September 1 and the national count in February 2027. Having examined the disability question, we find apprehensions of an undercount well-founded.

Question 13 asks whether the respondent is a person with disability and permits up to three selections from nine: Seeing, hearing, speech, mobility, intellectual disability, mental illness, acid attack, chronic neurological disease and, now, blood disorder. This appears to be an improvement: Nine categories rather than the eight of 2011, blood disorder introduced, and "mental retardation" replaced with "intellectual disability". But it is inadequate.

The Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016 expanded recognised conditions from seven to 21, including dwarfism, cerebral palsy, autism spectrum disorder and specific learning disabilities, each with entitlements such as certification, reservation and welfare. None will appear as a distinct category in the Census. Autism is often recorded as intellectual disability by certification boards lacking the capacity or intent to distinguish them. The Census mentions intellectual disability without a separate entry for autism and other developmental conditions, reproducing that error at national scale. This misidentification leads to real consequences in early interventions, education and employment.

The schedule has also regressed: The options for multiple disabilities and "any other" have been withdrawn, and it is unclear whether 13(b)'s three selections will be recorded as multiple disabilities or as duplicate counts. The options are the broad heads of the Disability Act, until acid attack appears, although the statute shunted it within locomotor disability. Placing a narrow sub-condition beside an umbrella term like mobility raises the question of what governed this classification. The customary response is the Unique Disability ID database will supply what the Census omits — does not hold. UID registration reaches only about half the disabled population as per the last Census figures. Census data is crucial to map this access gap. Enumeration is proceeding in districts where assessment infrastructure is thinnest and formal diagnosis rare due to lack of specialists. The training material has no adequate guidance on how to enquire when a respondent hesitates to disclose mental illness, or how an enumerator without clinical training might recognise intellectual disability.

Welfare allocations depend on disaggregated data. Parliament recognised thalassemia, haemophilia and sickle cell disease as distinct conditions. A single figure for blood disorder doesn't convey this, and neither the National Sickle Cell Anaemia Elimination Mission nor thalassemia care under the National Health Mission can be evaluated without a baseline. Specific learning disabilities, absent altogether, present another difficulty: Remediation must be available where most affected children live. Education departments are left with CSO estimates.

None of this required reinventing the Census, only aligning the question with the statute — by adopting all 21 recognised conditions or, at minimum, restoring multiple disabilities and a structured "other, please specify" — and training those who ask the questions. The Census returns once in a decade. If this occasion is missed, a generation of disabled Indians will grow up undercounted, underbudgeted and invisible to the state.

Pandey is a lawyer and founder of the Politics and Disability Forum. Batra is co-founder of Believe in the Invisible

40 YEARS AGO

August 25, 1986



Threat of crackdown in Pakistan

THE PAKISTANI government warned that it would resort to "drastic action" unless opposition groups and their drive to oust President Zia-ul-Haq and force early elections. But the leaders of the Movement for the Restoration of Democracy said they would not abandon the campaign. Security officials said the country was quiet and there had been no clashes between anti-government activists and security forces.

Revolt against Benazir Bhutto

TWO SENIOR associates of the Pakistan People's Party (PPP) leader, Benazir Bhutto,

have broken ranks to set up a rival opposition party in Pakistan, accusing Bhutto of being an "autocrat out of touch with the people". Ghulam Mustafa Jatoi, a former chief minister of Sindh province, and Ghulam Mustafa Khar, a former chief minister and governor of Punjab province, will join forces to formally launch a new party at a convention at Lahore.

Three gunned down in Punjab

SUSPECTED TERRORISTS killed three people and looted a petrol pump in different parts of Punjab during the last 24 hours. Two suspected terrorists gunned down three passengers in a car near the village of Budhsinghwal in Faridkot district. The ter-

rorists wielding sten guns stopped the car and shot their victims. The police and the CRPF rushed to the spot immediately and started combing operations.

India fined for CWG boycott

INDIA has been asked to pay \$245,000, about Rs 4.4 million, for having boycotted the 13th Commonwealth Games in Edinburgh last year. The 32 entrants who boycotted the games have been asked to pay £2.7 million the newspaper publisher Robert Maxwell said. The boycott was in protest against the British government's refusal to impose wide-ranging economic sanctions against South Africa.

The Ideas Page

TUESDAY, AUGUST 25, 2026

• **WHAT THE OTHERS SAY**
Netanyahu is dragging Israel into another pointless conflict — this time with Turkey — Haaretz, Israel



Could perverse incentives lead to inflated OBC numbers in Census? Answer is no



DESHKAAL
BY YOGENDRA YADAV

I RECEIVED a pleasant surprise last week. In an article in this newspaper ('Count caste by all means, But abandon belief that counting settles anything' *IE*, August 21), Surjit Bhalla, no *dinagi* Naxal by any stretch, endorsed the central claims I have been making in these pages on the caste census. Bhalla favours a caste census. And he does so for the right reasons: "Yes. Count caste — India allocates education and employment on caste." I have been arguing for years that it is a scandal for a country to have legally enforced quotas for a social group — the OBCs — and not count its population. Bhalla also shares my assessment that the caste census is now dead, actually being killed by the government: "Yadav is right that the [caste] Census is now being killed by design." And he agrees with my analysis of why the Modi government has done so: "His disavowal of caste politics behind the technical choice of the wording of the caste question is sort of persuasive."

I could not ask for more. I should have just posted his article on social media, while thanking and tagging him. But there is a technical twist in this tantalising tale. Bhalla wants me to realise that even in the absence of sabotage, the caste census would not have told us "the truth" and advise us to "abandon the belief that counting [castes] settles anything". This does disservice to his own position and begs a question: Why should we trouble the already burdened Census enumerator with this additional question if its answer does not settle "anything"?

Minus such verbal excesses, the main argument in Bhalla's article is fairly straightforward. Counting castes by using a top-down menu of categories like SC/ST/OBC is bound to produce unreliable data. If the Central Creator IAS Edition <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029a2vR8tRGjOK3H6dK0F>

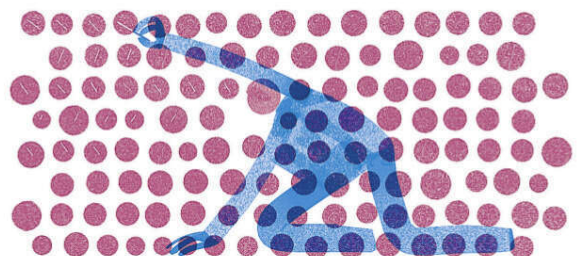


ILLUSTRATION: C.S. RAKSHAM

allows every person to choose a caste category, which is linked to his or her entitlements, we are creating a perverse incentive to lie, to claim membership of a category to which the person does not belong. This could lead to a massive exaggeration in the numbers for OBCs. Hence his suggestion: "Ask for caste, sub-caste and surname, never for category." He lays out a dazzling array of data to make an innocuous point: Human beings respond to incentives. Indeed, no proof was required for this.

Sadly, Bhalla chooses a bad example to make an otherwise valid point. He presents the unusual rise in the estimated population of OBCs between the 55th (1999-2000) and 61st (2004-05) rounds of the National Sample Survey as evidence of incentivised manipulation in caste numbers. He correctly shows that such a rise could not have happened due to an increase in population. But he wrongly assumes that this must have been caused by respondents falsely reporting OBC status to claim entitlements. He does not mention that 1999 was the first time OBCs were counted in the NSS and were thus prone to being under-counted. He does not examine a competing and compelling hypothesis: OBC was still a recent category in 1999, and many more OBCs were unfamiliar with it than compared to five years

While dissecting data from 1999 and 2004, Bhalla does not share the figures for 2009-10, 2014 and 2017-18, which report a fairly stable share for OBCs — between 42 and 43 per cent

later. Most importantly, while dissecting the data from 1999 and 2004, Bhalla does not care to share the NSS figures for 2009-10, 2014 and 2017-18, which report a fairly stable share for OBCs — between 42 and 43 per cent. If the respondents were over-reporting OBC status, why did this trend halt in 2004?

Regardless, let's stick to his general argument about perverse incentives that might lead to exaggeration of population numbers for the OBCs in the coming Census. That would be a valid apprehension if you do not know something basic about the Census of India, a surprising omission on Bhalla's part. Section 15 of the Census Act, 1948 guards the privacy of Census responses and says that Census records are not open to public scrutiny and cannot be used as evidence in a civil or criminal court. The Supreme Court has reiterated that no person can use his or her self-declaration in Census responses to claim entitlements, reservation, or any statutory benefits. In sum: There is zero individual incentive to misreport your category in the Census.

If not an individual one, is there a collective incentive for social groups to inflate their numbers in the Census to claim higher community benefits, say, a higher quota for OBCs? Theoretically, yes. But why would the non-OBCs participate in such a conspiracy if there

are no individual gains for misreporting? Besides, history belies such apprehensions: If entitlements incentive were lying in the Census, why has the population share of SCs and STs not leapt up beyond credible population trends in the last seven decennial censuses?

Now that the perverse incentive theory is laid to rest, may I invite Bhalla to rethink whatever remains of our difference on this issue. Although he does not spell out his alternative, it seems Bhalla does not favour an open-ended question on caste that simply records any answer offered by the respondent. As a seasoned survey researcher himself, Bhalla would know that it would be an invitation to a data disaster — millions of responses that defy post-coding. I understand his opposition is to a stand-alone caste category question — Are you SC/ST/OBC/General — as this method is vulnerable to large-scale errors. But that is not the proposal from the proponents of the caste census.

What we are suggesting is what survey researchers call a two-stage hierarchical question using cascading response categories. This is exactly how the question about SC and ST has always been asked in the census: First you are asked to choose a category, then presented with a list of caste names within that category to choose from. In case you choose the wrong category, the drop-down menu in the next question helps to rectify it there and then. So, our proposal is that the same should be extended this time to the OBCs and the General category. As for Bhalla's fair insistence that professional sociologists should be involved in classifying castes and sub-castes, I may again point out that this job has already been done by various commissions in the case of OBCs. And by the 43-volume *People of India* series by the Anthropological Survey of India for the rest. Why reinvent the wheel, if the desire is not to sabotage the caste count?

This is not meant to be a rebuttal. I really hope to persuade Surjit Bhalla, whose voice carries weight with the present dispensation, unlike mine.

The writer is member, Swaraj India, and national convener, Bharat Jodo Abhiyaan. Views are personal

Opposition has only one agenda: Disrupting Parliament



KIREN RIJJU

A CURIOUS formula now passes for democratic concern in sections of our political and commentariat classes: Disrupt Parliament, prevent Question Hour, shout down ministers, reject offers of debate and then publish solemn articles lamenting that Parliament did not debate.

Critics have cited the Monsoon Session's numbers: The Lok Sabha functioned for 15 per cent of its scheduled time and the Rajya Sabha for 33 per cent. Question Hour operated for barely 1 per cent of its allotted time in the Lok Sabha and 12 per cent in the Rajya Sabha. But these numbers cannot be separated from their cause. The same analysis records that the session was marked by repeated disruptions and adjournments. The Opposition's arithmetic is therefore deeply cynical: First ensure that Parliament cannot function, and then use the resulting loss of time as evidence against the government.

The Constitution gives the Opposition every right to question, criticise, protest, move amendments and vote against the government. It does not give the Opposition a remote control with which it may switch Parliament off whenever its political demands are not accepted. The government has listened, negotiated, amended legislation and accommodated legitimate concerns. What it will not do is surrender the people's mandate to an Opposition that paralyses Parliament and then cites that paralysis as proof of authoritarianism.

Nothing exposes the shallowness of the present campaign more clearly than the Opposition's own response when it was offered the parliamentary debate it claimed to want. On the Lantar Mantar protests, Union Home Minister Amit Shah offered a detailed discussion in Parliament. He offered to begin the debate at 3 pm that day and continue it until 3 pm the following day. He committed to responding to the questions raised. The Leader of the Opposition, Rahul Gandhi, rejected the offer, declaring that the Opposition was not interested in the Home Minister's "lecture". A leader genuinely denied a debate seizes a 24-hour offer. He does not dismiss it as a lecture. One cannot refuse a full parliamentary discussion and then complain that Parliament has been silenced.

The contradiction becomes even more striking when seen against Rahul Gandhi's own parliamentary record. During the 17th Lok Sabha, he recorded just 51 per cent attendance, participated in eight debates against a national average of 46.7, asked 99 questions against an average of 210, and introduced no Private Member's Bill. Yet he now declares that the government has "destroyed our democracy". He goes to the UK, Germany and the US and complains about the lack of democracy in India. But he doesn't have the gall to attend Parliament and seek accountability. Neither he nor the Congress party are defenders of democracy. They excel in political theatre bordering on parody.

The allegation that the government refuses to listen is equally detached from the record. When concerns were raised regarding the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, the government referred the Bill to a Joint Parliamentary Committee for detailed examination. Remarkably, sections of the Opposition opposed even the JPC referral and demanded that the Bill be withdrawn altogether. This reveals the real problem. For some Opposition parties, consultation no longer means that the government should listen. It means that the government must surrender. Debate is considered meaningless unless the minister accepts the Opposition's conclusions in advance.

The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill provides an instructive example. The Lok Sabha debated it for nearly 11 hours, with 48 MPs participating. The Rajya Sabha discussed it for more than six-and-a-half hours, with 35 members taking part. This was not a law being "rammed through".

The government also engaged directly with Sonam Wangchuk during his hunger strike. Following discussions, he subsequently ended his 26-day fast. Prime Minister Narendra Modi personally appeared to him to follow medical advice and prayed for his recovery.

Consider the democratic sequence: A protest was held; civil society concerns were heard; Union ministers engaged with the protester; written assurances were provided; the Prime Minister responded; Parliament conducted an extensive debate; and legislation was strengthened. It is difficult to imagine a more democratic chain of engagement and accountability.

Parliament belongs neither to the government nor to the Opposition. It belongs to the people of India. The mandate they have delivered is not a decorative certificate that may be suspended whenever defeated parties choose disruption over argument.

Slogans outside the House cannot substitute for arguments inside it. Those who cannot defeat a government through debate or the ballot cannot be permitted to defeat Parliament through noise.

The writer is Union Minister of Parliamentary Affairs and Minister of Minority Affairs

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Jobs for youth

AS A young Indian, I feel that a job is not merely a means of earning a living ("What young man, and why creating good jobs, is no longer optional," *IE*, August 24). We want stability, fair wages and a genuine chance to grow. Education must lead to employable skills, and apprenticeships should connect young people with actual workplaces. Small businesses also need easier credit and fewer hurdles. Creating enough decent jobs must become a clear priority if India's young population is to become its strength.

S.M. Jeeva, Chennai

Politics and policy

INVESTMENT DECISIONS cannot be separated from political stability, institutional credibility and predictable rules ("Investment question has a political answer," *IE*, August 24). The article rightly points to the risks created when economic policy becomes too dependent on political considerations. India needs stronger regulatory institutions, transparent decision-making and stable taxation to sustain investor confidence. Public investment should crowd in private capital rather than replace it. A competitive economy requires sound markets and good governance, with policy continuity despite changes in political leadership.

A Senthil Kumar, Kaniyur

Restrain Israel

CONTINUED SETTLEMENT expansion in the West Bank makes a negotiated settlement harder and risks deepening an already serious conflict ("Israel's West Bank settlements long-term peace," *IE*, August 24). Whatever the disagreements, civilian security and international law must remain central. India, with long-standing ties with both sides, can support dialogue and a credible two-state framework. Major powers should press for restraint rather than allowing facts on the ground to determine the region's future. Durable peace requires sustained engagement, not territorial colonization.

K.P. Muthukumar, Chennai



MANOJ KUMAR JHA

THERE ARE books that record an era, and then there are books that interrogate the future. Hiren Mukherjee's *Portrait of Parliament: Reflections and Recollections (1952-77)* belongs to the latter category. Written by one of my favourite parliamentarians, the book is a meditation on what Parliament means to a democracy and what happens to a democracy when Parliament itself begins to forget what it is meant to be.

Mukherjee sounded a warning that appears prophetic today. He lamented the growing "deterioration in parliamentary functioning" and cautioned that if Parliament failed to prize its own dignity, its powers, too, would be imperilled. At the time, many may have regarded it as the melancholic reflection of an old parliamentarian witnessing inevitable institutional change. Today, it reads more like a diagnosis.

Parliament was conceived not as an appendage of executive authority but as the sovereign arena where the nation could converse with itself. The executive had to govern and Parliament had to hold power accountable. Increasingly, however, Parliament appears to be losing its deliberative soul. The first symptom of decay is the concentration of power in the executive. Parliamentary democracies function on the principle that governments derive legitimacy from legislatures and remain accountable to them. However, this relation has gradually become inverted. Parliament today often appears as an institution expected to ratify decisions already taken elsewhere.

The question before us is not whether Parliament remains constitutionally supreme. The more troubling question is whether it still possesses the moral confidence to act as the nation's conscience

The Opposition, constitutionally intended to be a watchdog rather than an enemy, increasingly finds itself being treated as an inconvenience. But the health of a legislature is measured not by the comfort of the treasury benches but by the confidence with which dissent can be articulated.

The second symptom is the decline of debate. Mukherjee belonged to a generation that regarded preparation for parliamentary intervention as an ethical responsibility. Disagreement could be sharp, even ideological. Opponents were challenged, but not dehumanised as has become the norm these days. Today, much of parliamentary communication is designed not for persuasion within the House but for circulation outside it. Speeches increasingly seek virality rather than illumination. The result is a paradox: Parliament is more visible than ever and yet less heard.

The third symptom is the erosion of institutional memory. Parliament survives not merely through rules but through conventions — unwritten understandings that teach restraint to power and responsibility to the Opposition. Once these conventions weaken, the rulebook cannot save democratic culture. The tragedy of contemporary politics is that institutional continuity is often dismissed as elitist, while disruption is celebrated as authenticity. When debate declines, politics does not become calmer; it becomes more polarised outside the institution.

A fourth symptom is the diminishing role of parliamentary committees and other mechanisms of

scrutiny. The committee system was designed to allow detailed examination away from the heat of parliamentary contestation. Representation has certainly deepened. But representation without deliberation is incomplete. Mukherjee defended a principle: The idea that democracy requires institutions capable of slowing down power and compelling it to explain itself. That principle is under strain now. When parliamentary sessions become shorter, when scrutiny becomes weaker, when disagreement is portrayed as obstruction, and when political majorities begin to confuse electoral victory with institutional entitlement, democracy loses one of its most vital safeguards.

The true measure of Parliament is not how loudly the government speaks, but how fearlessly questions can be asked. It is not the speed with which legislation is passed, but the depth with which it is examined. It is not the size of a majority, but the space available for minorities. The question before us is not whether Parliament remains constitutionally supreme. The more troubling question is whether it still possesses the moral confidence to act as the nation's conscience. Mukherjee's *Portrait of Parliament* reminds us that democratic institutions rarely decay overnight. Their renewal, if political will still permits it, may also have to begin quietly with the recovery of a simple but profound belief: That Parliament is not an obstacle to governance. It is governance in its most democratic form.

The writer is Member of Parliament, Rajya Sabha, Rashtriya Janata Dal

Question for Delhi Master Plan: Whose city is it?



AMIR HYDER KHAN

DELHI'S AMBITIOUS Master Plan for 2047 promises new housing, transit-oriented development, economic corridors and expanded infrastructure as part of the larger project of making the capital a globally competitive city. But behind these targets lies a more fundamental question: Who gets to belong to the Delhi being built? Planning is often presented as a technical exercise involving land use, density and infrastructure. In reality, it determines who gets access to housing, employment and public space, who benefits from rising land values and who bears the costs of development.

The G20 Summit in 2023 offered a

glimpse of this contradiction. As Delhi prepared to host global leaders, roadside vendors were removed from prominent locations and informal settlements screened from public view. It exposed an uncomfortable truth: Delhi needs its informal workers to be visible. Street vendors, construction workers, domestic workers, sanitation workers, small traders and delivery riders are essential to the Capital's functioning. Yet they are frequently treated as obstacles to a cleaner and more "planned" city.

Gig workers make this contradiction particularly clear. Delhi's platform economy increasingly depends on delivery riders who move through the city at all hours. Yet conventional planning rarely recognises them as an urban constituency. A delivery worker

needs safe parking, toilets, drinking water, charging points, rest spaces and affordable housing close to employment hubs. Housing presents a similar problem. The existence of housing in peripheral locations alongside informal housing closer to employment shows the limitations of a numbers-based approach. For a low-income household, housing cost includes rent, transport, commute time, childcare and access to work. A formally affordable house can be unaffordable if reaching work consumes hours

Planning determines who gets access to housing, employment and public space, who benefits from rising land values and who bears the costs of development

and a significant share of income. Caste and occupation shape access to housing, land, dignity and public services. Workers in precarious occupations face the securities that cannot be captured by income classifications alone. Likewise, women's inclusion cannot be achieved simply by adding toilets or childcare facilities. The location of affordable housing affects commuting, unpaid care work and access to employment. Housing, transport and care infrastructure must be planned together.

The same principle applies to persons with disabilities. A ramp is meaningless if the pavement leading to it is inaccessible or public transport cannot be reached independently. The test should be whether a person with a disability can independently travel from home to wherever necessary for work, education, healthcare and recreation.

Rehabilitation must also protect livelihoods. The principle of "*Jahan Jhuggi, wahan makaan*" is important, but relocation of the poor simply means moving residents to distant housing. It also raises the question of who captures the value created by public investment. New Metro lines and commercial corridors increase surrounding land values. If these gains accrue primarily to property owners while poorer residents are priced out, public investment risks producing private wealth while socialising displacement.

The real test of Delhi 2047 is not whether the capital becomes richer, taller or more connected. It is whether the people who build, clean, deliver, drive and sustain the city can still afford a place in its future.

Khan is a Delhi-based architect

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY
E-Tendering Tender Notice
Open e-tenders on "Single Packet System" through E-Tender Notice No. IZM-ENHML-ERW-PW-42-75-26 are invited by Sr. Divisional Mechanical Engineer (EnHML), N.E. Railway, Izzatnagar for and on behalf of President of India for the following work:-
Name of Work: Supply and Installation of Motorized Valve and Water flow meter at coating depot KLU, LKU, RMR, KSJ, TSDCBJ and IZN Railway Station. **Estimated Value of work(₹):** ₹39,45,667.48
Earliest Money(₹): ₹78,955/-
Kind of tender form(₹): Nil. Period of Work: 06 Months. Date and time for closing of E-tender: 15.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs. *Tender must be submitted till E-Tenders online upto 15.00 hrs. on 15.09.2026. *Please go to the Indian Railways website www.irps.gov.in to see the complete details and upload/submit the E-tender.
Sr. DME (EnHML) Izzatnagar
CPR/Mech-74
DO NOT SMOKE CIGARETTES IN TRAINS

WESTERN RAILWAY
DESIGN, SUPPLY, INSTALLATION, TESTING AND COMMISSIONING WORK
CSTEN/WHICCO, Western Railway, Shri Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Building, Chhatrapati, Mumbai-400 020, invites Tender No. SG.217.01.2026 Dated: 19/08/2026. Work and Location: Design, supply, installation, testing and commissioning of TMS (Train Management System) in Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Building, Chhatrapati, Mumbai-400 020. **Approx. Cost of Work:** ₹88,58,82,566.17. **Earliest Money(₹):** ₹17,70,00,00/- **Tender Closing Date & Time:** On 28.09.2026 At 15:00 Hrs. For further details please visit our website www.irps.gov.in to see the complete details and upload/submit the E-tender.
Like us on [Facebook.com/WesternRail](https://www.facebook.com/WesternRail)

dholera
A NEW ERA
Dholera Industrial City Development Limited

Tenders are invited from reputed and experienced agencies for the following. The salient features, eligibility criteria and prescribed formats for submission of tender are available at the procurement portal link: dctender.pnprocure.com, as mentioned in below table, as amending from time to time including time extension, if any.

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Sr. No.	Description	Bid Due Date (Online)
1	RFQ cum RFP for "Appointment of Project Management Consultant for Service Area Buildings and other Miscellaneous Project in the Action Area of the Dholera Special Investment Region (DSIR), Dholera"	03.09.2026 Upto 15:00 Hrs

Physical Bid Submission: Within 07 days from the Online Bid Due Date

The Tender submission shall be accompanied with the requisite Tender Fee, EMD, Forms, supporting documents, etc. as required in the Tender Document. The Tender submission must be addressed to: Managing Director - DICDL

8/ Floor, Block No. 1 and 2, Udyog Bhawan, Sector-11, Gandhinagar-382011, Gujarat, India. Phone : +91 - 079-29750501, Cell : 04520951061/05838539
Email : tender@dicdl.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tender Notice
Date: 21.08.2026

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer Co-ordination North Central Railway/Pragraya, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite E-TENDER on prescribed form for the following works upto to 15.00 hrs. on 15.09.2026. The details of the Tenders is as under :-

S. N. 1 Tender No.: PRVJ-Sig-407-2026-27

Name of Work: "S&T work for provision of shifting of Electronic Interlocking equipment from Khurda ASM old building to Khurda ASM new building and S&T work for Extension of platform No. 1 to A to Alipah station."

Approx. Cost of work (₹): ₹ 848034.72/- (Eight-Four Lakhs Eight Thousand Four Hundred thirty seven and Two Paise Only)

Bid Security/Earnest Money (₹): 169600.00 **Completion Period:** 12 Months **Date of Closing of tender:** 15.09.2026

2. Availability of tender form: Tender forms shall be available on www.irps.gov.in 21 days prior to tender opening of the tender. **3. Earnest Money to be deposited:** The prescribed amount of Earnest Money as mentioned above must be deposited along with the tender form. The tenderer(s) should note that, Tenders without earnest money must be summarily rejected. **4. Time, date & place of opening of tender:** Tender will be opened through E-tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Pragraya from 08 am or after pre-determined date at 15:30 hours. In case tender opening date happens to be a holiday, Tenders will be opened on the next working day. **5. Validity of offer:** 60 days from the date of opening. **6. Right of Refusal to accept tender:** Railway administration reserves the rights to postpone/modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons. **7. Award of contract:** The award of contract shall be made on the basis of the lowest price. **8. Bid opening:** The bid opening will be held on 15.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs. **9. Bid opening:** The bid opening will be held on 15.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs. **10. Bid opening:** The bid opening will be held on 15.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs. **11. Bid opening:** The bid opening will be held on 15.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs. **12. Bid opening:** The bid opening will be held on 15.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs. **13. Bid opening:** The bid opening will be held on 15.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs. **14. Bid opening:** The bid opening will be held on 15.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs. **15. Bid opening:** The bid opening will be held on 15.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs. **16. Bid opening:** The bid opening will be held on 15.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs. **17. Bid opening:** The bid opening will be held on 15.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs. **18. Bid opening:** The bid opening will be held on 15.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs. **19. Bid opening:** The bid opening will be held on 15.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs. **20. 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'INDIA IS WORKING TO OPEN THE DOORS TO INTERNATIONAL ENGAGEMENT'

India, Japan to review trade pact, streamline investments: Official

Sandeep Singh & Avi Dutta Mishra
Tokyo/New Delhi, August 24

INDIA IS set to review its trade agreement with Japan signed in 2011 with an aim to fix the widening trade gap with the country and streamline committed investments worth 10 trillion yen (over \$62 billion) in the next 10 years, a government official said on Monday. This comes as a delegation of over 220 stakeholders from Indian industry, led by the Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal, is in Japan from 24th to 27th August to deepen collaboration with their Japanese counterparts.

Pitching for investment in India, Goyal at a roundtable here said that India is the fastest-growing large nation in the world and is poised to become a \$30 trillion economy by 2047. Bridging this gap is clearly on the agenda, and a roadmap has been laid out, Goyal said, adding that India is working to open the doors to international engagement.

"Today we have free trade agreements (FTAs) or preferential market access in markets Real Creator IAS Edition https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2nRbGCGOKf6m8D0F

worth \$17 trillion," he said.

"I have three suggestions or asks, as I invite you to leverage the cost competitiveness of our FTAs and our engineering talent. I urge each one of you present in India and those who will be coming to deepen your localisation. It will help you become even more cost-competitive and actually help you supply your components to the rest of the world. The government is also willing to support your innovation funding," Goyal said.

Goyal cited the example of the first large investment by Suzuki Motor Corporation in the 1980s and said that the market cap of Suzuki in India is over 16 times that of the parent company Suzuki Motor Corporation. Stating that "some of the largest and most profitable operations are coming out of India," the minister pointed to the journey of 1,580 Japanese companies in India, adding that "We would like to see 1,580 more of our kind of companies in India and the doubling of the number of the companies operating out of India."

Piyush Goyal held several meetings during the day, including with Japanese counterparts.

• TRADERESET

INDIA AIMS to fix the widening trade gap with Japan and streamline committed investment worth 10 trillion yen (over \$62 billion) in the next 10 years

INDIAN DELEGATION, led by the Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal, is in Japan from 24th to 27th August to deepen collaboration with their Japanese counterparts

Real Creator IAS Edition https://t.me/+2RvD_RG0mjlMgM1 Further, during the fireside chat with Nikkei Asia editor-in-chief Akito Tanaka, he said "We only use safeguards for the low end of the market, which is available in India. In any country, there will be certain areas where there are conflicting demands: local industries... foreign companies coming into the country, protecting certain sectors... sensitivities and because of that it could lead to a situation where in certain areas you may find it difficult to immediately get the attention of the policymakers..."

"But ours is a listening government; we have Invest India, which supports and handholds investors into India. The Commerce and Industry Ministry is working very actively to bring investment into the country and is always in the service of investors and business to help them in their journey in India and wherever possible we sort out the case," Goyal said.

Sandeep Singh is in Japan at the invitation of FICCI.

Meiji, Serum eye vaccine tie-up

Tokyo/New Delhi: Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal also discussed opportunities to strengthen India-Japan cooperation in the pharmaceutical sector and avenues to expand manufacturing and R&D with the President & Representative Director of Meiji Seika Pharma, Toshiaki Nagasato. The CEO, after the meeting, said that Meiji Seika Pharma is looking to partner with the Serum Institute of India for the supply of vaccines for Japanese Encephalitis. ENS



investors into India. The Commerce and Industry Ministry is working very actively to bring investment into the country and is always in the service of investors and business to help them in their journey in India and wherever possible we sort out the case," Goyal said.

Sandeep Singh is in Japan at the invitation of FICCI.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Gold at 3-mth high, India demand rises

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, August 24

AFTER WEEKS of correction, gold prices have rebounded to their highest level in over three months, led by a weaker dollar, easing expectations of a US Federal Reserve rate hike and US Treasury measures to manage its debt, which have boosted demand for alternative assets.

The precious metal now trades above \$4,600 per ounce on the London Bullion Market Association, the highest level since mid-May, and up over 16% from the \$3,900-\$4,000 levels just last month. It has also followed a similar pattern in the Indian market, now trading at around Rs 16 lakh per 10 grams on the Multi Commodity Exchange.

The rally follows the US Treasury's announcement last week that it will at least double buybacks of its longer-term bonds to maintain yields amid high US government debt levels, leading to yields subsidising a bit.

Lower yields are positive for gold as they lower the opportunity cost of holding a non-yield-bearing asset, making it a good asset for safe-haven demand.

The treasury's market intervention has also weakened the dollar due to an infusion of liquidity in the market, making the precious metal more affordable.

"The recent yield rise suggests that investors no longer as-

sume the Treasury supply will be absorbed effortlessly. Instead, the balance between supply and demand has become an increasingly important determinant of pricing," noted Johan Palmberg, Senior Portfolio Analyst at the World Gold Council (WGC). "Our view is that the positives would likely outweigh the negatives and likely invite substantial interest in gold," he added.

While the Treasury intervention last week fueled gains, gold had already been rising prior to that as prospects of a rate hike by the Fed eased. The market is now pricing in just a 38% chance of the central bank hiking interest rates in its meeting this month, compared to a nearly 84% chance a month ago.

Chances of the Fed maintaining a status quo on rates for the remainder of the year have also increased recently, after the last few meetings showed that some of its members had favoured a rate hike.

Meanwhile, the demand for gold in the Indian market has picked up as the festive season draws close, spurred by the correction in prices since hitting a peak around late January. A recovery in demand for the jewellery industry and continued interest in gold as an investment avenue have driven this demand, said the WGC.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

SEBI rejects Adani-linked offshore fund's requests

Mumbai: The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) rejected applications last week from at least three Mauritius-based funds with investments in the Adani Group to settle cases of regulatory violation in favour of failure to disclose their shareholder details, two sources

with direct knowledge of the matter said.

Thirteen offshore investors of the Adani Group have been under SEBI investigation since Hindenburg Research in 2023 alleged the group's improper use of tax havens, triggering a stock sell-off. REUTERS



On a regional basis, Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, and Delhi together account for over half of India's total Claude use. REUTERS

with per-capita income. India's per-capita use is consistent with what this relationship would predict. Without ad-

ressing structural barriers related to income, digital infrastructure, and awareness outside the IT sector, Indian AI

TCS, Porsche ink €1.25 bn AI deal

George Mathew
Mumbai, August 24

• TECHALLIANCE

TATA CONSULTANCY Services (TCS) has announced a strategic partnership with sports car maker Porsche AG of Germany to enable AI services across its mobility value chain, under which TCS will acquire 100% of MHP Management and IT-Beratung GmbH (MHP), Porsche's management and IT consulting subsidiary.

It will establish a dedicated AI Mobility Centre of Excellence for Porsche to drive innovation across manufacturing, engineering, operations and customer experience.

Porsche in its transformation journey, As AI software, and data redefining the automotive industry, this partnership brings together TCS' capabilities in AI, engineering, technology and business transformation with MHP's strong automotive consulting expertise.

"Together, we will industrialize AI at scale for Porsche, accelerating innovation across the value chain to deliver intelligent, software-defined mobility experiences of the future," Michael Leiters, CEO, Porsche AG, said. "Porsche is taking another important step in its strategy to focus resolutely on its core business with the transfer of MHP to TCS. At the same time, we are gaining a strategic partner in TCS."

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

FX swap schemes built buffers with 'maximum cost-efficiency': Fin Min

New Delhi: Termining the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) concessional swap facilities for Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) deposits, Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings, and External Commercial Borrowings "spectacular", the Ministry of Finance on Monday said the government had added to its economic toolbox with "maximum cost-efficiency".

The ministry's comments come after speculation the RBI closed the window early due to its high cost. As per the scheme, the RBI is set to bear the entire hedging cost of the FCNR(B) deposits. However, economists here argued the cost of the scheme — estimated by some to be around \$10 billion over a period of five years, assuming \$70 billion is raised in total — is unlikely to have been a factor in the decision to close the facility early.

The RBI's concessional swap facilities, which became operational on June 8, had raked in \$72.85 billion by August 21. Such has been the success of the FCNR(B) scheme in particular that the RBI on August 14 said the swap window would close on August 31, a month earlier than the initially-announced deadline of September 30.

The swap facility for Overseas Foreign Currency Borrowings and External Commercial Borrowings will remain open till December 31, as announced originally. ENS

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Tata Sons board likely to meet on September 17

George Mathew
Mumbai, August 24

THE BOARD of Tata Sons Ltd, the holding company of the Tata group, is likely to meet on September 17 to consider Chairman N Chandrasekaran's resignation and finalise a date for the annual general meeting (AGM), which was adjourned on August 18.

Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata and trustee Venu Srinivasan, who is Chairman Emeritus of TVS Motors, are on the board of Tata Sons. Apart from Chandrasekaran, other directors include former Unilever global CCO Harish Manwani, former World Bank official Anita M George and Group CFO Saurabh Agrawal.

Tata Trusts have already decided to initiate the process of setting up a search committee to select Chandrasekaran's successor.

The AGM will happen only when Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT), which holds a 23.56% stake in Tata Sons, is able to come out of the restraining order issued by the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner in May. Tata Sons' AGM on August 18 was adjourned due to a lack of quorum, as the regulatory freeze imposed on the SRTT prevented Tata Sons from securing the shareholder representation required to convene the meeting.

The government means the uncertainty over the resolution for the reappointment of Chandrasekaran as a director of Tata Sons will continue.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• BRIEFLY

FM to leave for 8-day official trip to Canada, US

New Delhi: Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman will embark on an official visit to Canada and the US from August 25 to September 2 to hold talks on bilateral economic and financial cooperation, investment opportunities and global economic priorities, besides participating in the G20 Finance Ministers and Central Bank Governors meeting. During her visit to Toronto, she will participate in the inaugural Economic and Financial Dialogue with Canada's Finance and National Revenue Minister François-Philippe Champagne. PTI

CIL sets up arm in Singapore for critical minerals

New Delhi: Coal India Ltd, India's largest coal producer, has incorporated a new wholly owned Singapore-based subsidiary, CIL

Global Pte. Ltd, to explore and develop overseas critical mineral assets. The new subsidiary aims to "enable efficient management of overseas investments and provide structural flexibility for future acquisitions," the company informed the exchanges on Monday. ENS

Govt to sell up to 6% in Hindustan Copper via OFS

New Delhi: The government will sell up to 6% stake in Hindustan Copper Ltd through an offer for sale (OFS) at a floor price of Rs 514 a share. The floor price is at a 10.38% discount over Monday's closing share price of Hindustan Copper on the BSE. In a post on X, Department of Investment and Public Asset Management secretary Arunish Chawla said the Government of India offers to divest 3% equity in Hindustan Copper through an OFS, with an option to divest an additional 3% (green shoe) in case of oversubscription. PTI

• MARKETS

			
Sensex	NIFTY	Gold	US Dollar
77,369.11	24,219.05	₹1,62,154	₹95.74
-171.72	-32.95		
-0.22%	-0.14%	Silver	Oil
		₹2,45,391	₹95.28

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1KG, CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF AUGUST 21, 2026

Govt allows 4-month relief for clean energy projects amid West Asia crisis

ENS Economic Bureau
New Delhi, August 24

THE CRISIS in West Asia is threatening to disrupt India's renewable energy expansion momentum, with the government extending deadlines for projects scheduled to be commissioned on, or after the outbreak of war in the region.

In latest advisory, the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) has asked renewable energy implementing agencies — including Solar Energy Corporation of India, NTPC Ltd, National Hydroelectric Power Corporation Ltd and SJVN Ltd, as well as the power,

energy and renewable energy departments of the state and Union Territory governments — to consider extensions of up to four months for projects scheduled to be commissioned on or after February 28, 2026. The move comes weeks after industry bodies sought relief from the ministry, warning that disruptions due to the conflict were affecting the procurement, manufacturing, logistics and execution of utility-scale renewable energy projects.

Meanwhile, government data also points to a slowdown in India's pace of solar capacity addition in the latest quarter. In the April-June 2026 quarter,

solar capacity additions stood at 11.8 GW, down 18.1% from 14.4 GW in the previous quarter.

In FY26, the country added 44.61 GW of solar capacity, of which 16.3 GW, or 36%, came from distributed solar, leaving 28.31 GW from mainly utility-scale projects. In its advisory, MNRE referred to an April office memorandum issued by the Department of Investment and Public Asset Management, which clarified that the situation in West Asia should be treated as a "war" and provided for a time extension of up to four months on account of the crisis.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Snapshot of India's AI use

The findings point to a broader challenge for AI adoption in India, where access to and use of advanced AI tools remains uneven despite the country's large technology workforce and the government's push to expand domestic AI capabilities.

Anthropic's analysis shows that higher-income countries generally record greater Claude usage per person, with factors such as income, access to digital infrastructure and awareness of AI tools likely influencing adoption.

"Globally, per-capita AI adoption is strongly correlated



with per-capita income. India's per-capita use is consistent with what this relationship would predict. Without ad-

option is likely to remain concentrated," it added.

The data also suggests that Claude's use in India is currently more closely linked to professional and technical work than broad-based consumer adoption.

This could limit the extent to which productivity gains from generative AI spread across sectors, particularly outside of high-skilled occupations and major economic centres.

It is worth noting that Anthropic's analysis is based on Claude usage and may not be a measure of overall AI adoption in India, though it is one

of the most popular AI companies in the world.

Indian states using Claude

Claude use in India is concentrated in a few economically high-performing states. Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, and Delhi together account for over half of India's total Claude use — and "this pattern closely mirrors India's IT sector geography and urban economic output," the company said.

"The concentration in these four states — home to Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Chennai, Mumbai, and Delhi-NCR — sug-

gests that current AI adoption is driven primarily by India's established technology workforce rather than broad-based consumer uptake," it said.

The primary reasons that Indians are using Claude also reflect that gap. Anthropic said the occupational mix of Indian Claude AI use, inferred by mapping tasks to related occupations, skews towards software development and engineering roles, consistent with the country's large IT services sector. "Broadening AI's economic impact will require looking beyond software and IT services," it added.

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM



epaper.indianexpress.com New Delhi

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

HEAD
CONSTABLE
UDAYENDU
HALDAR
09 BN BSF
13.01.1964 -
25.08.2011

Director General and all Ranks of
Border Security Force remember its
dallas Javan Head Constable
Udayendu Haldar on his Birthday
Giant. On this day he sustained fatal
injuries in a grenade blast triggered by
militants in Baramulla area (J&K) and
later succumbed to his injuries at 92 base hospital.

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

HEAD
CONSTABLE
BHUPENDRA
SINGH
159 BN
7-1-1953 TO
25-8-2008

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn
tribute to Head Constable Bhupendra
Prasad Singh of 159 BN, who made the
supreme sacrifice while bravely
combating Maoists during an operation
in Gaya district, Bihar, on 25 August
2008. CRPF salutes the braveheart and
pledges never to let his sacrifice go in
vain.

VER BALDANI

HEAD
CONSTABLE
SHYAMVEER SINGH
125 BN
1-1-1969 TO
25-8-2008

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to
Constable Shyamveer Singh and Constable Jitendra Kumar Tripathi of 125 BN, who made the
supreme sacrifice after sustaining grievous injuries in a massive IED
blast in Assam on 25 August 2008. CRPF salutes the braveheart and
pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

S. E. RAILWAY E-TENDER

Tender Notice No. **PM/GEN/T/2026/33** Date: 24/08/2026

TENDER FOR "E" PROGRAMMING SYSTEM

The Principal Chief Materials Manager, South Eastern Railway, Hd. Offs. (5th Floor), New administrative Building, 11, Garden Reach Road, Kolkata-700043 for and on behalf of the President of India invites open E-tenders which have been uploaded on website www.reps.gov.in as follows. All the tenders will be closed at 14.00 hrs.

Sl. No.	Tender No.	Closing Date	Brief Description	Qty.	Est. (IN Rs.)
1	29263133	01/09/26	KIT FOR I/O ELG make R2P2100/CM, consisting of 5 I/Os	395 Set	2000000/-
2	29264742	02/09/26	PCH KIT FOR R2P2100 CGM air compressor	19 Set	248780/-
3	29263613	08/09/26	High Speed Handgunning	65 Nos.	545340/-
4	29263622A	14/09/26	Microprocessor based Electronic speed control system monitoring system	25 Nos.	180860/-
5	29263257	16/09/26	M12 kit for Air Dryer of Tritel make	218 Set	142000/-
6	60260048	02/10/26	1 IN 8.5 WELDABLE CAST MANGANESE STEEL CROSSING B.G. 1673 MM	80 Set	627010/-
7	60260011-PA	21/09/26	Price Agreement for Manufacturing and Supply of 6 mm thick pocket type Nylon Cord Reinforced Grooved Rubber Sole Plates for fan shaped 1 in 8.5 Turnout for 60 Kg rails etc.	1000 Set	269040/-
8	60260010-PA	18/09/26	Price Agreement for Manufacturing and Supply of 6mm thick Nylon Cord Reinforced Grooved Rubber Sole Plates for fan shaped 1 in 12 Turnout for 60 Kg rails etc.	1000 Set	873000/-
9	60260090	17/09/26	THICK WEAR SWITCH FOR 1 IN 8.5 SYMMETRICAL SPUR TURNOUT (B.G) FOR 60E1 RAIL	71 Set	725540/-
10	60260014	14/09/26	1 IN 8.5 OVER RIDING (O.R.) TURNOUT OVERHANGING CURVED SWITCH FOR 1 IN 8.5 TURNOUT (B.G) FOR 60E1 RAIL etc.	190 Set	1613800/-
11	IE265654	23/09/26	Supply, installation, testing and commissioning of 200 KVA HSCF Pump Motor	02 Set	117330/-
12	65260528	17/09/26	CNC UNDER FLOOR WHEEL LATHE (Pre-Bid Conference Date: 10/09/2026 at 12.00 PM in PM Meeting Room/SEIRG)	01 No.	1876860/-
13	80263041A	18/09/26	SERVOFLUX SHC 120 I/O, PRODUCT CODE B15 FOR WAGHAWAT LCCS	33600 Nos.	856400/-
14	60260003	11/09/26	ELASTIC RAIL CLIPPERS MK IV WITH FLAT TOE FOR 60 KG UIC52G RAIL SECTIONS etc.	8000000 Nos.	5000000/-
15	60260020	29/09/26	1 IN 8.5 CAST MANGANESE STEEL CROSSING (B.G) FOR 60E1 RAIL	200 Set	892080/-
16	60260015	22/09/26	1 IN 12 CAST MANGANESE STEEL CROSSING B.G. (1673 MM) FOR 60E1 RAIL ON PSC SLEEPERS INCLUDING EPG, LINER, WAGHAWAT FISH PLATES, CHECK RAIL AND CHECK RAIL FITTINGS.	300 Set	1476180/-
17	38263335	16/09/26	Shrink casting with Wear Plate for up-graded HT-CBC	750 Nos.	184970/-
18	33263233	21/09/26	Regulated Battery Charger for LHB Coaches	60 Nos.	114700/-
19	20263618	21/09/26	FRC Window complete etc.	1755 Nos.	106450/-
20	20263549	16/09/26	FLAT PLATE FOR BUFFER PLUNGER etc.	2508 Nos.	129720/-
21	30261792	14/10/26	Slent Block for Anchor Link etc.	9500 Nos.	112820/-
22	29263995	31/08/26	Set of slide stop races for axle boxes etc.	409 Set	190160/-
23	29263268	10/09/26	Kits for Air Drain Valve	794 Set	209700/-
24	29265036	21/09/26	Set of Axle Box Bearing Component etc.	150 Set	293840/-
25	IE265951	19/09/26	New Downway Stiffening Cross Bar for BOVAL	3500 Nos.	238720/-

Interested tenders may visit website www.reps.gov.in for Full Details/Description/Specification of the tenders and submit their bids. In case manual tenders for these items will be accepted. N.B: Prospective Bidders may regularly visit www.reps.gov.in to participate in all other tenders & any Compendium published thereafter.

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA CORRIGENDUM TENDER NOTICE

SR NO.	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / END (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, HISAR	IMPROVEMENT OF T-JUNCTION BY CONSTRUCTION OF SLIP ROADS AT UDAO MARKET JUNCTION NEAR GU JHISAR (ROAD ID 11549) IN HISAR DISTRICT. (PG. SHIPPING OF 33KV LINE HISAR)	21.08.2026 27.08.2026	11.94 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01662225651 pwd-eeed-hisar@hry.nic.in
2	PWD B&R, FATEHABAD	SPECIAL REPAIR OF JUDICIAL RESIDENCE HOUSE NO. 6/3 (1882 SFT) IN HMI SECT. COMPLEX AT FATEHABAD IN FATEHABAD DIST. (WITHOUT GST) + 1 WORKS	20.08.2026 27.08.2026	33.70 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01662225651 pwd-eeed-fatehabad@hry.nic.in
3	PWD B&R, HISAR	CONST. OF PIT AT VILLAGE JAHAN DADI, PGD. POWER WIRING, CANTEN WIRING, 11 KV SUBSTATION, DSG SET ONLY	20.08.2026 26.08.2026	51.64 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01662225651 pwd-eeed-hisar@hry.nic.in
4	SHOM GOVT. MEDICAL COLLEGE NALHAR/JH	TENDER FOR COMPREHENSIVE MAINTENANCE CONTRACT FOR ELECTRICAL, FIRE FIGHTING SERVICES INCLUDING DIESEL GENERATOR SETS AT SHAHEED HASAN KHAN MEWATI GOVT. MEDICAL COLLEGE, NALHAR	24.08.2026 07.09.2026	EMD 5989/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01267-282007 tenderingmewati@gmail.com
5	PANCHAYATI RAJ, KURUSHETRA	SUPPLY OF 90 WATT LED STREET LIGHTS IN VARIOUS VILLAGES IN ALL BLOCKS IN DIST. KURUSHETRA	21.08.2026 27.08.2026	26.95 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	899624257 preveeng.kr@hry.nic.in
6	PANCHAYATI RAJ, HANSOT	THURANA, HANSOT, CONST. OF B.WALL OF COMMUNITY CENTRE IN WARD NO. 2 (BHAMANI PANA) HANSOT	21.08.2026 27.08.2026	53.82 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	839755240 preveeng.kr@hry.nic.in
7	PANCHAYATI RAJ, REWARI	CONST. OF RASTA FROM BHATSANA ROAD TO TATARPUR-NR BASS TO DHANI OF NANO LAL	21.08.2026 27.08.2026	38.18 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	946611077 xenger.rwl@gmail.com
8	PANCHAYATI RAJ, KARNAL	PUNDKAR CONST. OF E-BUILDING AT VILLAGE PUNDKAR BLOCK KARNAL. DISTT KARNAL. SCHEME HGVI + 3 WORKS	21.08.2026 29.08.2026	94.15 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	899634422 preveeng.kr@hry.nic.in
9	PANCHAYATI RAJ, KARNAL	ESTIMATE FOR SUPPLY OF 90 WATT LED STREET LIGHTS IN VARIOUS VILLAGES OF DISTRICT KARNAL. HRY. (PHASE-2)	21.08.2026 29.08.2026	53.19 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	899634422 preveeng.kr@hry.nic.in
10	PANCHAYATI RAJ, SONPAT	SUPPLY OF 90 WATT LED STREET LIGHT IN 40 NO. VILLAGES IN DIST. SONPAT 2ND PHASE	CLOSING DAT 26.08.2026	55.27 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	941639106 preveeng.srp@gmail.com
11	MOTILAL NEHRU SCHOOL OF SPORTS, RAJ, SONPAT	REQUIREMENT OF STATIONARY ITEMS	21.08.2026 11.09.2026	3 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8708559410 mmsra@rediffmail.com
12	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, SISRA	REPAIRING OF M-TYPE QUARTERS IN CANAL, HISSAR ROAD, SISRA (21 NOS. M-TYPE QUARTERS I.E. M4 TO M8 AND M-11 TO M-23), + 4 WORKS	CLOSING DAT 27.08.2026	8.14 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	999665761 xenor.sad1325@yahoo.com
13	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, SISRA	ESTIMATE FOR REMODELING OF WATER COURSE O/R D 56020 L KALIUNA DISTY BY LAYING PIPE LINE FOR BALANCE WORK 5997 FEET.	CLOSING DAT 08.09.2026	22.93 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666-235426 xenor.sad1325@yahoo.com
14	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, SISRA	ESTIMATE FOR REHABILITATION OF TEAKHARA HRY. D 65000 - TAIL.	CLOSING DAT 02.09.2026	537.74 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01666-235426 xenor.sad1325@yahoo.com
15	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, MANDI DABWALI	MANDI DABWALI STP- PROVIDING AND INSTALLATION / REPLACEMENT OF EQUIPMENT AND ELECTRIC INSTALLATION AT 16.50 MLD STP MANDI DABWALI DISTT. SISRA. CH. TO -> MANDI DABWALI- ESTIMATE FOR REPLACEMENT/UPGRADATION OF EQUIPMENT'S AND ELECTRICAL ITEMS AT 16.50 MLD STP AT DABWALI TOWN DISTT. SISRA + 1 WORKS	21.08.2026 14.09.2026	207.66 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	873000001 ee.mandidabwali@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in

GOVERNMENT OF ANDHRA PRADESH A.P. TOWNSHIP & INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LIMITED

Block-2, besides CRDA New Building, Rayapudi, Amaravati

Name of the work: APITDCO/VSAP/2026/01 - Balance works of Physical Infrastructure such as Block Apartments, CC Road, Road Safety & Retaining Walls, Plinth Protection Works, Storm Water Drainage, Link Road, Hand Barricading, Bore wells, etc., in the approved layouts at TIDCO Colony at Achammaidavolu location in Visakhapatnam District, Andhra Pradesh under AHP-PMAY-HIA (U) with the registered tenderer on web site www.etenders.hry.nic.in for the following work: E-Tender Notice for the work related to Visakhapatnam Division (Registered Tender EC/VCMount)- ECV of Rs. 5,75,25,103.86/-

Bidding Documents will be available from: 27.08.2026 to 27.08.2026 at DCTO, APITDCO, Visakhapatnam City.

Bid Document Downloading Start Date: 27.08.2026 at 11:00 Hrs

Bid Document Downloading Close Date: 09.09.2026 at 14:00 Hrs

Last Date and Time for Receipt of Bids: 09.09.2026 at 15:00 Hrs

Technical Bid Opening Date: 09.09.2026 at 17:00 Hrs

Financial Bid Opening Date: 10.09.2026 at 11:00 Hrs

Name & Address of the Concerned Officer: O/o DEPUTY CHIEF TECHNICAL OFFICER, APITDCO, VISAKHAPATNAM CIRCLE, 3RD FLOOR, VAMRDA, SRIPURAM, VISAKHAPATNAM-530 003.

The details can be seen in website <http://www.etenders.hry.nic.in>

Thereof Contact Nos: +91 9676476111, +919959378999.

Sd/-24.08.2026 Managing Director APITDCO, Amaravati R.O. No. 5360PDP/24.08.2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

Open tender for E-tendering are invited by Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/TRS, Electric Loco Shed, Khanalpura Yard, Northern Railway, Saharanpur (Ambala Division) for and on behalf of the President of India from the registered tenderers on web site www.etenders.hry.nic.in for the following work upto 11.00 hrs on the date of closing notice against the work and will be opened thereafter:-

Sl. No.	Name of Tender	ELS-SRE-T52RT1
1.	Open Tender	Complete body cleaning, cyclonic filters cleaning in 3-phase locomotive at Electric Loco Shed Saharanpur for period of eighteen months.
2.	Date of Closing/Opening	18.09.2026
3.	Approx. Cost	Rs. 18,85,113/-
4.	Earnest Money	Rs.37,70,000/-
5.	Completion period	18 (Eighteen) Months
6.	Validity period	60 days
7.	Cost of	Free of cost for downloading from REPS & tender form. Rs. 2000/- for obtaining from Sr.DEE/TRS-SRE office.

1. Tenderers (s) should have Class-II Digital Signature Certificate to participate in E-Tendering of Works Tenders 2. Tenderer are required to upload self-attested scanned copies of all related eligibility documents as per conditions 3. Taxes & Charges will be applicable as per extant rule. 4. For details, please refer log on REPS website www.reps.gov.in E-TENDER NOTICE No. ELS-SRE-T52RT1 Dt. 22.08.2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 2929/26

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA CORRIGENDUM

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD CORP./AUTH.	OLD REFERENCE/NET NO.	NATURE OF CORRIGENDUM	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH.	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	THE ROHTAKA CO-OP. MILK PRODUCERS UNION LIMITED ROHTAK	2506_HBC-S386A_2	DATE EXTENDED UPTO 07.09.2026 AT 16:00 PM OPENING ON 08.09.2026 AT 11:30 AM	www.rohtak.coop	899641185 victor@rohtak.coop
2	THE ROHTAKA CO-OP. MILK PRODUCERS UNION LIMITED ROHTAK	2506_HBC-S387A_1	DATE EXTENDED UPTO 31.08.2026 AT 16:00 PM OPENING ON 01.09.2026 AT 11:30 AM	www.rohtak.coop	899641185 victor@rohtak.coop

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in

Telangana Pollution Control Board

A-3, Industrial Estate, Sanathnagar, Hyderabad-500018

Tender No.963/TGCB/LAB/PROC/EC-MMS/2026, Date: 25-08-2026

e-Tenders are invited on behalf of the Member Secretary, TGCB from Manufacturer/Suppliers in India for supply of Gas Chromatograph Triple Quadrupole Mass Spectrometer (GC/MS/MS) compatible with ATD of Make Markes international and model: Unity-XR. The tender document can be downloaded from <https://etenders.telangana.gov.in> The last date of submission of e-tender is 09.10.2026 at 03.00 PM. Sd/-MEMBER SECRETARY DIPR R.O.No.654-P/02/AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 Dt.24-08-2026 TGCB, HYDERABAD

U.P. POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED

Electy Substation Design Circle-II,
13th Floor, Sakshi Bhawan Extension, Lucknow.

“INVITES-OPEN TENDER (E-TENDER)”

“Engineering, Supply, Erection and Commissioning for Increasing Capacity at 220kV Substation Hardoi from 2x160 MVA to 3x160 MVA on Turnkey Basis E-Tender Specification No. SD-1044”

Tender ID: 2026_PTRCL_1178961_1

Bid Portal (Download & Submission): www.etender.up.nic.in

Mode of Bidding: Open E-Tender

EMD: Rs. 7.78 Lakh

KEY DATES

Online Bid Submission Start: 22.08.2026, 06:30 PM

Online Bid Submission Closing: 14.09.2026, 03:30 PM

Technical Bid Opening: 15.09.2026, 03:30 PM onwards

Note:- Bidders are advised to visit the e-portal regularly for amendments/corrigenda, if any.

E-mail: seeds1@uptcl.org, Contact No.: +91 9415099037

“Save Electricity for Nation”

No.170 -ESD-C1 (G.S.)/Tender Notice, Dated:24.08.2026

BENGALURU NORTH CITY CORPORATION

Office of the Executive Engineer, Sarvagannagara Division,
9th C Main, HBRB Layout 1st Block, Kalyannagara,
Bangalore-560043

No. EE/SGN/KPP/TEND/07/2026-27 Date:24.08.2026

INVITATION FOR SHORT TERM TENDER

(Through KPP Portal Only) (Two Cover System)

The Executive Engineer, Sarvagannagara Division, BNCC Zone-1 invites tenders from registered contractors of Bengaluru North City Corporation, or equivalent registration with CPWD / KPWD / Railways / MES or any State Government Organizations for the work detailed in the table below.

Sl.No.	Name of the work
1.	PACKAGE-10 Comprehensive Development of Parks, Play Grounds, Buildings and Samudaya Bhavan in Ramaswamy Palya Park Part1, Part 2 & Play Ground in Subbaiahnappalya ward, M.L.A Office Park, Dr. Rajkumar Park, Dr. Puneeth Rajkumar Park in Kalyana Nagar, Telecom Layout Park in Hennur ward, HBRB Bande Park in Kalyana Nagar ward, Pillana Garden Dr. B.R Ambedkar Park, Pillana Garden 9th Park & Play Ground in Venkateshapura ward, ABCD Park in Kacharanga halli, MEG Officers Colony Park, Jeevanahalli Children Park in Maruthi Sava Nagara, 3rd Block, 1st Stage, HBR Layout Park, 4th Block HBR Layout Park Sarvagannagar Constituency, Construction of Surveillance Building in Jeevanahalli Play Ground, Balance Construction of Samudaya Bhavana in Ward No.35 Kammanahalli, in Ward No-37 Jeevanahalli, (Anubanda-08, GO No: 4.57, & 8). Estimated Cost: 800.00 Lakhs. EMD: Rs.12,00,000/- (1.00 lakh through e-payment balance Rs. 11,00,000/- through BG/DRF should be submitted before opening of Technical bid. Period of Completion: 240 Days.
1)	Tender documents can be downloaded from KPP portal http://kppp.karnataka.gov.in 2) Last date of receipt of queries: 19.09.2026 up to 13:00 Hrs. 3) Pre-bid Meeting: 21.09.2026 at 11:00 Hrs. 4) Last Date & Time for receipt of tenders : 25.09.2026 up to 16:00 hrs. 5) Opening of technical bids: 28.09.2026 after 16:30 hrs. 6) Opening of financial bids: After Approval of Technical bids. Further details can be obtained from the office of the undersigned.

Sd/- Executive Engineer Sarvagannagara Division.

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA CORRIGENDUM

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD CORP./AUTH.	OLD REFERENCE/NET NO.	NATURE OF CORRIGENDUM	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH.	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	THE ROHTAKA CO-OP. MILK PRODUCERS UNION LIMITED ROHTAK	2506_HBC-S386A_2	DATE EXTENDED UPTO 07.09.2026 AT 16:00 PM OPENING ON 08.09.2026 AT 11:30 AM	www.rohtak.coop	899641185 victor@rohtak.coop
2	THE ROHTAKA CO-OP. MILK PRODUCERS UNION LIMITED ROHTAK	2506_HBC-S387A_1	DATE EXTENDED UPTO 31.08.2026 AT 16:00 PM OPENING ON 01.09.2026 AT 11:30 AM	www.rohtak.coop	899641185 victor@rohtak.coop

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in

S. E. RAILWAY - CORRIGENDUM

Corrigendum to the Tender No. CKP-D-619-OND-PSI-Maint published earlier by Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (TRD), Chakravarthy, Tender No. and Closing date should be read as :- CKP-D-619-Main-PSI-OND and 11.09.2026 at 15.30 hrs. instead of CKP-D-619-OND-PSI-Maint and 04.09.2026 at 15.30 hrs. Details of E-tender Notice along with corrigendum is available on www.reps.gov.in (PR-658/C)

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BARIPADA

E-Mail ID: serw@baripada@gmail.com
Ph.No-06792-261434/261344 Gangraj, Baripada

“E” PROCUREMENT NOTICE FOR BUILDING WORK
IDENTIFICATION NO.-ONLINE TENDER, BUILDING N.C.B. NO. 429 FOR 2026-27
Letter No. 493 Date: 21/08/2026

1. Name of the work : Construction of Building Works in the District of Mayurbhanj

2. Total No. of work : 05 Nos. (Five)

3. Estimated Cost : Rs.188.75 Lakh to Rs.202.44 (approximately).

4. Eligible Class of Contractor : As per annexure.

5. Period of Completion : As per annexure.

6. Other details : As per annexure.

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of Tender On-line for bidding	Last Date of opening of tender	Date & Time of Opening of Tender
Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Baripada	No.429	Building On-line N.C.B. at up to 5.00 P.M.	21.09.2026	At 11.00 A.M.

● Further details can be seen from the website: www.tendersindia.gov.in

● Any Corrigendum / Addendum will be displayed in the above e-tender website only

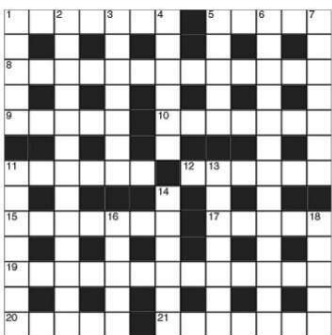
Sd/-
Chief Construction Engineer
R.W. Circle, Baripada.

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA CORRIGENDUM

8730000001		SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD CORP./AUTH.	OLD REFERENCE/N
ee.mandibabwall@gmail.com		1	THE SIRS DISTRICT COOPERATIVE MILK PRODUCERS UNION LIMITED	TENDER ID 2020/HIC/541 NO 19/15-5-TENDER/20

CROSSWORD

6076



ACROSS

- 1 Alcoholic drink is for the non-driver (7)
 5 A spice having no end of use in savouries (5)
 8 Following a certain style but none too well (5,1,7)
 9 Is in good time but nearly loses a point (5)
 10 Drive home an attendant in storm (7)
 11 In a question of going round a pub say nay (6)
 12 Put butter on bread for the meal (6)
 15 Widespread search for criminals may be granted (7)
 17 Twisted roots used for a perch (5)
 19 Striking was usual if such staffs were employed (8,5)
 20 Learn the way it's affecting the kidneys (5)
 21 Stays if made content (7)

DOWN

- 1 The fish is put on ice (5)
 2 A conclusion showing resolution (13)
 3 Continue to make a fuss (5,2)
 4 Former arrangement is better (6)
 5 A mass rising on the Indian border (5)
 6 But they're not accommodation for soldiers (7,6)
 7 Make an effort to study with care (7)
 11 His wife will be late (7)
 13 Primate in a role that offers limited protection (7)
 14 Isn't over-generous with the work allotments (6)
 16 Change of plane needed in mountainous country (5)
 18 Likely to snap under pressure (5)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 6076 ACROSS: 1 Beast, 8 Mistress, 9 Atlas, 10 Plantain, 11 Grain, 12 Aye, 16 Sills, 17 Towed, 18 See, 20 Store, 24 Demeaned, 25 No end, 26 Organdie, 27 Yeast DOWN: 2 Tintirety, 3 Spaniels, 4 Willow, 5 At one, 6 Relay, 7 Using, 12 Ass, 13 Eve, 14 Rest home, 15 Bearings, 19 Eyelid, 20 Adios, 21 Omega, 22 Haut

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

It's not enough that we do our _____; sometimes we have to do what's _____ - Winston Churchill (4,_,8)

CERES



UNITED



EOIRS



AERUBQ



SOLUTIONS: Ceres: See, Dear, United, Bangur ANSWER: It's not enough that we do our best, sometimes we have to do what's required - Winston Churchill

OVER THE HEDGE



BY MICHAEL FRY & T. LEWIS

CALVIN & HOBBS



BY BILL WATTERSON

MARVIN



BY TOM ARMSTRONG

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 1s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows, and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

9	5			4	2
	7	3	9	1	5
3	2			4	7
	8	3	4	7	
	4				1
		1	2	3	6
	7	5			9
5	9	6	7	2	
6	2				5

SUDOKU 6420

9	2	6	3	7	4	1	8	5
8	4	5	6	1	2	9	3	7
3	7	1	8	5	9	2	4	6
7	5	9	1	2	8	4	6	3
1	3	2	5	4	6	7	9	8
4	6	8	7	9	3	5	1	2
6	1	7	9	8	5	3	2	4
2	9	3	4	6	7	8	5	1
5	8	4	2	3	1	6	7	9

SUDOKU 6420

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

SEE SECTION 84 BHARTIYA NAGARIK SURAKSHA SANHITA Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused Person namely **Arun Kumar S/o Anil Kumar R/o H.No. 208/1, 1st Floor, Malviya Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 348/2018 U/s 454/380/411/34 IPC**, has been registered at **PS: Hazrat Nizamuddin, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Arun Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Arun Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Arun Kumar** of **FIR No. 348/2018 U/s 454/380/411/34 IPC**, has been registered at **PS: Hazrat Nizamuddin, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.09.2026**.

By Order
 Sh. Manoj Kaushal
 JMFC-3, Room No. 512
 Saket Court, New Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Gagan, S/o: Ratan Lal R/o: Near Raza Ka Makan, Gali No. 01, Sanjay Colony, Gokul Puri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 804/2015, U/s: 452/392/394/34 IPC, PS: Gokal Puri, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Gagan**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Gagan**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Gagan**, of **FIR No. 804/2015, U/s: 452/392/394/34 IPC, PS: Gokal Puri, Delhi**, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.09.2026**.

By Order
 Babru Bhan
 Additional Session Judge
 Room No. 312, 3rd Floor
 North East District
 Karkardooma Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS) Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Sandeep S/o Hari Ram, R/o Village Firjipur Bangar, Tehsil Kharkhoda Dist. Sonapat, Haryana** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 201/2019 U/s 335/58 Delhi Excise ACT, PS: Bawana, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sandeep** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sandeep** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Sandeep** of **FIR No. 201/2019 U/s 335/58 Delhi Excise ACT, PS: Bawana, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.09.2026**.

By Order
 Ms. Bharti Beniwal
 Judicial Magistrate First Class
 Room No. 114, North District
 Rohini Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Okeatigwe Kamabilli-Collins S/o Okeatigwe Patrick R/o House No. 37, Jain Road, Water Tank, Bhagwati Garden, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence **FIR No. 260/16 U/s 333/38 Delhi Excise Act/ Section-14 Foreigner Act at P.S. Ranhola, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Accused** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Accused** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding **U/s 82 Cr.P.C.** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Okeatigwe Kamabilli-Collins** accused of **FIR No. 260/16 U/s 333/38 Delhi Excise Act/ Section-14 Foreigner Act at P.S. Ranhola, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.10.2026**.

By Order: Shri Ankit Karan Singh,
 Metropolitan Magistrate -08, (West),
 Room No. 30,
 Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita-2023) Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Siraj Sheikh @ Miraj Sheikh @ Babu S/o Murad Sheikh R/o Vegabond, Azad Market, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 101/21 U/s 356/379/411 IPC at PS: Kotwali, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Siraj Sheikh @ Miraj Sheikh @ Babu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Siraj Sheikh @ Miraj Sheikh @ Babu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Siraj Sheikh @ Miraj Sheikh @ Babu** of **FIR No. 101/21 U/s 356/379/411 IPC at PS: Kotwali, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.09.2026**.

By order
 Sayesha Chadha
 Judicial Magistrate - 1st Class-08
 (Central) Room No.272
 Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF THE PERSONS ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C.) (84 Bhartiya Nagrik Suraksha Sanhita-2023) Whereas complaint has been made before me that two accused persons namely 1. **Karan Singh Negi @ Rahul Negi S/o Bhupal Singh Negi R/o H.No. G-33, Vijay Vihar, PH-4, Rohini, Delhi** 2. **Vipin Kumar @ Babu S/o Lahu Singh R/o A-292, Vijay Vihar, PH-4, Vijay Vihar, Rohini, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 027819/2024 U/s 305b/317(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023 at PS: Budh Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused 1. **Karan Singh Negi @ Rahul Negi** 2. **Vipin Kumar @ Babu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused 1. **Karan Singh Negi @ Rahul Negi** 2. **Vipin Kumar @ Babu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused 1. **Karan Singh Negi @ Rahul Negi** 2. **Vipin Kumar @ Babu** of **FIR No. 027819/2024 U/s 305b/317(2)/3(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023 of PS: Kanjhawala, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.09.2026**.

By order
 Sanyam Jain
 Judicial Magistrate First Class-04
 (North - West) Room No. 112,
 Rohini Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS) Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Navita W/o Lt. Ashok R/o Ground Floor, Premises Adjacent to Pole No. JFPH 907, Village Rawta, Jaffarpur, New Delhi 110073** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CT Cases 444/2022 U/s 135 Indian Electricity ACT, PS Jaffarpur Kalan, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Navita** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Navita** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Navita** in **CT Cases 444/2022 U/s 135 Indian Electricity ACT, PS Jaffarpur Kalan, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.09.2026**.

By order
 Ms. Harleen Singh
 Additional District & Sessions Judge (South West)
 Special Court Electricity, Court No. 609
 Dwarka Court, New Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person namely **Naim Singh S/o Rampal Singh, R/o: H. No. B-32, Gali No.5, B Block, Main Nala Road, Anand Vihar Karawal Nagar, Delhi** (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 199/2023, U/s 27/61/85 NDPS ACT, registered at P.S.: Karawal Nagar, Delhi** and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused **Naim Singh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Naim Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Naim Singh** accused **FIR No. 199/2023, U/s 27/61/85 NDPS ACT, registered at P.S.: Karawal Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.09.2026**.

By Order
 Ms. Isra Zaidi
 Judicial Magistrate First Class-04
 Room No. 64, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.PC Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Renu W/o Lt. Abdul Huq R/o New Seemarpur, Dilshad Nagar, Delhi, Also at: Village-Mednipur, Kolkata, West Bengal**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 10/2014, U/s 4/5/8 ITP ACT, PS Anand Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Renu** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Renu** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Renu** the said accused of **FIR No. 10/2014, U/s 4/5/8 ITP ACT, PS Anand Vihar, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.10.2026**.

By Order
 Ms. Sanghmitra
 Judicial Magistrate First Class-01,
 DP/11835/SHD/2026 Shahdara Distt., Room No.-54, 2nd Floor,
 Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Your interactions with friends and members of groups might be intense today. Someone might do something that catches you off guard. You'll meet someone unusual. You'll feel sympathetic for someone and look for ways to help them. Tonight: Be friendly.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Encounters with someone in authority might be intense today. Pull in your reins a bit in case you offend someone. This could relate to something unexpected that impacts your money, possessions or your earnings. Tonight: You're admired.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Steer clear of controversial subjects today. They might quickly grow into an argument. Be careful as you might say something you could later regret. Tonight: Explore and learn something.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): If you're discussing how to divide or share something like a shared property, make sure that your facts are correct. Something unexpected might throw you off guard. Confusion with someone in authority might be a factor. Tonight: Check your finances.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Discussions with partners, spouses and close friends are intense today. You're surprised by something that a friend or a member of a group does or says. You also might feel sympathetic to the problems of someone far away. Tonight: Listen and cooperate.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): This is a powerful time for you: nevertheless, something unexpected might occur if you attempt to improve your health or your job. This could relate to an authority figure or your efforts to help someone in need. Do what you can. Tonight: Work hard.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Surprise opportunities to socialise might pop up today. Act quickly. Romantic connections will be affectionate today. This is also an accident-prone day for your kids. Tonight: Socialise.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Your home routine might be interrupted today. You also might be involved with a parent or a female family member more than usual. If exploring new health remedies, be careful. Enjoy chatting with others today. Tonight: Relax at home.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Pay attention to everything you do today as this is a mildly accident-prone day for you. You will feel affectionate towards kids as well as your romantic partners. An unexpected inspiration might give you some creative ideas. Tonight: An intense discussion.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): You might impulsively buy something today. You might lose something, so protect what you own. Something unexpected could impact your money. Help a family member today in practical ways or with a sympathetic ear. Tonight: Check your money.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Today the Moon is in your sign lined up with Pluto, which can make you emotionally intense. You might feel overwhelmed by something or you might feel obsessed with an idea. Tonight: You're strong.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): This is a restless day for you. Fortunately, you might attract money or favours from others to you. Romance will be affectionate, definitely. You also might be attracted to competitive sports. Enjoy your day. Tonight: Privacy.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Jitender, S/o: Dharan Pal, R/o: Premises Right Hand Side to Plot No. 1, Near BSE Pole No. NJFAA89, Shiv Enclave, Najafgarh, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CT Case No. 750/2021, U/s: 135 Indian Electricity Act, PS: Baba Haridas Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Jitender**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Jitender**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Jitender**, of **CT Case No. 750/2021, U/s: 135 Indian Electricity Act, PS: Baba Haridas Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.09.2026**.

By Order
 Harleen Singh
 Additional District & Sessions Judge (South West)
 Special Court [Electricity] Court No. 609
 Dwarka Court, New Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Danish @ Khatra @ Salman, S/o: Imran R/o: N.164 & 165, Sunder Nagar, Nand Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 406/2017, U/s: 323/452/506 IPC, PS: Welcome, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Danish @ Khatra @ Salman**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Danish @ Khatra @ Salman**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Danish @ Khatra @ Salman**, of **FIR No. 406/2017, U/s: 323/452/506 IPC, PS: Welcome, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.09.2026**.

By Order
 Deepak Kumar
 Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
 Karkardooma Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Shoav, S/o: Samshur Singh, R/o: B-164 J.J. Colony Raghubir Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 328/2024, U/s: 129/55 Delhi Gambling Act, PS: Khyala, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Shoav**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Shoav**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Shoav**, of **FIR No. 328/2024, U/s: 129/55 Delhi Gambling Act, PS: Khyala, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.09.2026**.

By Order
 Ms. Sheetal Rani
 Judicial Magistrate First Class-12 (West)
 Room No. 152
 Tis hazari Court, Delhi

Jurel on 'Jai Jawan, Jai Kisan' tattoo: 'Those are my roots'



Dhruv Jurel. CREMAS

Express News Service
Mumbai, August 24

DHURUV JUREL endured a tense 13-ball wait to move from 99 to his second Test century, reaching the milestone with a risky single off Asitha Fernando. After removing his helmet and raising his bat, the wicketkeeper-batsman rolled up his sleeve to reveal his left bicep, tattooed with the words "Jai Jawan, Jai Kisan."

The 25-year-old said the tattoo was a tribute to his grandfather and father, a farmer and a soldier, respectively.

"My grandfather was a farmer, my father was a soldier, so those are my roots, where I came from, and I don't want to forget it," Jurel told reporters on Monday.

In October last year, the right-hander had celebrated reaching his fifty in a Test against the West Indies in Ahmedabad with a salute, a gesture dedicated to his father. After reaching his maiden Test hundred in the same innings, he dedicated it to the Indian Army.

Stuck on 99

Jurel shared a critical 112-run partnership for the seventh wicket with Rishabh Pant on Monday, which gave India the upper hand. He said that batting with the left-hander made his job easier.

"It makes my batting approach easy, because you are getting runs from one end. It's easy to bat with him," Jurel said. "At the end of the day, whether he gets runs or I get runs, the team should win."

Jurel was on 95 when the heavens opened up, and early tea was taken. He said that he was used to breaks in play, having toured Sri Lanka earlier with India A.

"I am tired of used to it. I was just trying to bat in partnerships, assess conditions, the situation, pick your pockets and play positively," he added.

The wicketkeeper also spoke about being stranded on 99 for 13 balls, admitting that Fernando was bowling well and he took the single because he felt he had found a gap after hitting the ball past the bowler. But he had his heart in his mouth when the fielder threw the stumps.

"I don't know, when I was on 99, before that, he (Asitha) was bowling decently. I was getting runs. I got on 99, he started bowling good lengths and lines, good fielding, so when I played that shot, it was going over the head of the bowler. I thought there was a gap, but when he (fielder) grabbed that ball, I was like, 'oh God, please save me'," he remarked.

SRI LANKA VS INDIA, SECOND TEST

Jurel proves himself as man for all seasons with second Test ton

Wicketkeeper-batsman shows he can adapt to different situations; takes team from strong position to dominant one

Shankar Narayan
Mumbai, August 24

BY THE time Dhruv Jurel finally got there, he had spent a long time waiting: 171 deliveries, to be precise. And when the moment arrived, it brought a little drama with it.

Jurel punched Asitha Fernando towards mid-off and set off for a single. The throw was coming in the general direction of the stumps. Had the fielder hit, Jurel would have been walking back on 99. Instead, he missed, punching the air before removing his helmet and soaking in the applause.

From the other end, Mohammed Siraj ran towards him and wrapped him in a big hug.

"My grandfather was a farmer, my father was a soldier, so those are my roots, where I came from, and I don't want to forget it," Jurel told reporters on Monday.

In October last year, the right-hander had celebrated reaching his fifty in a Test against the West Indies in Ahmedabad with a salute, a gesture dedicated to his father. After reaching his maiden Test hundred in the same innings, he dedicated it to the Indian Army.

When Sarfaraz Khan was brought in as Sri Lankans' injury replacement, there were murmurs about whether he should walk straight back into the middle order for his ability to play spin and use the sweep efficiently. Instead, the management backed the incumbent option in Jurel. He responded with 51 in Galle. In Colombo, he went second on 99.

Jurel's innings on Monday had two distinct phases, differentiated by the presence and then the absence of Rishabh Pant. When Pant joined him, the pair gave India exactly what the team wanted: aggression without recklessness.

Jurel was the calmer half of the partnership, while Pant ensured the bowlers could never settle. The two wicketkeeper-batsmen went over their work in completely different ways. The former trusted his defence, played late and waited for the ball to come to him. The latter moved around the crease, swept, reverse-swept, stepped down the track and occasionally launched the ball into the stands.

It offered a lovely balance to the stand: A right-hander and a left-hander, two wicketkeepers and two different methods.

Jurel was on 11 when Pant came out after Saransh Jain's dismissal. Soon enough, the two turned a potentially awkward passage into a century partnership. Pant brought up his fifty from 82 balls, while Jurel reached his own half-century in 97 deliveries, pulling a Prabhath Jayasuriya long-hop through midwicket.

Pant's presence gave Jurel the chance to play his natural game. He did not have to force the pace. He could leave the wider deliveries, defend the good ones and cash in when Sri Lanka erred in length. He was playing the perfect foil to his more experienced partner.

Different facets

Then, just after lunch, the equation changed.

Pant danced down the track to Keshara Nuwantha and holed out at long-off on the first ball of the post-lunch session. He was gone for 63 off 89 balls, and his dismissal meant Jurel suddenly had to shoulder a different responsibility.

He kept the scoreboard ticking, first with Manav Suthar, before Siraj joined him. The pacer had recently shown a penchant for using the long handle, and it had come off on some occasions.



Dhruv Jurel scored an unbeaten 115 off 177 deliveries in the second Test in Colombo to take India to a comfortable position. CREMAS

ing, first with Manav Suthar, before Siraj joined him. The pacer had recently shown a penchant for using the long handle, and it had come off on some occasions.

India had just crossed the 450-run mark. They were safe but needed more runs to feel fully secured. Jurel rallied Siraj, farming the strike for the most part and showing composure to frustrate the Sri Lankans. The heavens opened up when he was on 95, and it seemed like he would remain stranded there.

The rain gods eventually relented, and after resumption,

Jurel quickly moved to 99. He played a maiden against Jayasuriya while sitting on that score, refusing to manufacture a scoring opportunity simply because he was one run from a milestone. When the hundred finally came, the shackles came off. Jurel cleared his front leg and smashed Asitha over deep square leg for six.

In an era increasingly obsessed with scoring rates, Jurel's batting style offers an interesting throwback. His innings did not have a barrage of ramps, scoops or improvised strokes. It was

Scorecard

SRI LANKA vs INDIA
COL Under-19s
TOSS: India won, chose to bat
INDIA (O/N-300/5)
R Pant c Udara b Nuwantha 63 (89b, 6x4, 2x6)
D Jurel not out 115 (177b, 9x4, 2x6)
S Jain c Mishara b Fernando 6 (87b, 1x4)
M Suthar c Dickwell b Jayasuriya 18 (51b, 2x4)
M Siraj lbw b Jayasuriya 3 (29b)
P Krishna not out 4 (7b, 1x4)
• **EXTRAS** (b 8, lb 3, nb 3, w 7) 21
• **TOTAL** (138 overs) 503/9d
• **FOW:** 6-307 (Saransh Jain, 86.5 ov), 7-419 (Rishabh Pant, 112.1 ov), 8-458 (Manav Suthar, 124.4 ov), 9-489 (Mohammed Siraj, 136.1 ov)
• **BOWLING:** Asitha Fernando 29-5-106-4; Lahiru Kumara 20-4-68-1; Prabhath Jayasuriya 42-7-132-2; Keshara Nuwantha 38-3-154-2; Sonal Dinusha 3-0-8-0; Dhananjaya de Silva 2-0-8-0; Kamini Mishara 4-0-16-0
SRI LANKA
Lahiru Udara c Jaiswal b Krishna (16b)
Kamini Mishara not out 5 (5b)
Prabhath Jayasuriya lbw b Suthar 2 (7b)
• **EXTRAS** 0
• **TOTAL** (3 Overs) 8/2
• **FOW:** 1-1 (Lahiru Udara, 1.2 ov), 2-8 (Prabhath Jayasuriya, 2.6 ov)
• **BOWLING:** Mohammed Siraj 1-0-1-0; Prashith Krishna 1-0-1-1; Manav Suthar 1-0-1-0

built in orthodox fashion: straight drives, clipped singles, controlled pulls, firm punches and a willingness to defend when the ball demanded it.

Even as wickets fell at the other end, Jurel stayed long enough and ensured they did not lose control of the game. By the time he reached his hundred, Sri Lanka had spent more than two days in the field, and India were closing in on 500. Jurel has shown in this series that he can absorb pressure without allowing it to consume him. In Galle, the SI suggested he belonged. In Colombo, the unbeaten 115 has now given him something more valuable: time. After an innings build on patience, discipline and the occasional flourish, India have the upper hand. And Jurel has answered the question that followed him into the series.

Pant's 63 in Colombo invaluable, like his knock in Manchester



Rishabh Pant played through an injury to score 63 off 89. CREMAS

Shankar Narayan
Mumbai, August 24

RISHABH PANT has never done things the conventional way. On Monday in Colombo, with his left forearm still strapped after retiring hurt for 3 the previous evening, he did it again. He was dismissed immediately after lunch, but the damage was done. His 63 may not have been a hundred, but for India, it was worth its weight in gold.

Pant walked out to bat early in the first session on Day 2 after Saransh Jain had fallen cheaply. There were doubts over whether he could play his normal game, whether he could withstand Sri Lanka's attempts to test the injury. The answers came emphatically. More than the runs, there was an audacity to the way Pant batted, as if the strapped forearm were an inconvenience rather than a reason to retreat.

Asitha Fernando bent his back, sending bouncers towards Pant's body and shoulder. Pant ducked under some, swayed away from others and was struck again. On one occasion, he was caught between ducking and swaying, taking the ball on the shoulder as it lobbed dangerously close to the stumps. His left hand remained batted, his gloves repeatedly coming off and going back on. Yet he took deliveries most batsmen would have been happy simply to survive.

The defining moment came in the fifth ball of the 90th over. Kumara went short and into Pant, precisely the delivery Sri Lanka had been using to test him. He rocked back, got into position and hooked it over fine leg. It sailed onto the roof.

He pulled Fernando's short balls through backward square, tapped Kumara behind point and rotated the strike when the bowlers strayed. The injured forearm made conventional batting difficult, but that only seemed to sharpen his instinct for improvisation and risk.

Using the crease

Then came the spinners, and Pant found another way to disturb their rhythm. Keshara Nuwantha kept bowling around middle and leg, trying to cramp him. Pant used the crease, going deep to create room for the pull and staying down for the sweep, stepping out when the ball was tossed up and occasionally using the reverse sweep.

Against Prabhath Jayasuriya, he was particularly inventive. He reverse-swept through deep point, padded another fine down the leg side and then skipped down the track to loft

The defining moment came in the fifth ball of the 90th over. Kumara went short and into Pant. He rocked back, got into position and hooked it over fine leg. It sailed onto the roof.

the left-arm spinner straight back over his head. When Jayasuriya erred in line towards leg, Pant went deep in his crease and whipped him through backward square. It was not merely shot-making; it was a display of audacity from a batsman carrying an obvious physical limitation.

The 50 came in 52 balls, with Pant going deep in his crease and pulling Nuwantha through midwicket. It was not quite a textbook pull, but it found the boundary.

Then, on the very first ball after lunch, Pant did what Pant does: Nuwantha tossed one up. Pant shuffled down the pitch, got too close to the ball and attempted another big shot. He struck it flat towards deep mid-off, where Lahiru Udara held a sharp catch. The dismissal summed up both the brilliance and risk of his innings. Yet India could hardly complain.

India was 307 for 6 when Pant resumed. By the time he departed, the score had reached 419 for 7. His 112-run partnership with Dhruv Jurel transformed the complexion of the innings and put India ahead in the game. Pant had done something similar before. In Manchester, after Chris Woakes struck his toe, he walked out in obvious discomfort and still made 54. In Colombo, the physical challenge was different, but the response was similar: play through the pain, absorb the punishment and make the bowlers pay.

His score may appear modest beside the hundreds that define great Test innings. But context matters. This was not a 63 accumulated in comfort. It was 63 earned while Sri Lanka repeatedly attacked the body of an injured batsman, and it came when India needed control.

The maverick had done his job. Those runs carried greater weight than the score suggested. Pant did not need to bat until tea. He did not need to make a hundred. He needed to show that the injury would not stop him - and turn that belief into fact. By the time he walked back, India were firmly in the driver's seat.

Abid's 5/39 on red soil gives North Zone a 171-run lead

Venkata Krishna B
Bengaluru, August 24

ABID MUSHTAQ's delivery to Prithvi Shaw pitched on middle, held its line long enough for Shaw to commit to it, then spun away to take out off-stump. The speed gun read 95kmph, roughly 10kmph quicker than anything the other spinners in the match had bowled. It was, in Mushtaq's own words, the ball Ravindra Jadeja bowls on this kind of surface, red soil, the kind that lets a left-arm spinner attack the stumps at pace rather than loft it up and wait.

That wicket, on the evening of Day 1, set the theme for what followed. In the Duleep Trophy quarterfinal, after North Zone were shut out for 251, it was Mushtaq who pulled them back into the game, his 5 for 39 helping bowl out West Zone for 187

and hand North a 171-run lead.

Mushtaq is North Zone's most visible spinner on a given day. Mushtaq gets the ball when J&K, or North, need something manufactured rather than just landed in the right areas.

Growing up in Bidadarwah, Mushtaq spent most of his cricket on green tops or low, slow black-soil pitches. Red soil, the kind that lets the ball grip and turn sharply, wasn't something he had access to until a couple of years ago, when Mithun Manhas took charge of J&K cricket.

"I get goosebumps. I get excited," Mushtaq says of what a red-soil pitch does to him. "Before that it used to be black soil or a green top. It won't turn one bit. It is the case actually all across north. So when we got a red soil pitch at home, it was fun. When it was laid, I spiked it up so much so that it made it hard for



Abid Mushtaq. EXPRESS

batsmen," he says, cheekily.

His best innings figures, 8 for 18, came on red soil, against Vidarbha in December 2022. His 5 for 111 against Madhya Pradesh and 7 for 68 against Hyderabad, both during J&K's title-winning Ranji campaign, came on red soil too. Kanhaiya Wadhawan, North Zone's cap-

tain, has kept wicket to him often enough to know what he's capable of on it.

"It's natural," he says of his habit of taking wickets in clusters. "I was trying to bowl at the stumps as there was help in the wicket. When the wicket is red, I get confidence. I've seen the speed at which Jadeja bhaal operates. So I try to make it harder for batsmen. When you bowl quickly, they can't sweep me either. And if the pitch is turning, I use the crease a lot," he says.

He sent down 25.4 overs in the innings, conceded just 39 runs, and bowled 10 maidens. Mushtaq had spent the off-season auditing at the AG's office in Srinagar, in weather cold enough to stiffen a bowler's body before he's bowled a ball.

"For me, it's hot here. So, I get into the rhythm. I'm trying

for lbw and bowled on this pitch. Since it is turning, if I put too much rotation, I will end up getting beaten. So that's why I'm attacking the stumps more," Mushtaq says. With Arshdeep Singh and Anshul Kamboj providing control and breakthroughs around him, West Zone folded for 187. Sams Mulani top-scoring with 52. On a surface already showing signs of wear, North came out looking to score quickly in their second innings.

BRIEF SCORES: North Zone 251 & 107/4 (Ayush Badoni 39 n.o.) vs West Zone 187 (Shams Mulani 52; Abid Mushtaq 5/39).
East Zone 467 (Shabbaz Ahmed 167, Sudip Gharami 146; Pheerojain Jotin 3/64) vs **North East Zone** 111 (Abhimjit Sarkar 5/20, Shabbaz Ahmed 3/20) & 1/0 7/0.

• SPEED DEMON UNLOCKED

Deepesh, 18, cranking up pace in the mid-140s, is Tamil Nadu's newest prospect

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, August 24

AT HOME, D Deepesh's parents speak of a son who can't eat a meal without watching the Japanese cartoon Shin-Chan. But hand him a cricket ball, and he can consistently bowl in excess of 140kmph. Earlier in the ongoing Tamil Nadu Premier League, playing for Madurai Panthers where he has picked up 5 wickets in 6 games so far, the speed gun clocked him at 146kmph against Trichy Grand Cholas.

Game after game, with a smooth action, he has been cranking up raw pace in the mid-140s, crushing batsmen with his bounce.

In the middle, he doesn't mind a fiery exchange with the batsmen either; send-offs are common too, and he has a trademark wicket celebration, pulling imaginary arrows from a quiver.

Standing at 6 feet, the 18-year-old is testament to fast bowling great Dennis Lillee's old line: "Fast bowlers are not made. They are born."

Finding the pace

Growing up, until Under-16 level, Deepesh was a batsman. By Under-19 he had evolved into a fast bowler. "Reason *elam num in na... fast ahi potu oru viba kedakukun*," Deepesh tells *The Indian Express*: there's no real reason, if you bowl fast, there's a vibe to it. "I love watching Dale Steyn, I wasn't inspired by anyone. I didn't play cricket wanting to get selected to any team. I'm playing because I love bowling fast. I don't know where it will take me," he says.

At the Under-19 World Cup, he clocked 140kmph, but when he delivered the fastest ball at the TNPL, he had no idea it was coming. He admits he was eventually bowling faster than ever

before. "I didn't specifically work to increase my speed to 145kmph. I did a lot of volume and kept bowling after the World Cup. Played the Chennai league and I feel it's a result of that. I still do the same weights and gym work, but it's the volume of bowling which has increased. I believe my pace has increased to 145 because of bowling more balls," he says.

Crickets runs in Deepesh's blood. His father, V Devendran, played for Tamil Nadu in the inaugural edition of the Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy. With Deepesh showing an interest in cricket, Devendran enrolled his son in swimming at age 10, to breathe, I make him bowl 25 overs a day. Batsman a ship la thooka na than Sri dhool," he adds: you need to get batsmen dismissed in the slip cordon.

AC Pratheepan, Madurai's bowling coach, has experienced first-hand what Deepesh pro-



D Deepesh clocked 146kmph in the Tamil Nadu Premier League. NPL

vides to his team. For Pratheepan, Deepesh is a wholesome package. "He is a character. Many people have said before that fast bowlers are scary characters, and he is a proper character. Every captain will love to have a fast bowler like him in their team. He is always ready for the fight, he will not shy away. He

will go hard and look to bowl quickly. It is not like I will control and if I hit a good length, it is enough." He wants control as well as speed," he says.

What has also caught Pratheepan's attention is Deepesh's indifference to the numbers. "He is not a person who looks at the numbers. After each game, he

"I love watching Dale Steyn, I wasn't inspired by anyone. I didn't play cricket wanting to get selected to any team. I'm playing because I love bowling fast. I don't know where it will take me."

DEEPESH
FAST BOWLER

will ask, 'how did I bowl?' He asks for that feedback, doesn't matter if he got wickets or not. At this level, more are after numbers because that is what will take you to the next level. With him, he is different. Since he has pace, now it is all about getting control," Pratheepan adds.

Beyond raw pace

Deepesh isn't about pace alone. At the Under-19 World Cup, he showed a slower-ball bouncer that is hard to pick, and has since gone about adding variations, including the off-cutter and the dipping yorker.

These variations are a by-product of working with Tamil Nadu coach Sandeep Warrier. "To be honest, Deepesh has it in him. It is all about sharing the experience and helping him develop. At 18-19, if you can learn as much as you can, when he hits the peak in a couple of years, he can be a complete fast bowler. So I

just share my experiences and guide him about lead, de-liding, and how to manage the body," Warrier says.

Early in his own career, Warrier was known for clocking over 140kmph, and though he went on to become a reliable red-ball bowler, he struggled for consistency in white-ball cricket. "With Deepesh, he bowls a lot, which is not common these days. From Under-19, he has to take the next step. If he can learn at 18, it will help him a lot. With the red ball, you can find the rhythm once you get the control. But to be an all-format pacer, you need to add variations. I had nobody to help me when it comes to white-ball cricket, so I'm just sharing my knowledge, so that when he breaks the big doors soon and plays the Ranji Trophy, IPL, and for India, he's ready. Deepesh isn't obsessed about speed. He wants to bowl fast, but be a complete pacer," Warrier adds.

Sports ministry stands firm on selection criteria for Asian Games

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 24

THE 492-STRONG squad for the Asian Games has already been announced. But as is often the case in such matters, athletes who have not made the cut have rallied for a spot in the continental mega event taking place in Aichi-Nagoya from September 19 to October 4. On Monday, the sports ministry made it clear that despite the pressure, they would stick to the selection criteria announced a year ago.

"A lot of pressure was there (on us). Some parents came and said 'my child has not been selected'. We told them if your child merits selection (fulfills the criteria), there is no way or she will not be selected," a sports ministry source told reporters. It was reiterated that only the top six in Asia in any event would be selected and that the Asian Games was not an event for athletes to 'gain experience'.

"If somebody has to run inside 10 seconds to be a contender for a medal in the 100m event, should we send an athlete who clocks 15 seconds?"

In September 2025, the Sports Authority of India had laid down the selection criteria for athletes to be a part of the Asian Games. While top six in Asia via rankings was the operative standard, in cases where judging by that marker was not possible or realistic, 'a top-six finish among Asian nations in international competitions', or a top-six finish at an Asian Championship would be the operative criterion. The ministry, in its September release, had added a relaxation clause: one that allowed it to choose an athlete for justifiable reasons, as recommended by experts from the concerned federation. Hence, there is still room for additions, subject to approval from the Olympic Council of India.

HOCKEY WORLD CUP

Uninspired India crash out of semifinal race without a fight

Harmanpreet-led side's hopes end after going down 3-5 to Argentina in do-or-die match

Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, August 24

INDIA ARE out of the Hockey World Cup, and the manner of their elimination — following a 5-3 hammering to Argentina — was as damning as the result.

They arrived at the Wager Stadium knowing they needed a big victory to keep their semifinal hopes alive. There was no room for a slow start, a cautious approach or defensive lapses.

Yet, six minutes in, they were 2-0 down.

Craig Fulton clenched his teeth after Argentina scored their second goal. It was the kind of reaction that needed no explanation. India were not being blown away by an irresistible Argentine attack. They were giving Argentina opportunities, reacting late and failing to deal with danger inside their own circle.

At half-time, Fulton put it even more bluntly, "We are giving them a lot of opportunities for no reason." It was perhaps the most accurate summary of India's first half.

The first six minutes exposed India's defensive uncertainty. They were slow to react inside the circle, late to close down attackers and unable to impose themselves on a game they desperately needed to control.

Sukhjeet Singh briefly offered a glimpse of what India should have been doing. Under



India were down 1-5 by the 53rd minute, and two late goals only reduced the margin of defeat. HOCKEY INDIA

pressure from a couple of defenders, he turned and produced a good shot to pull one back. It was a fine piece of skill and execution, the sort of moment India desperately needed.

But it remained an isolated moment. For all the urgency demanded by the situation, India spent much of the second quarter looking anything but urgent. Argentina were not being pinned back. India's midfield was not dictating the game, and couldn't manage a sustained wave of attacks.

Most strikingly, there was a lack of personality. India have players capable of producing spectacular moments. They have players who can eliminate opponents with a piece of skill, burst through a gap or change the tempo of a match with one pass. But there was little of that here.

There was no jaw-dropping move. No passage of hockey

that made you sit up. No show-case of the skill that this team possesses. Instead, India seemed to be waiting for something to happen.

The contrast with Argentina was stark. Their first two goals came from India's defensive uncertainty, but Argentina were alert enough to exploit it. And when the ball entered the Indian circle, they looked more decisive.

Tomas Domene was the clearest example. When the Argentine forward found the net again with a reverse hit, India were once more too slow to react. It was Domene's seventh goal of the tournament, and India knew exactly what he was capable of.

Earlier this year, Argentina had beaten India 8-0 and 4-2 in the Pro League. Domene scored four times in that extraordinary 8-0 victory, while he was again among the scorers in the 4-2

win. He had already established himself as one of the most dangerous forwards India would face at this World Cup. India knew the threat. And yet they continued to give him openings.

Thirty-four seconds into the third quarter, it happened again. Sumit reached for the ball, failed to get enough of it and brought down the Argentine attacker. Another penalty corner. Argentina did not convert that one. India could count themselves fortunate.

But fortune could only protect them for so long. The fourth goal was almost a summary of the evening. Yashdeep Siwach played a square ball that was intercepted, leaving Argentina one-on-one with Mohith H S. The goalkeeper saved the first attempt, but the rebound struck Yashdeep's foot in front of the goal.

Penalty stroke. Domene converted. 4-1.

It was not an elaborate Argentine move that broke India. It was another Indian mistake. That has been the most damning feature of the performance. India have not simply been beaten by a team producing irresistible hockey. They have repeatedly made the game easier for Argentina.

Looking flat

There was another problem, too: India were not creating enough opportunities of their own. They entered the match needing to chase a substantial margin. That should have produced desperation. Instead, they looked flat. Too slow with the ball. Too passive without it. Too often waiting for the opposition to make the next move. This was not simply a night when India failed to convert their chances. They barely created enough of them.

There will be questions about India's defence, their midfield and their attacking structure. There will be questions about why a team with so much individual ability could produce so little collective spark in a match of such consequence.

But the most uncomfortable question may be simpler. Where was the fight?

India did not go out because Argentina produced a performance so overwhelming that they were left helpless. They crashed out after repeatedly making errors, failing to respond to them and then failing to create enough pressure of their own.

A high-stakes World Cup game, with a semi-final place on the line, demanded a team willing to seize the match. India needed to create a storm. Instead, they got swept away in one.

We want Imran to get best treatment: Kapil

Express News Service
New Delhi, August 24

KAPIL DEV does not blame Pakistani cricketers for not speaking up in favour of an ailing Imran Khan, because "they have to live there". The Indian cricket icon instead chooses to restate his support and seek the best treatment for the fellow former all-rounder.

Dev is one of the 22 ex-international captains who issued a second appeal to Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif on Sunday, expressing concern over Khan's health. An eye condition has reportedly left Khan almost entirely blind in one eye, amid allegations of medical neglect in prison.

"I would like to support my friend, against whom we played and admired his cricketing skill. We don't know the law of the country. But humanity and simple facilities should be given to a prisoner, whoever he may be. And he was a former prime minister of the country and a top cricketer of the world," Dev said on Monday at the launch of PGTI's Race to DP World India Championship.

"We want he (Khan) should get the best treatment. We are not asking for anything else, we are asking for any replies, we are requesting," Dev added.

Sunil Gavaskar and Dilip Vengsarkar are the other Indians to have signed the latest letter to Sharif. Greg Chappell initiated the communication and Clive Lloyd, Arjuna Ranatunga, Allan Border, David Gower, Steve Waugh and John Wright are also signatories.

The first letter was sent in February 2026 when 14 former captains, including Gavaskar, had put on record their apprehensions over Imran's medical condition.

This followed allegations of negligence at Adiala prison, where Khan is being held by the current regime. The signatories described themselves as "former colleagues and rivals who share a bond



Kapil Dev at a PGTI event. PFI

forged on the cricket field", adding that the bond "transcends the borders and disputes that too often divide countries".

Khan served as Pakistan's prime minister from 2018 to 2022 but has been in jail since his removal from office after being convicted in corruption and other cases. The 1992 World Cup-winning Pakistan skipper was recently taken to a government hospital for a medical examination. The examination was conducted in the presence of one of his sisters, and Khan was then returned to Adiala prison. Doctors declared him medically fit, but the 22 cricket greats have questioned the procedure of Khan's medical checkup.

PGTI calendar revised

Dev, the Professional Golf Tour of India (PGTI) president, also unveiled the new Order of Merit trophy for the DP World India Championship. Under the fresh format, the 2026 champion will be decided after the competition on October 18. This schedule aligns the PGTI calendar closely with the World Tour, so that players don't miss out on key tournaments.

The 'race' to the Championship features nine tournaments. It will end with the Kapil Dev Invitational Tour Championship — in Greater Noida from September 30 — and determine the season's top 24 performers who make the Championship cut.

माननीय प्रधानमंत्री श्री नरेन्द्र मोदी जी का 'स्वच्छ भारत मिशन' - दिल्ली का जन-अभियान

आइए, स्वच्छ दिल्ली के लिए सब साथ मिलकर कदम बढ़ाएं

नरेन्द्र मोदी
प्रधानमंत्री

रेखा गुप्ता
मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली

दिल्ली को फूड़े से आज़ादी

17 अगस्त - 2 अक्टूबर, 2026

स्वच्छ दिल्ली के लिए

क्या करें?

कूड़ा हमेशा डस्टबिन में डालें

गीला और सूखा कूड़ा अलग रखें

घर, दुकान और अपने आसपास सफाई रखें

RWA, वार्ड, बाजार व स्कूलों के स्वच्छता अभियान से जुड़ें

क्या न करें?

सार्वजनिक स्थानों पर गंदगी न फैलाएं

नालियों में कचरा न डालें

प्लास्टिक व कचरा पाकों में न छोड़ें

सड़क, पार्क या खाली प्लॉट में कूड़ा न फेंकें

कहीं कूड़ा दिखे तो MCD (311 ऐप) पर शिकायत दर्ज करें

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स्वच्छ दिल्ली हम सबकी जिम्मेदारी

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